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NEW DELHI/METRO
Friday, November 13, 2026

Hindustan Times
FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

Collection O Sadar Bazar Gurgaon: “Nice hotel in gurugram, best hotel near sadar bazar, room infrastructure are awesome also hotel staff are very polite and humble, room clearness is awesome, if you want stay near sadarbazar so this is best option for stay.’ — Sachin. Townhouse Karmelaram Railway Station Sarjapur: “Clean rooms, friendly staff, smooth check-in. Great stay, would return again! Highly recommended!!!” — Vishal. Townhouse Sector 69 Gurgaon: “Had a wonderful stay. The room was clean, comfortable, and well-maintained. The staff was very polite, friendly, and always ready to help. Their hospitality made the experience even better. Highly recommended.’ — Prabhakar. “The room was very clean and the location was also very good and the staff was also very good, the space of the room was also good and fully ac room.” — Vikash. Townhouse Millenium City Centre: “A perfect blend of comfort and modern elegance OYO Townhouse never disappoints. Feels like a premium stay without the premium price.” — Sandeep Sharma. “Worth of a stay at this property. Strongly recommend to other guests. Hospitality is top rated” — Harish Mittal. Collection O Sector 33 Gurgaon: Staff was very nice and helpful, Sumit and Shivam were very polite and helped me along my stay. Room was clean and very good. — Pramod. “Excellent stay good with top-notch amenities, very smooth check-in process and delicious food. Truly a five-star experience in every way.” — Kapil. Hotel O Sector 52 Gurgaon: “Location and room service is excellent, since I am traveling from last 2 years I get this is one the best hotel.” — Ashish Kumar. “Good location, clean room and helpful staff. Amenities and service were satisfactory. Value for money. — Nitish Kumar. Townhouse Sector 49 Sohna Road: ”Good property, awesome vibes, superb location, staff polite and helpful, cozy beds, overall safe and secure environment.” — Ashutosh Kumar. Townhouse OAK AECS Layout Brookfield: “The location of the place is good, and there are good restorent available, the rooms are so comfortable and very clean and workers are so friendly.” — Harsha Jc. Hotel O Whitefield: “Staff also good, building location very good, rooms very nice, lovely manager and all staff very good service. Super Hotel O Whitefield!” — Nigu. Collection O Bangalore Airport Stay: “Friendly staff quick help and service room also neat and cleat 10/10” — Nimesh Rai. Collection O Niladri Road: “Best hotel for stay, rooms are very clean and neat, staff are very good with quick response.” — Abhijith. Collection O Guduvancheri Railway Station: “Good room at low price which really help in budget trip” — Aswanth Ls. Hotel O Triplicane Formerly Park Royal: “Had a smooth check in.the room was clean and decently maintained. The overall experience was good” — Dhaksheish. Collection O K R Puram Manyata: “I was very impressed by the peaceful atmosphere here. It felt like a peaceful, poolside experience, and every moment of our stay was relaxing.” — Kelevi. “Good hotels in Bangalore, the best part is the location is easily accessible to everyone and the staff is quite helpful.”— Ayush. Hotel O Brookefield Mall Bangalore: “This is a new place and staff is very good and very helpful.” — Amit Kumar Kushwaha. “Good rooms and service is good. — Sabbir Ahmed. Hotel O Nemeli Road Sriram Nagar: ”Great location, beautiful surrounding atmosphere, great staff. Most friendly and helpful receptionist and staff ever, lovely and great first impression of the hotel. Everything about the hotel was exceptional — clean, stylish, roomy with excellent service. Food was good and great value for money. I was very pleased with my stay and hope to be back for a longer visit in the future.” — Saron Raj. Hotel O Purasaiwalkam: “A good budget friendly and a clean stayThe stays, friendly staffs at a good budget.Am satisfied” — Arun. Hotel O Janappanchatram: “Staff was friendly and very helpful.” — Lokesh. “Easy check-in and smooth experience.” — Kumar. Hotel O Red Hill Chennai: “Good hotel and worth for stay in low cost... superb hotel” — Yuvan Yuvan. “Benefits for money... Good stay” — Mukil Tours Travels. Super Collection O Shalimar Bagh: “Excellent stay! The rooms were clean, spacious, and well-maintained. The staff was polite and always ready to help. One of the biggest advantages is the location — it's very close to Metro Station, making travel across Delhi extremely convenient. Highly recommended for both business and family stays.” — Vivek Gupta. “Had a wonderful experience here. The hotel is clean, peaceful, and well-managed. The staff is courteous, and check-in was quick. The location is perfect, with Shalimar Bagh Metro Station nearby, making it an ideal choice for anyone visiting Delhi. Will definitely stay again.” — Vandana Gupta. Hotel O Alipur Narela: “Exceptional hospitality; staff went out of their way to help with trekking arrangements, making the stay feel like home. Truly special atmosphere!” — Rohit Gupta. Townhouse Chhatarpur Metro Station Delhi: “Had an amazing stay! The rooms were super clean and comfortable, staff was very polite and helpful” — Jatin Kumar. ”It's a very great experience at the hotel, I will visit again and good service, also got a very clean room. Thanks!” — Kunal. Hotel O Dwarka Metro Station: “ I really enjoyed the stay, the reception staff was very friendly and polite. Really love the stay.” — Priyanshu Bidaliya. ”This hotel is very nice and service is also nice. — Ramit Das. “Good place to stay and I would recommend for others.” — Jonesbritto. Super Capital O Prestige: “Amazing service! Loved the place and they serve delicious food. The rooms are really maintained well.” — Neha. Super Townhouse Oak Sector 39 Medanta: “Comfortable and peaceful stay. I loved to suggest this place to others. Totally worth it option for any stay... family, friends, alone. Loved it.” — Swati. Hotel O Bolligudem: ”Excellent hotel, staff was responsive and check-in smooth. Kind staff and clean hotel — recommended 10/10.” — Vishnu. “Good, so worthy, and staff so helping in nature.” — Kiran Payavulla. Collection O Park Circus: “Nice stay, very clean room, good behaviour, staff behaviour is good, nice ambiance, always staff is available” — Tanishq Sah. Super Townhouse Newtown DLF: “Both of the receptionists are extremely helpful and polite. We wish to visit again.” — Ankur. “Good to stay here, neat and clean rooms, staff are good’ — Yatish Singh. Super Townhouse PBG Mall Vashi: “I had a comfortable stay at Townhouse. Will surely visit again” — Ronit Mallick. Hotel O Palava Dombivali: “Best OYO serviced hotel, thank you hotel staff and OYO app for finding me the better rooms as compared to other apps” — Kishor. Townhouse Oak Vashi: “Nice service by the whole staff and hotel is very neat and clean.” — Mohammad. “Comfortable accommodation next to Kamat vegetarian restaurant in Vashi, Navi Mumbai” — Raju. Townhouse Sector 143B Noida “It is a great place to stay in Sector 143, it is a great place at a very affordable price, loved the experience here,” — Ankit. “This is a premium OYO hotel on Noida Expressway. Location is also awesome and this hotel will give you secure and premium hotel facilities” — Atul. Super Hotel O Kondapur Hyderabad Formerly Dunes Inn: “simply awesome. the ambience, way I was treated everything made me feel safe and comfortable.” — Hemant. Townhouse Oak Sector 31 Noida: “I had a great experience staying here. Rooms are tidy and staff is really very caring. I would recommend it — it's the best place to stay to have a great experience.” — Surbhi Chaudhary. “Excellent stay! The room was spotless and comfortable, location very convenient, and check-in process smooth and quick.” — Deepanshu. Collection O Sector 20 Noida: “Hotel services are best and the staff is also supportive and friendly and overall experience of staying here is good” — Super Townhouse Kokapet Near GAR: “Premises is clean and tidy. Staff is responsive to any requests. It is located nearby to offices and can be reached easily by OTR access road.” — Ram. Collection O ECIL Industrial Estate Formerly Hotel Cube: “The hotel is good the staff are polite and easy to travel and there are so many shops near and overall good stay” — Dhruv. Townhouse Preet Vihar Metro Station: “Excellent stay! The amenities were top-notch, rooms sparkled with cleanliness, and the check-in process was smooth and welcoming.” — Manish. Townhouse Gomti Nagar Matiyari: ”I had an outstanding experience. We visited for an official meeting, and from the moment we arrived, the service was impeccable.” — Prakhar Shankar. OYO Collection O Vrindavan Yojna Lucknow Formerly Khushboo Palace: ”Room are good and are easily accessible. Trained Staff and good area.. Everything is too good. Enjoyed our vacation” — Akash. Hotel O SGPGI: “The best hotel Lucknow ever visited, this was a wonderful experience great property manager and good location” — Pragatisheel M. K Singh. Hotel O Gomti Nagar Vigyan Khand: ’Nice place to stay under low budget.” — Tushar. Collection O High Court Lucknow: “I have visited this hotel several times, and each stay has been consistently pleasant and comfortable. The rooms are always clean and well-maintained”.” — Kirti Singh. “Excellent stay! Staff were very courteous and helpful.” — Jatin. Hotel O Gahakkal Omkar Global Inn: “Good location and comfortable stay. staff behaviour is very good and 24X7 hours help available in stay” — Poli. Super Townhouse Pimple Nilakh Pune: “So nice room which was allocated and I would recommend everyone to go and best place to visit and be around” — Anup Panday.

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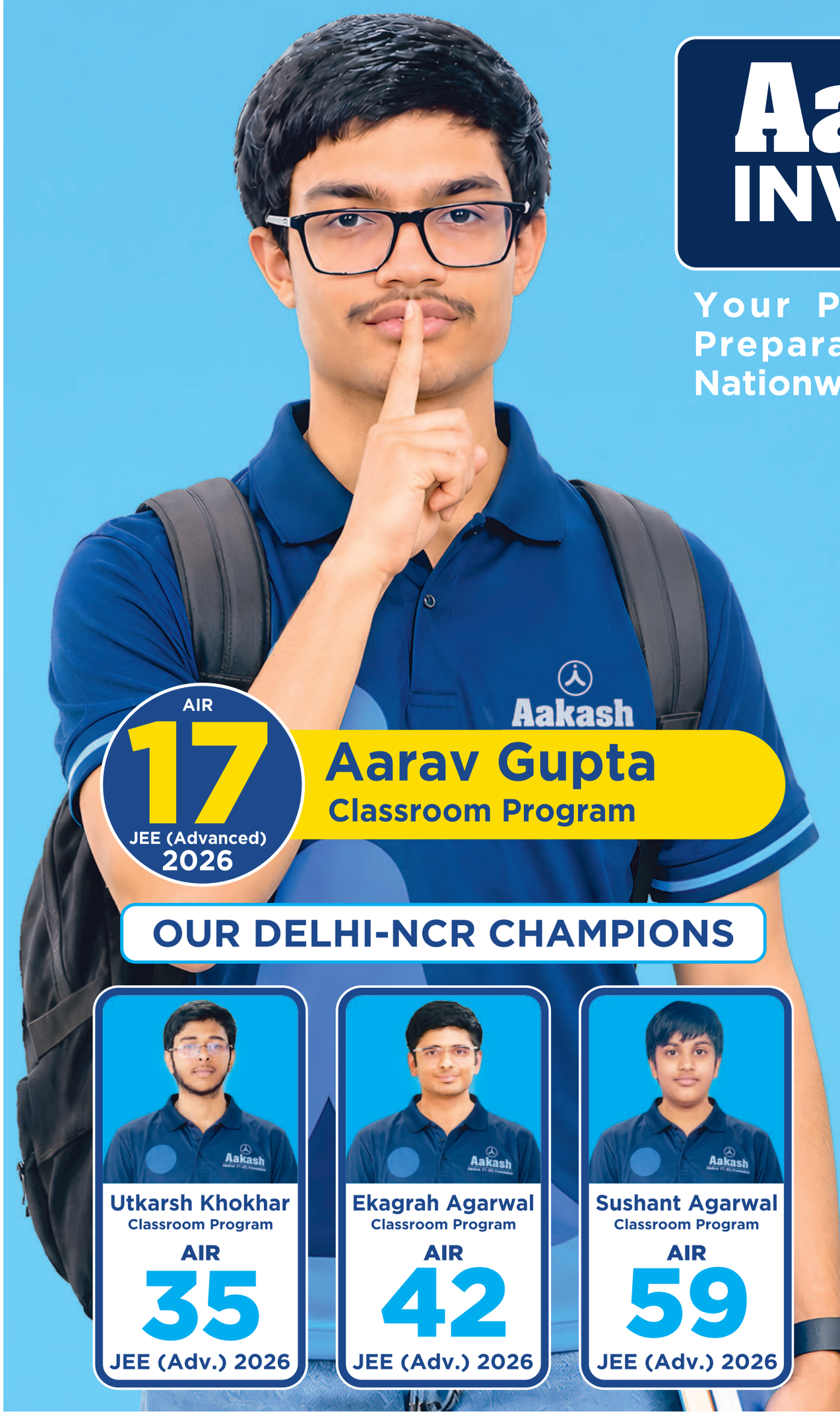

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1. Name of the Work : Periodical maintenance of five year completed PMGSY works in the District of Kalahandi and Nuapada.
2. No of Works : As per NIT.
3, Location details : Kalahandi and Nuapada District
4, Estimated Cost : As per NIT.
5. Period of Completion : As per NIT.
6. Cost of tender paper : Rs.10,000/- per set.
7. Other details

Availability of Tender On-line for bidding		Last date & time for seeking tender clarification	Date and time of opening of technical bid
From	To		
16.11.2026 11.00 A.M.	30.11.2026 5.00 P.M.	27.11.2026	01.12.2026 at 11.00 A.M.

Further details can be seen from the website **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**

Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Bhawanipatna

OIPR - 225001/25102/1/26-27/0017

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Nisha Kumari

General public is hereby informed that one girl (depicted in the photo) Namely: **Nisha Kumari, D/o. Mukesh Kumar, R/o: H. No. 92, Gali No. 01, Champi Chowk, Tunda Nagar, Johripur, Delhi-110094** has been Missing/Kidnapped from her house since **16.10.2026 at 5.00 P.M.** In this regard a missing report case vide **FIR No.336/2026 dated 09.11.2026 U/S 137(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023** has been lodged at **P.S. Karawal Nagar, North-East District, Delhi.**

Her Physical description is as under:-

Sex: Female, **Age:** 14 Years, **Height:** 5', **Complexion:** Fair, **Face:** Round, **Built:** Medium, **Identification Mark:** A cut mark above the Right Eye, **Wearing:** White Color Kurti, Pink Color Lower and White Slippers on her foot.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing girl but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone having any information about this girl please inform to the following.

Phone No.: 011-24368638, 011-24368641 | Fax no.: 011-24368639 | Email id : cic@cbi.nic.in | Website : https://cbi.nic.in

SHO
P.S – Karawal Nagar, Delhi
Phone: 9205832616, 8800421044

DP/16390/NE/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING

General public is hereby informed that a Male namely **Teekam Singh, S/o: Malkhan Singh, R/o: Village Jeetpur Milak, Tehsil Dhampur, Distt. Bijnor, UP has been missing since 25.10.2026 from Kishangarh Village, Bus Stand, Near CNG Pump, Delhi.** In this regard **FIR No. 260/2026, U/s: 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Dated: 31.10.2026,** has been registered at P.S. **Kishangarh, Delhi.** The description of missing Male is as under:

Name: Teekam Singh, Age: 35 Years, Height: 5'5", Complexion: Wheatish, Built: Medium, Wearing: Grey Colour T-Shirt, White Colour Pant and Black Colour Sport Shoes in Feet.

If anyone have any information about this missing Male please inform P.S. **Kishangarh, Delhi.**

Web: http://cbi.nic.in, Email: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638/24368641, Fax: 011-24368639

SHO
Police Station Kishangarh, Delhi
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CHANGE OF NAME

IT IS for general information that I, Asif Abbas S/O Mohammad Abbas Siddiqui R/o Jangalia Ward-15, Gopalganj, Bihar-841428 declare that name of my father and my mother has been wrongly written as Md Abbas Siddique And Jahan ARA in my 10th and 12th class and migration certificate educational documents. The actual name of my father and my mother are Mohammad Abbas Siddiqui and Jahan Arah Khatoon respectively, which may be amended accordingly.

IN MY Passport My name mentioned as Aarsh S/o Mohammad Mustafa. Which is Wrong. My Correct name is Arsh S/o Mohd Mustafa for all future purposes. Arsh S/o Mohd Mustafa R/o H.no 527, Kabristan Wali Gali, Kamalpur Datawali Meerut U.P

I, SREEDHARAN Nambhoothiri, S/o Late Shri Eswaran Nampoothiri R/o.B-105, Gayatri Apartments, Plot 9, Sector-9, Dwarka,New Delhi- 77 have changed my son's name from Easwaran Nampoothiri K S to Eashwaran Nampoothiri for all future purposes

I, VASUDEV S/o Late Sh. Ramlal Chawla R/o H. No. 53, Near Main Market, Mohna, Faridabad-121004 Haryana have changed my name from Vasudev to Vasudev Chawla for all future purposes.

I, DEVENDRA Singh, S/o Mangal Singh, R/o C-4/8, Himalaya Pride, Techzone-4, Greater Noida West, Gautam Buddh Nagar (U.P) 201306 have changed my name from Devendra Singh to Devender Singh for all future purposes.

I, NIDHI Nirwan W/o Kameshwar Singh Nirwan, R/o Flat-1742, Building Romano, Mahagun Moderne, Sector-78, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP-201301 have changed my name from Nidhi Nirwan to Nidhi Singh Nirwan. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Nidhi Singh Nirwan for all future purposes.

I, JYOTI Arya R/o H.No. 1280, 4th Floor, Street no 8, Govindpuri, Kalkaji, New Delhi-110019, declare Jyoti & Jyoti Arya are one person. Also, my father Bhuvan Arya & Bhuvan Ram Arya are one & the same person.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, GAURAV S/o Chander Pal Bansal, Resident of F-36, Senior Citizen Home Complex, Sector P-3, Greater Noida, Kasana, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh - 201310 have change my name from Gaurav to Gaurav Bansal. Henceforth I would be known as Gaurav Bansal for all future purposes.

I, RINKI Yadav, D/O Umesh Yadav, R/O House-A-158, Gali No. 1, Jhandapur, I.E. Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, UP-201010, declare that my name is mentioned as Rinki Yadav in Aadhaar and Km Rinki in educational documents. Both names belong to one and the same person, and in future I shall be known as Km Rinki.

I, VIJAY Deep Kumar Pandey S/o Radhey Shyam Pandey, R/o Tower - 5A , Flat No. -605 Grand IVA Sector-103, Gurgaon, Haryana -122006 Changed my Name as Vijay Deep Pandey.

I, ZAHEEN Siddiqi S/o Jameel Ahmed, R/o 134 -135, Second Floor, Gali Masjid Tehwar Khan, Naya Bans, Delhi - 110006, have changed my name to Zaheen Ahmed for all future purposes.

I, ANITA Sarangi, wife of Sh. Santosha Kumar Sarangi, aged 38 years, residing at D47/1, Street No 3, Rajpur Khurd Colony, Chhatarpur, New Delhi 110068, have changed my name from Anita Sarangi to Anita Panda Sarangi. As per Affidavit dated 29.10.2026 sworn before a Notary Public at New Delhi. Both names refer to the same and one identical person.

I, KRISHAN Kumar S/o Sh. Ishwar Dass R/o H.No. 1379, Sector 7 Extn, First Floor, Gurugram Hr 122001. have changed my name to Krishan Kumar Verma for all future purposes.

I, SHRI Vedenu, S/o Late Theyesayi, Resident of Phugwi Village Under Phek district, declare through this Affidavit vide Regd No. 227 dated 06/10/2026 before the First Class Magistrate, Phek, that my late father's name has been inadvertently entered as Lal Bahadur in all my official Documents. That henceforth, for all official purposes his name shall be written and used as Theyesayi.

I, ABHISHEK Dwivedi S/o Prabhat Kumar Dwivedi, resident of A54-B, Nikunj Appartment, Shyam Park Extension, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad (U.P.)- 201005, have changed my name from Abhishek Dwivedi to Abhishek Kumar Dwivedi. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Abhishek Kumar Dwivedi for all future purposes.

I, AKRITI Goel, W/o Sh. Rahul Goel and R/o House No. 14, Road No. 22, Punjabi Bagh, West Delhi, Delhi - 110026, have changed my name from Akriti Goel to Akriti Jain. I have complied with all legal requirements in this regard and have duly sworn an affidavit also. Henceforth, I shall be known as Akriti Jain for all purposes.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, MANITA W/o Gaurav Bansal resident of, F-36 Senior Citizen Home Complex, Sector P-3, Greater Noida, Kasana, PO: Kasna, Dist: Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201310 Have change my name from Manita to Manita Bansal. Henceforth I would be known as Manita Bansal for all future purposes.

NO. 452839N Sub Maj Sanjay Kumar R/o Village Kharak Khurd Teh. Bhiwani Dist. Bhiwani Haryana Mother name was entered incorrectly in my Military Documents list is Jayotri" But Official documents list it is Javitri which is correct both names refar to the Same woman in the future she should be known by the name Javitri.

I, MORDHAVAJ S/o Lajpat resident of Vill: Bhairi Akberpur Uklana Mandi Hisar 125113 have changed my name to Mordhavaj Dadhich vide affidavit dated 11-11-2026, sworn before Notary Gurugram

I, MADHUR Bhatia Garg W/o Sameer Garg R/o B 102, Arihant Arden, Sector 1, Greater Noida West, U.P. 201306 have changed my name to Madhur Bhatia for all purposes.

I, AANCHAL, W/o Roopak Shivani, R/o 604, Tower-11, Emaar Palm Garden, Sector-83, Gurgaon, Haryana-122004 have changed my name from Aanchal to Aanchal Sachdeva. Henceforth I Would be known by the name of Aanchal Sachdeva for all future purposes.

I, VIKAS Kumar S/o Sh. Krishan Kumar, R/o H. No. D-238, Jhailmil Colony, East Delhi, Delhi-110095. I declare that Vikas Kumar and Vikas Khera are the same person. I have changed my name from Vikas Khera to Vikas Kumar for all future purposes.

I, ASHWANI Bhat, S/o Mr. Maharaj Krishna Bhat, R/o D-3/16, Gali No. 9, Mahavir Enclave Part-1, South West Delhi - 110045, declare that my name is wrongly mentioned as Bhat Ashwani Maharaj Krishan instead of Ashwani Bhat (Aadhaar No. 524448211352), and my mother's name as Bhat Shanta Maharaj Krishan instead of Shanta Bhat. Both correct names shall be used for all future purposes.

I, RANI Khatoon, R/o Rohtas, Bihar. Changed my name as Rani Khatoon D/o Israr Ansari from Saniya Khatoon.

LOST & FOUND

I, NISHA Rani Garg W/o Surinder Kumar Garg R/o 23101, Tower-3, 10th Floor, Prestige Waterford, ECC ITPL Main Road, Bengaluru, Karnataka-560066 have lost my Builder Buyer Agreement / Allotment Letter of my property Flat No. C-1504, Tower-C, Pristine Avenue, Gaur City 2, Greater Noida West, Gautam Buddh Nagar (U.P) 201318 If found please contact : 8295573820

PUBLIC NOTICES

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is for the knowledge & information of all that my clients Shri Dharmendra Saxena and Smt. Sandhya Saxena who are married couple R/o D2A/49B, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058 have severed all their relations with their son named Sparsh Saxena and his wife Smt. Gopika Kalra, their daughter in law absolutely and forever effective with immediate effect. Both of my above named clients have also disowned and debarred them from all their movable and immovable properties and assets whether self acquired or currently owned or to be acquired in future. Any person dealing with them shall do so at one's own risk and responsibility. My clients shall not be liable for any consequences and also will not be responsible for their act, misdeeds or debts whether illegal or unlawful now or in the future.

Sd.
Neha Gera
Advocate
Enrl.No. D/682/2009
F-26/1, Shankar Market, Connaught Place, New Delhi - 110001

FORM URC-2

Advertisement giving notice about registration under Part I of Chapter XXI [Pursuant to section 374(b) of the Companies Act, 2013 and rule 4(1) of the Companies (Authorized to Register) Rules, 2014]

1. **NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN** that in pursuance of sub-section (2) of Section 366 of the Companies Act, 2013, an application is proposed to be made after fifteen days hereof but before the expiry of thirty days hereinafter to the Registrar of Companies, Delhi I that Emarald Builders & Developers LLP, a Limited Liability Partnership Firm, may be registered under Part I of Chapter XXI of the Companies Act, 2013, as a Private Company Limited by shares.
2. The principal objects of the company are as follows: To carry on the business of Real estate activities with own or leased property or Real Estate activities along with Construction business and continue business activities of the Limited Liability Partnership 'Emarald Builders & Developers LLP' - post registration under Chapter XXI of the companies Act, 2013.
3. A copy of the draft memorandum and articles of association of the proposed company may be inspected at the office at S-263, entire Basement/ Lower Ground Floor, Greater Kailash, Part-1, New Delhi-110048.
4. Notice is hereby given that any person objecting to this application may communicate their objection in writing to the Registrar at Central Registration Centre (CRC), Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs (IICA), Plot No. 6,7,8, Sector-5, IMT Manesar, District Gurgaon (Haryana), Pin Code -122050, within twenty-one days from the date of publication of this notice, with a copy to the Company at its registered office.

Name of the Applicant : Bharat Pal Singh & Prahlad Gautam

AUCTION NOTICES

E-AUCTION NOTICE

An E-Auction of obsolete items will be conducted at following 2 (two) locations of World Bank Facilities

1. **Location #1-Hindustan Times House 18-20 Kasturba Gandhi Marg-Ground Floor** -Sale of fixed equipment, materials, and fittings located at Ground, Mezzanine & Basement

   Site handover: By **11 December 2026,** the successful bidder must vacate the premises and hand them over as a broom-clean, debris-free bare shell. ***Total Area -55,000 sqft (Fifty five thousand sqft)***

   - ***E-Auction -1***- Fixed Items: The E-Auction scope includes all fixed items: fire detection systems; fixed furniture workstations, of 76 open workstations and in 64 enclosed office rooms; ceiling, conference room, round and long lighting fixtures; demolition of wooden, gypsum, MDF and glass partitions; carpet and hard flooring; tile-grid and gypsum ceilings; roller blinds; ductwork; wiring and conduits; DB shutters; and other fixed items on as is where basis. **Earnest Money Deposit (EMD):** Rs.200,000/- (by NEFT in favoring Accurate Auctioneers.) to be deposited before the start of e-auction and note EMD will be refunded after NOC from satisfactory work
   - ***E-Auction-2***- Loose furniture-Herman Miller Chairs, Haworth X-99 conf Chairs, Tower AC Units, electrical panels and stabilizers (2 × 300 kVA); UPS units (2 × 80 kVA) with 72 batteries; HVAC equipment and ducts; VRV units (40 and 10 HP); etc available in separate lots at HT House Ground

     Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)- (by NEFT in favoring Accurate Auctioneers.) is indicate against each Lot List available with Auctioneer
2. **E-Auction-3 at Location #2-The World Bank Building at 70 Lodhi Estate, K. K. Birla Lane, Lodhi Garden gate No-2. New Delhi – 110003.** Sale of Herman-Miller-Chairs, Haworth X-99 conf Chairs, AC Units & Junk Items etc. available in separate lots

   Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)- (by NEFT in favoring Accurate Auctioneers) is indicate against each Lot List available with Auctioneer

E-Auction Date:
17-Nov-2026 – 11.30 am

The Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) specified above must be paid before the e-auction begins. The EMD will be refunded after WORLD BANK–New Delhi issues a No Objection Certificate (NOC) confirming satisfactory completion of the work. The security deposit will be forfeited if the bidder fails to pay the full amount, including GST.

Inspection Dates: 14th 15th & 16th November 2026. (3 days)

Inspection Location: Location-1- Hindustan Times House, 18-20 K G Marg. New Delhi-110001 & **Location -2** World Bank Building, 70 Lodhi Estate, KK Birla Lane Near Lodhi Garden Gate No-2, New Delhi-110003.

Note; *The World Bank reserves the right to modify, suspend, or cancel all or part of the auction process at any time before contract award, without liability to bidders.*

For Details Terms & Conditions, and catalogue contact Govt. Auctioneer:
ACCURATE AUCTIONEERS
09868215515, 8076863359.
www.accurateauctioneers.in

COURT NOTICES

COURT NOTICE

In The Court of **MS. TAVLEEN KAUR MOHI,** District Judge-02, Room No. 605, 6th Floor, Dwarka Courts Complex, Delhi GP NO. 22/2026

JYOTI VANJANI AND ANR Vs. **STATE** NDOH-18.12.2026

Citation Under Section 8 of The Hindu Minority And Guardian And Wards Act, 1956, Read With Sections 29 And 31.

Whereas an application under section 8 of the Hindu Minority and Guardianship Act, 1956 read with sections 29 and 31 of the Guardians and Wards Act, 1890 seeking prior permission to sell/Transfer the Lawful share/interest of the Minor Petitoner 2 Namely Drishti Gangwani D/o Late Anand Kumar Gangwani and Smt Jyoti Gangwani R/o A-43, Block-A, Extension Mohan Garden, Durga Wali Gali, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059. Petitioner has been filed by Petitioner no. 1 Smt Jyoti Gangwani W/o Late Anand Kumar Gangwani R/o A-43, Block-A, Extension Mohan Garden, Durga Wali Gali, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059, for the below mentioned immovable property.

Property bearing First Floor, without Roof Rights on Property A-53-A, Measuring 58 Sq. Yards (48.494 Sq. Mtrs), Out of Khasra No. 600, Village Nawada Majra, Hastsal, Mohan Garden Extension, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059.

Whereas the case has been fixed for hearing on **18.12.2026** Notice is hereby given that any person having any interest in the Administration of the Estate of the said deceased may if he/she desires to appear in this court of the said **18.12.2026** and see the proceedings before the Grant Guardianship Rights.

Given under my hand and the seal of this court on this **10.10.2026.**

Tavleen Kaur Mohi, District Judge-02 Dwarka Courts Complex, Delhi

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NEW DELHI/METRO
Friday, November 13, 2026

Hindustan Times
FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

AI superstar ousted as Nvidia CEO over affairs

Bloomberg
letters@hindustantimes.com

SAN FRANCISCO: Nvidia chief executive officer (CEO) Jensen Huang, the preeminent face of the AI infrastructure boom, was ousted from his post after reports of two affairs, including one with a woman suspected of spying for China.

Longtime chief financial officer (CFO) Colette Kress is taking the job of interim CEO, Nvidia said on Thursday, and Huang will no longer have ties with the chipmaker. The board, which has never had a chair before, appointed director Harvey Jones to that role. Jones, 73, formerly led Synopsys, a company that Nvidia took a $2 billion stake in last year.

The resignation deepens a crisis partly of Nvidia's own making, since the company has long lacked a clear succession plan. The 63-year-old has been Nvidia's only CEO during its three-decade history. He carefully managed every part of the business, while also serving as a champion for the broader AI industry.

Huang transformed the business from a niche maker of computer graphics components into the world's biggest seller of AI computing chips, the highly prized products at the center of a global spending frenzy.

"Jensen Huang's resignation is a watershed moment for Nvidia, which now has to prove it can maintain its AI dominance without the leader largely responsible for building it," Emarketer senior analyst Asa Hiken said in a note. "And given the broader AI industry's heavy dependence on Nvidia's chips, Huang's departure introduces uncertainty well beyond the company itself."

continued on →9

How the Jensen Huang scandal unfolded

An affair between Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang and a woman suspected of spying for China has sent ripples through the global AI industry, ultimately culminating in his resignation on Thursday, even as reports emerged of another affair

JUNE 2024: Jensen Huang and Alice Huang, an executive linked to Megaspeed, a Singapore-based Nvidia cloud partner, are photographed together in Taiwan

OCTOBER 2025: US federal investigators examine Megaspeed's activities and potential chip exports to China

OCTOBER 29, 2026: US intelligence officials raise concerns that Alice Huang was acting on behalf of Chinese intelligence, the New York Times reports

NOVEMBER 8: Jensen Huang admits to having an extramarital affair in a message to Nvidia employees. Nvidia launches an independent investigation

NOVEMBER 9: Nvidia shareholder sues the company and Huang, accusing them of deceiving investors about the affair

NOVEMBER 11: Reports emerge of another alleged affair. Nvidia's board considers whether to oust Huang

NOVEMBER 12: Huang resigns as Nvidia CEO and board member. CFO Colette Kress becomes interim CEO

14.3% Nvidia shares plunged after Huang's resignation, raising concerns over the global AI trade. The stock recovered to trade 5.5% lower as of 11pm

SINGAPORE BARRED ALICE HUANG FROM ENTRY AFTER PROBE

Alice Huang, the alleged Chinese spy at the heart of a scandal at Nvidia, left Singapore in February and was barred from re-entering following a probe into possible offences, Singapore's home affairs ministry said on Thursday. It said Huang was probed for possible offences including buying servers that were exported via Singapore to Malaysia without entering the Singapore market. →P16

TRUMP SAYS EX-APPLE CEO TIM COOK SHOULD REPLACE HUANG

US President Donald Trump said on Thursday that former Apple Inc Chief Executive Tim Cook should replace Jensen Huang as the CEO of Nvidia. "NOW THAT Nvidia CEO JENSEN HUANG, who has done a fantastic job, has resigned, there is only one man to take his place - TIM COOK of Apple," Trump said in a post on social media. "A Legend replaces a Legend!" the US President further said. REUTERS

CANADA TRADE TALKS INCLUDE MOVEMENT OF PROFESSIONALS

Anirudh Bhattacharyya and Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

TORONTO/NEW DELHI: The mobility of professionals is part of ongoing negotiations between India and Canada for a comprehensive economic partnership agreement (CEPA) that the two sides are hoping to finalise by the end of the year, people familiar with the matter said.

The two sides will hold the sixth round of negotiations for the trade deal this week, and economic ties and cooperation in key areas such as critical minerals and energy have been spurred by a turnaround in the overall relationship since Mark Carney was elected Canada's PM in March last year. The two countries are looking to finalise talks on the trade deal before Prime Minister Narendra Modi visits Canada during December 11-12. The mobility of professionals is among the items on the agenda, five people familiar with the negotiations said. →P12

2 missing SPOs found shot dead in Kishtwar

Ravi Krishnan Khajuria
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JAMMU: The bullet-riddled bodies of two special police officers (SPOs) were recovered from a forest in Jammu and Kashmir's Kishtwar district early Thursday, a day after they went missing while travelling to report for patrolling duty, officials aware of the matter said, adding that their service weapons and ammunition were missing and are believed to have been taken away by terrorists.

The incident follows an attack on a CRPF checkpost in south Kashmir's Kulgam district on Wednesday, in which three security personnel were injured, one of them critically.

"The bodies were recovered between 8am and 9am on Thursday," a security official said, requesting anonymity. "A massive operation is underway to identify, track and neutralise the assailants."

The deceased have been identified as Babi Chand (57) and Rashpal Kumar (45), both residents of Kiyar village in the remote Dachhan tehsil in Kishtwar. Posted with the special operations group (SOG) of local police at Kiyar, the two were heading towards a temporary base of army's 17 Rashtriya Rifles in the Dharna-Marwah belt on Wednesday afternoon when they went out of contact, officials said.

SPOs are local residents engaged on a temporary, honorarium-based arrangement to assist the regular police in maintaining law and order.

Local residents, according to officials, reported hearing gunshots between Kiyar and Dharna on Wednesday afternoon. Initially, their mobile phones were reachable, though calls went unanswered; the devices were later switched off,

continued on →9

Previous attacks on SPOs

Oct 16, 2026: Bashir Ahmed, posted at the Pedil police post, found dead two days after he went missing in Kishtwar

June 27, 2021: Fayaz Ahmed, his wife Raj Begum and daughter Rafia killed in Pulwama

April 14, 2020: Pasid Iqbal killed in Kishtwar

A thick layer of toxic haze covers the Red Fort, in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

2 DIE AFTER TRUCK RAMS 3-WHEELER, WOMAN CRITICAL AFTER MISCARRIAGE

Hemani Bhandari
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NEW DELHI: Two men were killed while a nine-month pregnant woman was critically injured on Thursday after a truck rammed into the auto-rickshaw they were travelling in, near Sonia Vihar in Delhi, police said. The woman and her husband were on their way to a hospital after she complained of labour pains. Their unborn child also died. Police suspect fog may have led to the fatal early morning collision. →P3

Inflation tops RBI's 6% ceiling, raises Dec rate hike prospects

Shreya Khandelwal
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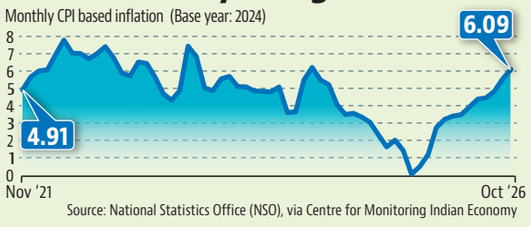
NEW DELHI: India's retail inflation rose to a two-year high of 6.09% in October, breaching the Reserve Bank of India's upper tolerance limit of 6% and strengthening expectations of another rate hike in December. Headline inflation has risen every month since November 2025 and had crossed the RBI's actual target of 4% in June this year.

The latest reading, driven by both food and non-food prices, was largely in line with expectations. A Bloomberg poll of economists had predicted inflation at 6%.

Inflation hits 2-year high

Monthly CPI based inflation (Base year: 2024)



Source: National Statistics Office (NSO), via Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy

India's benchmark inflation rate, measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI), rose 6.1% in October, according to data released by the National Statistics Office (NSO). The reading indicates that inflation is becoming broad-based, even as food remains its primary driver.

Monthly inflation increased in 11 of the 12 major categories of the

continued on →9

4 HC CHIEF JUSTICE APPOINTMENTS YET TO GET GOVT NOD; 2 VACANCIES LOOM

Utkarsh Anand
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NEW DELHI: The Union government is yet to clear four appointments of high court chief justices recommended by the Supreme Court collegium more than two weeks ago, leaving four high courts functioning under acting heads even as two more incumbent chief justices are set to retire in the coming fortnight.

The collegium, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, recommended the appointments on October 26. The delay has left the Delhi, Gujarat, Telangana and Uttarakhand high courts without regular chief justices. →P11

AQI surges amid wind shift, Capital enveloped in haze

Binayak Dasgupta
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi's air turned sharply more toxic on Thursday, with the concentration of PM2.5 across the city more than doubling in 24 hours to 244 micrograms per cubic metre by 6pm, four times the national standard, as a thick, smoky haze that usually thins by afternoon stayed trapped over the Capital in warm, damp and almost motionless air.

AIR WE BREATHE

Two things closed in on the city at once, an HT analysis of official pollution and weather data showed. The dome of air in which Delhi's pollution mixes and thins shrank to about 400 metres high on Thursday afternoon, from 1,400 metres two days earlier; and the north-westerly that carries smoke from the farm fires of Punjab and Haryana, slack since Diwali, was blowing above the city again at 34 km/h.

The Central Pollution Control Board's air quality index for Delhi, a rolling average of the previous 24 hours, climbed from 313 at 2am to 366 by 6pm, gaining seven to eight points an hour through the afternoon. At 10pm, it reached 387 — 74 points higher than the 24 hours before it. In all, 21 of the 58 stations reporting were in the "severe" zone, above 400, by then, against one on Wednesday evening and none on Tuesday. →P4

DRAFT ELECTORAL ROLLS FOR SSR PUBLISHED IN 13 STATES, 3 UTs

Himanshi Dahiya
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NEW DELHI: Draft electoral rolls were published on Thursday in 13 states and three Union Territories as part of the Election Commission of India (ECI)'s Special Summary Revision (SSR) 2027. Voters across these regions have until December 11, 2026, to submit claims and objections ahead of the final roll publication on January 4, 2027. →P10

KEY ACCUSED IN ₹2.8K-CR C'GARH LIQUOR SCAM HELD IN DUBAI

Neeraj Chauhan
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NEW DELHI: Vikas Agrawal, a key accused in an alleged ₹2,883-crore Chhattisgarh liquor scam who was absconding for the past several years, has been caught in Dubai and may be brought to India very soon, at least three officials told HT.

The alleged irregularities pertain to the illegal sale of unaccounted and duty-evaded liquor through state-run liquor outlets, allegedly under the protection of senior excise and other Chhattisgarh government officials between 2019 and 2023. →P13

PM points to progress, says 2047 Viksit Bharat deadline can be met

Smriti Kak Ramachandran
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said India could achieve its goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047, pointing to the country's recent progress in space, infrastructure and economic development. He also urged the media to showcase India's achievements and talent to the world as part of telling the "India story".

Addressing journalists at a Diwali Milan programme at the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) headquarters in the capital, Modi said setting a clear target helps change both the pace and approach of governance.

"Deadlines are important...

Prime Minister Narendra Modi

for individuals, institutions and even the country. We are also working on a deadline of 2047 to achieve Viksit Bharat," he said.

Modi stressed that the 2047 deadline was meant to instil urgency in the pace of work and drive immediate action rather than defer progress. →P10

CONG'S PITRODA CALLS MODI HIS 'GUJRATI FRIEND'; PM EXTENDS DIWALI GREETINGS

PM Narendra Modi on Thursday exchanged Diwali greetings with Indian Overseas Congress chief Sam Pitroda after the latter described him as a warm and caring friend, while appreciating his oratory and hard work. "Happy Diwali and Nutan Varsh Abhinandan to you Sam Bhai and to Anjana Ben. Praying for a joyful and healthy year ahead. Jai Jagannath!" Modi said on X, while sharing Pitroda's comments about him. Earlier, Pitroda, a close associate of LoP Rahul Gandhi, said in an interview he shared a bond with Modi, whom he had known as a "Gujarati friend". →P10

AAP DROPS MIN, 6 MLAs IN 2ND LIST OF 31 CANDIDATES FOR PUNJAB ELECTIONS

Navneet Sharma
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHANDIGARH: The Aam Aadmi Party on Thursday announced its second list of 31 candidates for the 2027 Punjab assembly polls, dropping seven sitting legislators, including a cabinet minister and two former ministers, and fielding two Lok Sabha MPs. The AAP is the only major party to have declared its nominees so far, announcing its candidates for 71 of the 117 Punjab seats. →P10

'Using AI to understand our rich history and culture is important'

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A century ago, a quiet scholarly breakthrough unfolded in erstwhile Mysore, when R Shamasastry, a pioneering epigraphist, unearthed and translated Kautilya's Arthashastra, an ancient Indian Sanskrit treatise on statecraft, economic policy, and military strategy, with manuscripts preserved on fragile strips of dried palm-leaf. Shamasastry is the great-great-grandfather of Caltech computer scientist and professor Anima Anandkumar, who drew a link between her expertise – Artificial Intelligence – and the storied history of her family.

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"UNESCO recognised Arthashastra as one of the treasures from India. And I have a really interesting connection that my great-great-grandfather discovered Kautilya's Arthashastra more than a century ago. Using AI even to understand our rich history, our culture, and our local traditions, is important," she said on the opening day of the 24th Hindustan Times Leadership Summit.

"We shouldn't just be focusing on one thing, but on having investments across the board, such as investing in technical research," she said, suggesting India's rich heritage and history as well as local traditions could do with being digitised using AI. →P15

'DIWALI MUBARAK': F'BAD MURDERER TOLD NEIGHBOUR AS HE SHOT HIM

Debashish Karmakar
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

GURUGRAM: The man accused of killing a Singapore-based executive in Faridabad last week over an argument regarding his dog was allegedly carrying a pistol with intentions to kill the victim and said "Diwali Mubarak" as he shot him, according to police officials and CCTV videos from the area on Thursday.

The accused, Mohan Sharma (42), allegedly shot dead his neighbour Paramjith Dhankhar (43) in the stilt parking area of a residential building in Sector 21C. He was arrested a day later. →P5

{ WORST START TO SEASON }

3 in 3: Man Utd remove Carrick amid slide; Pochettino seen as next in line for hot seat

Dhiman Sarkar
letters@hindustantimes.com

KOLKATA: Manchester United have sacked head coach Michael Carrick, marking the club's third managerial change in three seasons, after a poor run of results left the team in the relegation zone amid their worst start to a Premier League season. US men's coach Mauricio Pochettino is the frontrunner to replace him.

Appointed in January to replace Ruben Amorim, Carrick, 45, had initially turned things around for United, guiding them to 39 points in 17 Premier League matches, the highest tally by any team during that period. United finished third and qualified for the Champions League.

However, United's form has dropped off in the current season, with the club sitting 18th in the Premier League table, one point above the bottom, after managing just one win in 10 games. United have conceded 30 goals across competitions, the most among teams in Europe's top five leagues. →P19

Michael Carrick was sacked after Manchester United managed just one win in their opening 10 Premier League games. AFP

MOLESTED, PUSHED OFF MUMBAI LOCAL, WOMAN LOSES ARM; 53-YEAR-OLD HELD

Megha Sood
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: A 20-year-old woman lost her left arm after she was allegedly molested and pushed onto the railway tracks from a Mumbai local, police said on Thursday, adding the 53-year-old accused has been arrested. The incident occurred on November 4 when the woman confronted the accused for allegedly molesting her in a Virar-bound train. →P12

Ailing wife, foreign posting motive behind hijack hoax

Neha LM Tripathi and Joydeep Thakur
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A hijack threat note found in the toilet of a Kolkata-Mumbai flight on Wednesday was written by a 56-year-old passenger who has claimed he wanted to skip an overseas posting by his employer so that he could take care of his ailing wife, police said on Thursday.

The man was identified as the author of the note after passengers were made to take a handwriting test at Kolkata airport, where Air India flight AI 2772 was held up for several hours after the security scare.

"During questioning the man told airport security officials that he was reluctant to go abroad as his wife was ailing. Hence, he left a note in the aircraft's lavatory stating that it would be hijacked, hoping that the threat would delay the flight and eventually force cancellation of his journey," an official said. →P12

PAGE ONE PLUS

{ MY INDIA } PARLIAMENT SCHEDULE

Suspense continues over winter session

The Union government is yet to announce the next session of Parliament or prorogue the monsoon session, keeping Opposition parties and others guessing even as 91 days have passed since the Houses were adjourned sine die on August 13. The delay has fuelled speculation that the Centre may extend the monsoon session by a few days to push through the Delimitation Bill and the 131st Constitution Amendment Bill, which proposes to expand the Lok Sabha. With 12 days already gone in November, the government is running short of time if it wants to convene a fresh winter session. People aware of the details said the Centre is keen to get the bills passed, but it is not yet clear whether it will do so during the winter session or call a special session. "The government has reached out to several parties and we are confident that this time the government will have more than what (votes) is required to pass the bill," said a person cited above. →P10

{ WORLD } GUNMAN KILLS HIMSELF

1 dead, 4 injured in Washington shooting

A shooter killed one person and injured several others before turning the gun on himself in America's capital, a short distance from the White House. According to law enforcement, another shooting victim is in critical condition while three others have suffered non-life threatening injuries. The shooting took place around a gym in the Logan circle neighbourhood, following which the assailant barricaded himself in an apartment above the gym. "The suspect was in litigation recently with his building owner. And we believe the suspect went into Vida Fitness to target the building owner and shoot him and kill him, which he did," city council member Brooke Pinto told local media. Law enforcement authorities said police communicated with the assailant for an hour before hearing a gunshot from inside an apartment. →P16

{ MY DELHI } HC AFFIDAVIT FILED IN SC

Delhi fast track courts take 4 yrs to clear rape, Pocso cases

It takes an average of four years for a fast track court (FTC) set up in the Capital to dispose cases of rape or sexual offences involving minors under the Protection of children from sexual offences (Pocso) Act, a report filed by the Delhi high court in the Supreme Court has revealed. The affidavit by the Delhi high court registrar general Reetesh Singh was filed on November 4 in a suo motu petition over recent rape incidents in the Capital. Giving a comprehensive report on the functioning of the 23 fast track courts (FTC), 31 special courts, and seven other courts handling rape cases, the high court stated that despite more than 10,000 cases being disposed in the past three years (2023-25), the total pendency of cases in these courts is 15,890. The Pocso FTC courts required an average of 1,720 days (approximately 4 years and seven months) for final disposal of cases. At the same time, the FTC for rape cases require an average time of 1,533 days (4 years and 2 months), and FTC for sexual assault cases require 1,493 days (4 years), the affidavit said. →P8

{ WORLD } TRUMP DIRECTS VANCE

'No Iran deal needed, focus on own issues'

President Donald Trump said on Thursday the US does not need a deal with Iran and directed Vice President JD Vance, who has played a role in efforts to resolve the war, to focus "his complete and total attention" on alleged crime and corruption in Democratic-run cities and states. Trump's directive came a day after the Wall Street Journal reported that Vance was considering face-to-face peace talks with a hard-line Iranian security official and a week after the vice president blamed the costly war with Iran for Republicans' midterm elections drubbing. "We don't need a deal with Iran. Those days have long since passed. We've got their money...and we've got their Strait!" Trump wrote on social media. Trump said he asked Vance to focus instead on a domestic issue: leading an effort targeting alleged fraud in Democratic-run cities and states. REUTERS

{ MY INDIA } IN SEPARATE ATTACKS

1 woman killed, 3 injured in Manipur

A 40-year-old woman farmer was killed and two others injured after unidentified armed people opened fire at farmers working in a paddy field in Senapati district of violence-hit Manipur on Thursday, police said. In a separate incident, a 52-year-old Naga community member was injured in a firing incident in Ukhrul. The first attack took place around 11am in Taphou Kuki village. The deceased, Kimneineng Chongloi, died at the spot, while two other farmers, Sehngam Chongloi alias David and Lamkhochon Chongloi, sustained bullet injuries. "All the victims belonged to Kuki communities. Who were involved and what were their motives behind the attack is yet to be ascertained," a senior police officer aware of the matter said. A case was registered at Senapati police station. In the second incident, armed people opened fire on farmers in Sinakeithei village in Ukhrul. Village guards retaliated, triggering an exchange of fire. →P11

RUSSIA'S PUTIN LETS EUROPE JOIN UKRAINE PEACE DISCUSSIONS

Reuters
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MOSCOW: President Vladimir Putin agreed on Thursday to let European representatives join the next round of Ukraine peace talks, a US envoy said, though the Russian leader said Washington must work with its European allies to understand if they want peace or war in Ukraine.

The move to give Europe a seat at the negotiating table at the next round of talks, which US envoy Steve Witkoff announced after the talks, could mark a breakthrough. "The Europeans will join at the next meeting, which we consider to be a very important moment because they are our partners and it's important to us that they take part," Witkoff told Russian state TV after meeting Putin.

But in a sign of renewed tensions, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said new restrictions were affecting the US-made satellite communications Kyiv uses on the battlefield, and that he found the US approach of discussing a new European security order with Russia "a bit strange".

Zelenskiy said disruptions to the Starshield satellite communications service were significant, however, affecting the entire front line and Russian-controlled parts of Ukraine. Starshield is the military version of SpaceX's Starlink satellite communications service, and Ukraine suffered similar disruptions last month. In a post on Telegram, he said that systemic restrictions were limiting the speed at which Starshield could be used. As a result, Ukrainian interceptors could not reach sufficient speed to down Russian jet-powered drones, he said. SpaceX declined to comment.

{ PART 2 }

How Nvidia, Huang fit into US-China AI race

Roshan Kishore, Abhishek Jha and Shreya Khandelwal
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NEW DELHI: The first part of this series discussed Nvidia's rise as one of the most valuable companies in the world and how it matters for the larger AI economic story. The concluding part will bring in the geopolitical in the economic AI story, largely the Sino-US competition.

China has won the trade war, can it also win the AI war?

2026 will be the second consecutive year when China will post a trade surplus above a trillion dollars. This kind of mercantile dominance is unprecedented in the world. China today, is not just the cheap factory of the world, like it was a few decades back. It controls some of the most cutting-edge technology and manufacturing processes in the world, so much so that even European and American giants in many sectors are now lagging.

Even on AI, as was shown in an HT analysis of a Carnegie China report, China is catching up pretty fast with the US in terms of the skilled workforce in the sector. The world realised this even before the Carnegie China report came, when China released DeepSeek-R1– an open-source reasoning model – in January 2025, bringing it within striking distance of all leading frontier AI developers, all of whom are based in the US.

A recently published report by Lowy Institute also shows that Chinese models are catching up fast with American models despite the US having a lead over China in every AI field except human resource. *(See Chart 1)*

But China still needs advanced chips for its AI push

Jensen Huang has been seen as a villain by many US hawks because he has also been a votary of the relaxing restrictions on sale of Nvidia chips to China.

The latest controversy around his extra marital affair and the allegations of Alice Huang being an alleged Chinese spy have only added to the hawkish views around Huang, who resigned as Nvidia chief executive on Thursday. China, on expected lines, has downplayed the controversy and denied the allegations of any kind of spying.

While a lot of commentators argue that China does not really need Nvidia's chips – the actual evidence is anything but clear – an HT analysis of trade data shows that unlike in most things, China does show a rising import dependence in commodities which are likely GPUs or related products. This is where Nvidia, both in terms of its chip supplies and technical know-how in terms of any alleged corporate espionage via Huang himself being compromised, becomes important. *(See Chart 2)*

NUMBER THEORY

The AI race as of now is contingent on the US and China solving their respective supply constraints first

The easiest way to describe the US and China trying to derail or constrain each other's progress in the AI race is the US trying to restrict China's access to cutting edge chips/GPUs and China limiting the supply of rare earth minerals to the US. Both sides perhaps know that the constraints will cease to matter in the long-term but they hope to crack the challenge before they become redundant.

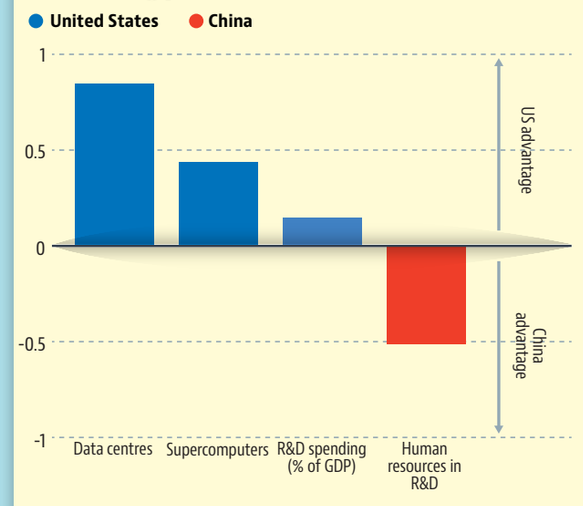
"Washington has imposed numerous restrictions on both China and Chinese subsidiaries abroad, which has, in turn, spurred affected companies to innovate around them. In May 2026, Huawei announced a new chip-design approach intended to increase transistor density without shrinking transistors. This could allow it to design chips by 2031 with transistor density equivalent to that of the chips Taiwan's TSMC aims to make in 2028, but without the advanced lithography machines China is barred from importing. If successful, this could limit the effect of US export controls", the Lowy Institute report says.

The US, on the other hand, launched the Pax Silica alliance in December 2025 which will ease its access to rare earth minerals. Beijing countered the move with World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization (WAICO) earlier this year. All these are independent of Huang's affair but the disclosure of the latter is certain to add more paranoia in the US AI eco system vis-à-vis fears of a Chinese catch-up in the biggest technological battle of our age. *(See Map 1)*

PART 1: What happens in Nvidia, will not stay in Nvidia

CHART 1

Technology index score



Source: Lowy Institute Asia Power Index. Recreated from Lowy Institute AI data snapshot, Figure 4.

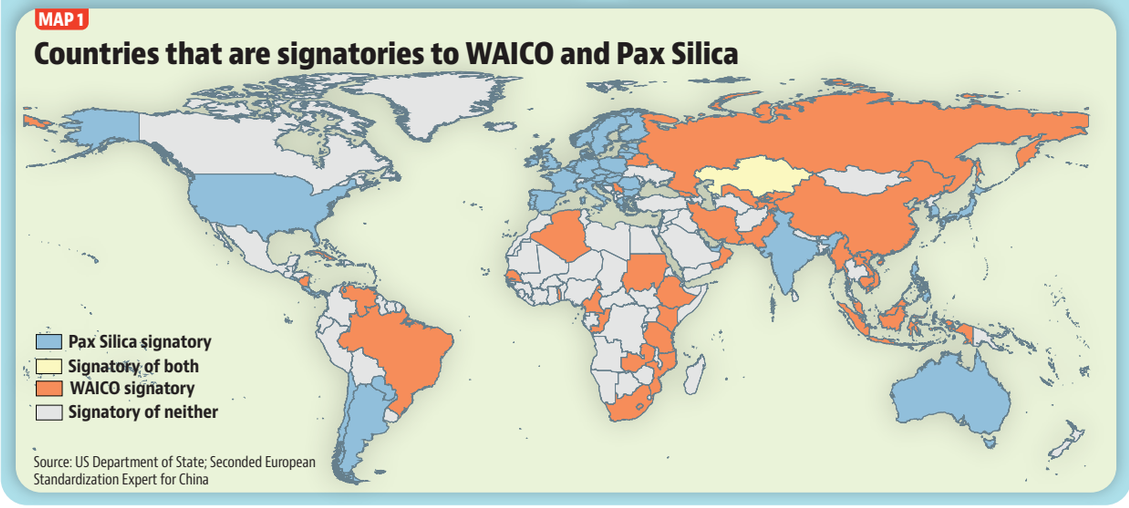
CHART 2

China's trade balance in AI infrastructure
(in billion $)

AI infrastructure here includes: Chips (processors incl GPUs), Other Automatic Data Processing units, servers, GPU modules/cards and other boards, and network swiches as captured in HS codes 854231, 847180, 847150, 847330, and 851762.
Source: UN Comtrade

MAP 1

Countries that are signatories to WAICO and Pax Silica



Source: US Department of State; Seconded European Standardization Expert for China

Solapur farmers turn to Mumbai for jobs amid drought

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MUMBAI: At 12.15am, while most of Mumbai was asleep, 65-year-old Moroddin Hussain was waiting for a truck loaded with vegetables to arrive at the Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC) market in Vashi. For the past few weeks, the farmer from Akkalkot tehsil in Solapur district has been spending his nights unloading vegetable trucks instead of looking after his three-acre farm back home.

For Hussain, this has been one of the worst agricultural years. He spent nearly ₹16,000 to ₹17,000 on sunflower seeds and hired a tractor to prepare his field. But with little or no rain, his crop dried up, leaving him with nothing to harvest.

"I heard from people in my village that several farmers from our tehsil were coming to Mumbai to look for work. So, I also decided to come here. Whenever I get work, I earn ₹700 a day," he said, struggling to hold back his tears. His children work as masons in the village, and the family is trying to manage its expenses with whatever little they earn.

Hussain is among 40 to 50 farmers from Solapur district affected by drought who have come to work as daily wage labourers at the Vashi APMC market. Dependent on their farms for their livelihood, these farmers are now unloading vegetable trucks to support their families. With crops failing and little work available in their villages, many have been forced to leave their homes in search of employment.

While ministers were visiting homes of drought-hit farmers to celebrate Diwali with them, several others from the same farming community are spending the festival away from their families, working in Mumbai to make ends meet.

"Drought has been declared in all 11 tehsils of Solapur district. Many farmers from the district are coming here looking for work, and several others have called me asking if they can also come," said Kishor Chavan, a supervisor (mukadam) who brings workers from his village to the APMC market.

PICK OF THE DAY

Chavan himself has been coming to the market for the past few years whenever rainfall is poor in his village. However, this year, the situation is worse. The poor harvest has also affected the number of vegetable trucks arriving at the market, reducing the work available for labourers. "Workers are paid only for the days they get work. The number of people contacting me this year has almost doubled. I have had to tell many of them not to come because there is not enough work for everyone. Some have started looking for other kinds of daily wage jobs as well," he said. Chavan added that agricultural incomes in the district have remained low for the past three years, affecting the earnings of farming families. He, too, could not return to his village for Diwali.

Mohammad Mujar, who has been working at the APMC market for the past 20 years, said the farmers arriving from Solapur were in a desperate situation. Most own three to six acres of land, but their fields have produced little or nothing this year. "They have no crops to sell and no work available in their villages. They come here and earn ₹700 a day. After spending money on food and accommodation, they send whatever they can save to their families. The situation is very difficult. Even here, we are finding it hard to provide work to everyone," he said.

The scale of the crisis is reflected in the rainfall figures. All 11 tehsils of Solapur district -- North Solapur, South Solapur, Barshi, Akkalkot, Mohol, Madha, Karmala, Pandharpur, Sangola, Malshiras and Mangalwedha -- have been affected by drought.

According to a report by a local official, the district has recorded a rainfall deficit of around 58% compared with its average, one of the highest in the state.

Sangola has recorded a 52% deficit, while Mohol has received only 193.2mm of rainfall. The shortage of rain has also affected groundwater levels.

Compared with the 2015 drought, 47% more wells in the district have recorded a fall in water levels. Several villages are now dependent on water tankers to meet their drinking water needs.

The local government report also highlighted that both Kharif and Rabi crops have suffered. The lack of moisture in the soil has also raised concerns about the sowing of Rabi jowar, an important crop for the region.

For 27-year-old Shivsharma Koli, coming to Mumbai to work as a labourer was something he had never imagined. He owns six acres of farmland where he had grown sunflower and tur dal. However, the crops failed, leaving him without an income.

"For the first time in my life, I have had to take up manual labour. My parents and wife are back home, and there was no work available in the village. So, I came here a month ago," he said. Koli earns ₹700 on days when he gets work and stays in a rented room in Turbhe, for which he pays ₹2,000 a month. "After spending on food and other expenses I try to send as much money home as possible. My family depends on me, and I have to support them," he said.

Mehboob Kheraj, 43, who owns six acres of farmland, has also come to Mumbai after losing his crops. He had grown sugarcane and tur on his land but received almost nothing from the harvest. With a family of eight to support and children pursuing college education, he said the situation had become difficult to manage.

"We are entirely dependent on farming. With no rain this year, we have suffered huge losses. We had no other option but to come here and work as labourers," he said. Kheraj said this was the third consecutive year of agricultural losses for his family. While excessive rainfall affected the crops last year and poor rainfall affected production the year before, this year the family has been left with almost nothing. "At least in the previous two years, we managed to get some harvest. This year, there is nothing. Many farmers in our village are facing the same situation," he said.

Solapur district officials said the government plans to provide employment to farmers under the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin).

The growing migration of farmers from Solapur to Mumbai and Pune is also worrying academics.

Prabhakar Kolekar, associate professor of sociology at Punyashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar Solapur University, said the scale of migration this year is much higher than in previous years.

"The drought situation in Solapur is very serious. Many people are moving towards Pune and Mumbai in search of work. Those looking for short-term employment generally go to Pune and find work in construction, while those seeking longer-term employment move to Mumbai," he said.

Kolekar said migration from the district was not new. Educated youth often move to cities such as Hyderabad, Bengaluru and Pune for jobs, while skilled workers migrate to Mumbai and Pune. However, the movement of farmers who have land of their own to other cities for daily wage work is a worrying development.

He added that some educated youngsters who had returned to farming after working for two to four years were now going back to formal jobs because of repeated agricultural losses.

"This is a major loss for the district. Agriculture is the main source of livelihood for most people here. If agro-based industries are set up in the district, people will have more employment opportunities and will not have to migrate to other cities," he said.

Kolekar warned that if the situation did not improve, the migration of farmers this year could become permanent, given the scale of their losses.

The Punyashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar Solapur University has decided to study the impact of the drought across the district. The university has asked colleges in different areas to assess the situation in their respective regions and submit information.

"We want to understand the ground situation in different parts of the district and prepare a report based on the information collected by the colleges," said university vice-chancellor Prakash Mahanvar.

Considering the existing drought situation, the government plans to provide employment to as many people as possible under the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar & Ajeevika Mission (Gramin), said Solapur district collector S Karthikeyan.

The scheme will be implemented from December 1. "It will include drought-related works such as tree plantation, deepening of wells and other water conservation activities to provide local employment to people," said Karthikeyan.

Solapur-based farmer Moroddin Hussain, 65, carries a sack of vegetables after unloading it from a truck at the APMC market in Vashi on Thursday. RAJU SHINDE/HT PHOTO

MY DELHI

{ SONIA VIHAR }

Woman miscarries, two die as truck crushes auto

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NEW DELHI: When 25-year-old Rakhi, who was nine months pregnant, complained of labour pain on Thursday morning, her husband hailed the first autorickshaw he could find outside their home in northeast Delhi's Sonia Vihar.

Minutes later, a truck rammed into the three-wheeler, killing two men and injuring Rakhi and her husband Raja. It was only after she was taken to Rajiv Gandhi Super Specialty Hospital that her family learnt that her unborn child had not survived."Rakhi is in critical condition. Raja, too, is injured and under treatment. We have not been able to gather the courage to inform Rakhi that her baby is no more... We don't even know if she will survive," said Reena, 34, Raja's sister. Rakhi is currently on life support in the hospital's neurology department.

The crash also left five people injured, including Rakhi's husband, Raja, and a six-month-old girl. The two men killed were the autorickshaw driver and a passenger.

Around 5am, the four-seater autorickshaw, which was carrying eight people, was hit head-on by a truck on Pushta Road. A police officer investigating the case suspects fog may have contributed to the collision.

"The autorickshaw was going towards Chauhan Patti from Sabhapur and the truck was coming from the other side. It was a head-on collision on Pushta Road. Because the Yamuna is on both sides of the road, there was fog around 5am when the incident took place," the officer said, adding that the truck driver fled after the crash.

Deputy commissioner of police (northeast) Rahool Alwal said police received a call about the accident at 5.09am. "Eight injured persons, including five men, two women and a six-month-old girl, were taken to Jag Pravesh Chandra Hospital, where two men were declared dead on arrival," he said.

What happened?

THURSDAY, 5AM: An autorickshaw carrying 8 people was travelling from Sabhapur towards Chauhan Patti when a truck rammed into it head-on on Pushta Road.

2 KILLED
Autorickshaw driver Pramod Chaurasia, 40, and passenger Satbir Singh, 32, died.

6 INJURED
Five men, a woman and a six-month-old girl were taken to hospital. Nine-month-pregnant Rakhi, 25, and Akshay Sharma, 35, were critical.

Baby lost
Rakhi's unborn child did not survive. She remains on life support.

Truck driver fled
Police suspect fog may have contributed to the crash and are searching for the driver.

The deceased were identified as Satbir Singh, 32, a passenger, and autorickshaw driver Pramod Chaurasia, 40. The injured included Satbir's wife, Moni Singh, 30; Rakhi and her husband, Raja; and Rameshwar Dayal, 45, and Akshay Sharma, 35. The six-month-old girl was also among those taken to hospital.

All the injured were subsequently admitted to Rajiv Gandhi Super Specialty Hospital. While the others were out of danger, Rakhi and Sharma were critical, doctors at the hospital said.

Sharma's brother, Deepu Sharma, 25, said Akshay and Chaurasia were friends and drove the autorickshaw together, sitting next to each other. "Akshay left home around 7.30pm. He and Chaurasia would often get drunk and fight. I don't know if they were drunk at the time of the incident or who was driving," he said, adding that his brother had remained unconscious since the crash.

Deepu alleged that the police did not inform the family about the accident. He said locals told him around noon that an accident had taken place on Pushta Road, following which he went to the police station to check.

Rakhi's sister-in-law Reena said the couple married in July 2024 and have a one-year-old son. "We truly hope she survives because her son is very small. He will not be able to live without his mother," she said.

The family also raised concerns about the medical facilities available at the hospital. "I have to pump for oxygen support manually because they don't have the required equipment. They said that she needs to be put on ventilator support, but they are waiting for it," Reena said.

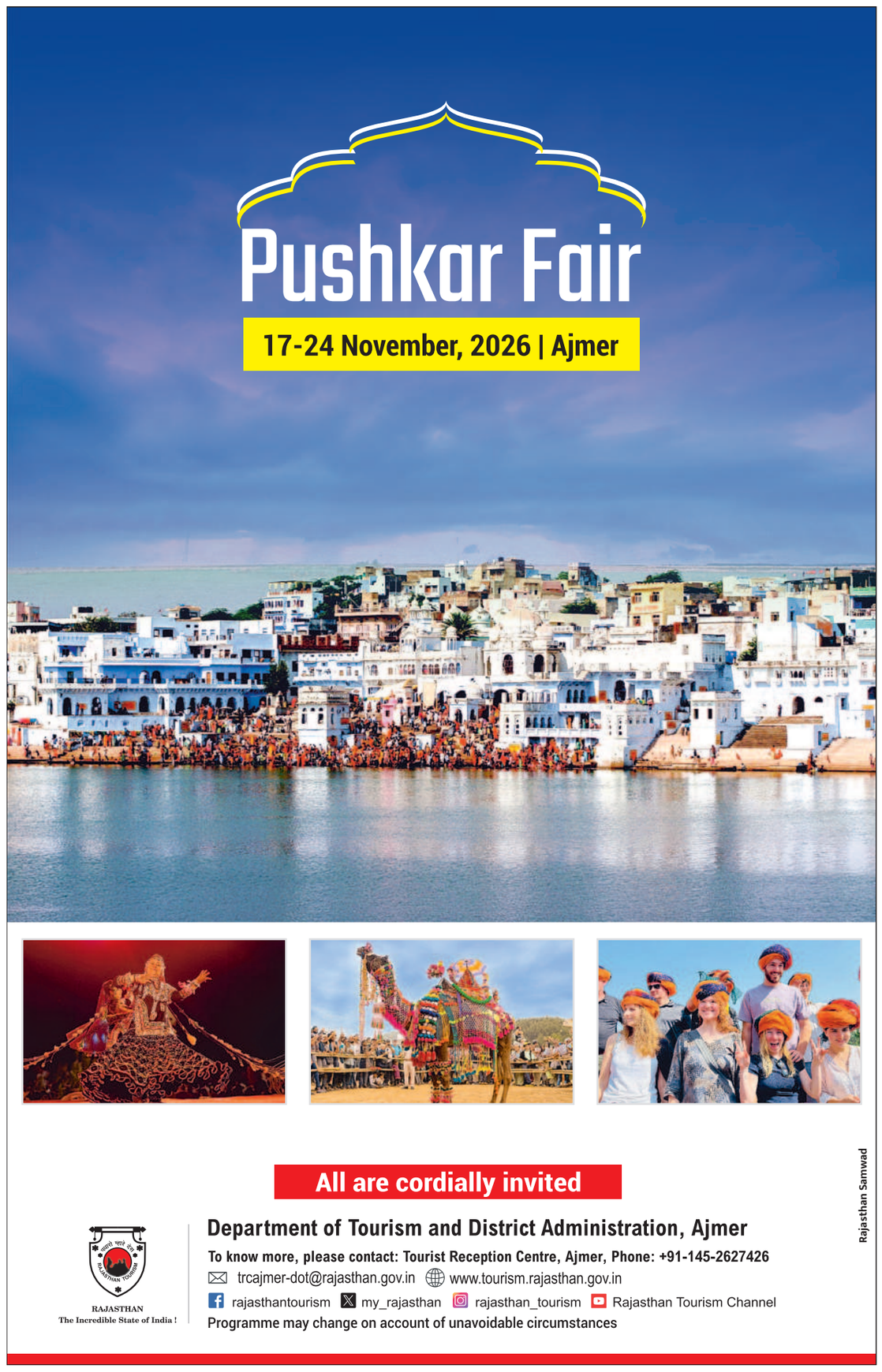
Officials at Rajiv Gandhi Hospital did not respond to HT's request for comment.

Satbir's wife, Moni, suffered injuries to her lips that required stitches and fractures in both legs. By Thursday afternoon, she had not been informed about her husband's death.

The couple lived with their infant daughter in Chauhan Patti. Satbir worked at a polythene manufacturing factory in Tronica City.

The family had gone to their village in Kasganj and were returning home when the accident occurred. Their six-month-old daughter suffered head compression. "They are now left to fend for themselves. We will take them back to the village," said Satbir's brother-in-law, Dharambir Singh, 41.

Police said they had registered a case on charges of causing death by negligence and were searching for the truck driver.



Delhi chokes as PM2.5 hits 4 times safe limit

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NEW DELHI: Delhi's air turned sharply more toxic on Thursday, with the concentration of PM2.5 across the city more than doubling in 24 hours to 244 micrograms per cubic metre by 6pm, four times the national standard, as a thick, smoky haze that usually thins by afternoon stayed trapped over the Capital in warm, damp and almost motionless air.

Two things closed in on the city at once, an HT analysis of official pollution and weather data showed. The dome of air in which Delhi's pollution mixes and thins shrank to about 400 metres high on Thursday afternoon, from 1,400 metres two days earlier; and the north-westerly that carries smoke from the farm fires of Punjab and Haryana, slack since Diwali, was blowing above the city again at 34 km/h.

The Central Pollution Control Board's (CPCB) air quality index (AQI) for Delhi, a rolling average of the previous 24 hours, climbed from 313 at 2am to 366 by 6pm, gaining seven to eight points an hour through the afternoon. At 10pm, it reached 387 -- 74 points higher than the 24 hours before it. In all, 21 of the 58 stations reporting were in the "severe" zone, above 400, by then, against one on Wednesday evening and none on Tuesday.

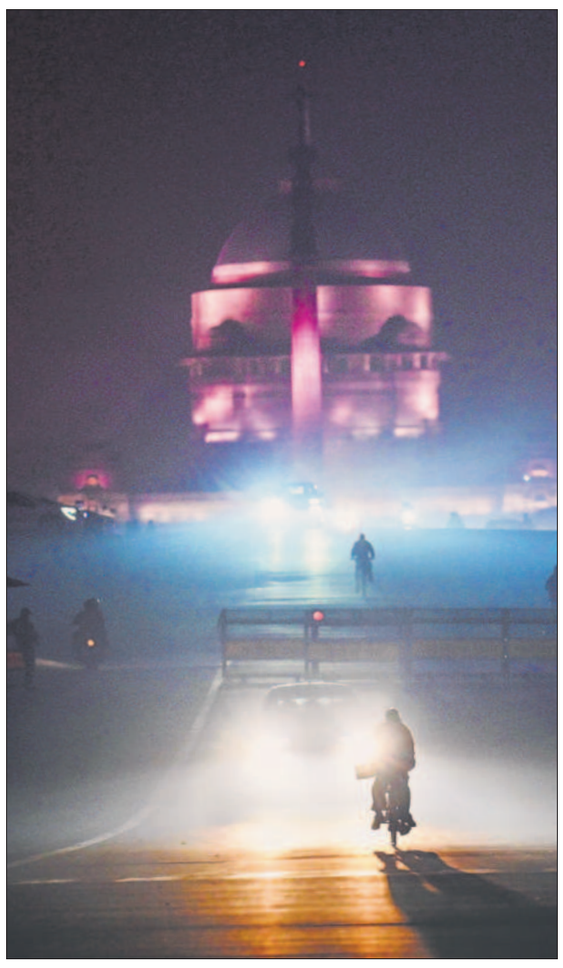
The index for the day stood at 350, or "very poor", in CPCB's 4pm bulletin, up from 313 on Wednesday and 299 on Tuesday.

The weather meant that the afternoon – which typically brings some relief from high pollution every day – did not see a cleaning that's routine.

HT records this conditions on its realtime air quality dashboard at hindustantimes.com/breathe.

For instance, at 4pm on Wednesday, PM2.5, the fine particles that lodge deep in the lungs, had fallen to 92. It then crossed 200 by 1am --- pollutants typically gather at night --- and stayed near 220 through the morning. In the hours it usually drops, it instead rose further: to 224 at 2pm, 232 at 3pm and 239 at 4pm.

The deterioration was citywide. On Wednesday evening, 44 of 58 stations had recorded PM2.5 below 120 and only one 200 or more; but by Thursday evening, 43 of 56 stations were at 200 or more and three were below 120. (See Chart 1)



A heavy layer of smog shrouds Rashtrapati Bhavan and vehicles on Kartavya Marg on Thursday. RAJ K RAJ/HT PHOTO

AIR WE BREATHE

At the Safdarjung airfield, which reported smoke in the air at 2.30pm, visibility fell to 800 metres by 3.30pm, with the temperature at 29°C. At 2.30pm on Wednesday it had been 2,500 metres.

The India Meteorological Department's forecast suggests offers little relief in the days ahead, with no rain through forecast and surface winds expected to be in 5-10 km/h in the mornings and evenings over the next three days. The first stronger afternoon wind, of 15-20 km/h, is not expected until the weekend.

The dome

Delhi's pollution builds through the night and falls by mid-afternoon, as the sun warms the ground and the air near it rises and mixes with cleaner air above. How high it rises sets the depth of the mixing layer, the dome of air into which everything the city emits is diluted.

The India Meteorological Department's (IMD) weather balloon, launched from Safdarjung at 4.30pm, measured that layer at about 400 metres on Thursday. It had been about 700 metres high on Wednesday and 1,400 metres on Tuesday, so the dome lost more than two-thirds of its height in two days.

In HT's record of the balloon's readings over six winters, the layer is usually about 1,300 metres deep in early November and about 600 metres in the first half of January, its shallowest fortnight. No November afternoon in 2022 or 2024 had a layer as shallow as Thursday's.

The wind inside the dome weakened too, to an average of 8 km/h against a usual 13 km/h. Together, the layer's depth and the wind through it decide how much air is available to dilute pollution. By that measure, called ventilation, Thursday was 84% below Tuesday, at about a fifth of the usual for early November and less than half of the usual for early January. (See Chart 2)

The air was also far more humid. The dew point, the temperature at which moisture in the air condenses, was 23°C at 2.30pm, against 19°C on Wednesday and 15°C on Tuesday.

The feed

Above the dome, the wind changed direction. Smoke from the fields travels to Delhi on a north-westerly 1 km to 3 km above the ground, and the balloon launched at 4.30am on Thursday measured that wind at 34 km/h between 1 km and 2 km up, blowing from the north-west at every level up to 3 km.

It had dropped to 5 km/h on November 9 and 10, and blew from the north at 21 km/h on Wednesday. (See Chart 3)

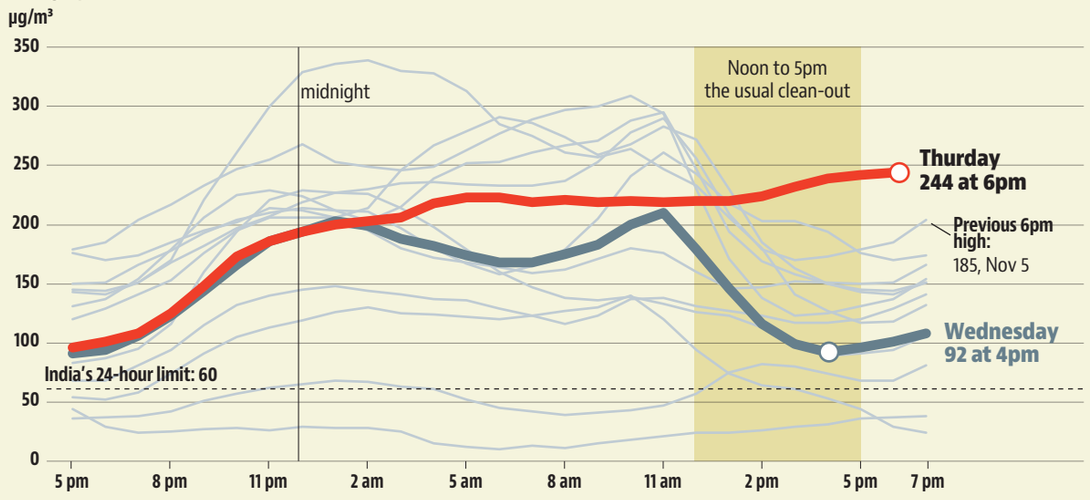
Sunil Dahiya, founder and lead analyst at think-tank Envirocatalysts, said: "Today Delhi had two problems at once. Overnight, smoke from crop-residue fires in Punjab and Haryana drifted in from the north-west. Monitors in Panipat and Bahadurgarh spiked first, and Delhi rose a few hours later. Then the weather failed to clear it."

"Tomorrow should bring less new smoke but will stay very poor. Real relief needs stronger winds, which models expect only by Saturday," he added.

CHART 1

Delhi's air usually clears by late afternoon. On Thursday, it kept getting worse

PM2.5 hour by hour, averaged across Delhi's monitoring stations, from 5pm one day to 7pm the next. Each grey line is one such stretch since Oct 28.



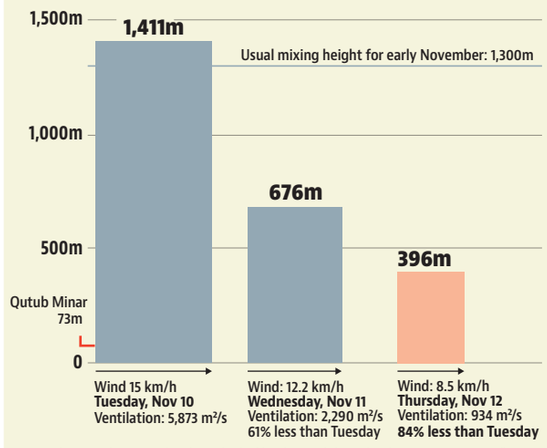
Micrograms per cubic metre, mean of the hourly readings at all Delhi stations reporting (56-58); each hour is labelled at its end. The stretch that began on Diwali evening (Nov 8), which peaked at 1,179, is off the scale and left out. Thursday's line runs to 6pm; Wednesday is the darker grey line.

Source: Central Pollution Control Board, hourly station data. HT analysis

CHART 2

The air available to dilute Delhi's pollution shrank by 84% in two days

Each box is drawn to scale from the 4.30pm weather balloon: its height is how high pollution mixed above the city, its width the speed of the wind through that layer.



Ventilation is the mixing height multiplied by the wind through it (in metres per second), so each box's area is in proportion to it. Mixing height: the first level at which the balloon finds air 1°C warmer than at the ground, after allowing for height. Buildings at the foot of each box are illustrative; the orange mark on the scale is the height of the Qutub Minar.

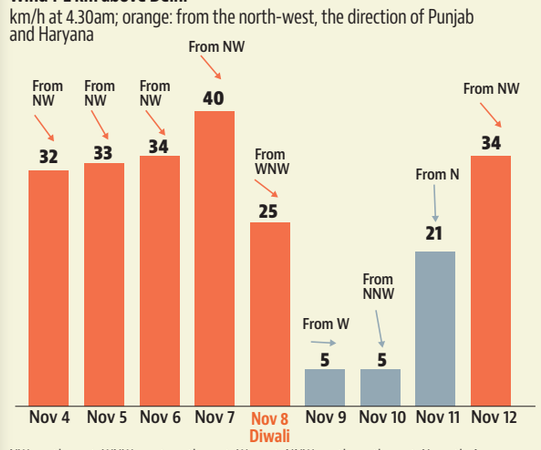
Source: IMD weather balloon, Safdarjung (University of Wyoming archive). HT analysis

CHART 3

The wind from the farm-fire belt is blowing over Delhi again

Speed of the wind 1-2 km above Delhi at 4.30am, the height at which smoke from the fields of Punjab and Haryana travels, and the direction it blew from.

Wind 1-2 km above Delhi
km/h at 4.30am; orange: from the north-west, the direction of Punjab and Haryana



NW: north-west. WNW: west-north-west. W: west. NNW: north-north-west. N: north. Arrows point the way the wind was blowing. Measured by weather balloon; the average of all levels between 1 km and 2 km above the ground. The chart shows the wind's speed and direction; it does not measure the farm fires' share of Delhi's PM2.5.

Source: IMD weather balloon, Safdarjung (University of Wyoming archive). HT analysis

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of female **Name:** Unknown **W/o** Unknown **R/o** Unknown **Age:** About 55-60 years **Height:** 5.5 feet, **Face:** Oval, **Built**: Normal, **Complexion:** Shallow, **Injury Mark:** Injury on face due to accident, wearing red colour suit-salwar was found at Outer Ring Road due to accident brought to Trauma Centre, Civil Line, Delhi, where doctor declared her dead on 02.10.2026. **FIR No. 363/26 u/s 281/106 Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita has been registered on 02.11.2026 at P.S. Darya Ganj, New Delhi.**

Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address or telephone numbers.

SHO - P.S. Darya Ganj, New Delhi.
Tel. No. 011-23274683, 6395706712

DP/16367/CD/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that this Female **Named:** Gulabo Devi, **W/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** 61 years, **Sex:** Female, **Height:** 4'6", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Built:**Thin, **Face:**Oval, **Wearing:** Blue colour Kurta & Lower was found abandoned and was shifted to Apna Ghar Ashram, Village Budhpur, Delhi by Ashram Staff, **Place of Recovery:** She was suffering from an illness and was admitted to SRHC Hospital, Narela, Delhi, by Ashram Staff for treatment Delhi on Date 08.11.2026 and during the treatment, Dr. declared brought her dead. In this regard **DD No. 08A, Dated: 08.11.2026,** has been registered at **P.S.: Alipur, Delhi**.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about identity of this female but no clue has come to light so far. If any person having any information or clue about this female may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S.: Alipur, Delhi
Ph.: 9871935343, 7065036325

DP/16317/ON/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that a male (depicted in the photo) Namely: **Unknown, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown** was found dead with **face/head injured/crushed on the footpath, back side of Delhi Jal Board, Opp. New Field Advg. Pvt. Ltd. Building, Near Turkman Gate, Asaf Ali Road, New Delhi on 29.10.2026 at 5.47 P.M.** In this regard vide **FIR No.359/2026 Dated 29.10.2026 U/S 103(1) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023** has been registered at **P.S Daryaganj, Central District, Delhi-110002.**

The description of the deceased is given as below:

Name: Unknown, **Sex:** Male, **Age:** About 30-35 Years, **Height:** 5'5", **Complexion:** Wheatish/Shallow, **Injury/Identification Mark:** Face/Head Injured/Crushed, Tattoo of Name **"ARJUN"** on Right Forearm, **Wearing:** Multi colored Printed Shirt (Brown, Purple, White) bearing Label **H&M** Red Colored Sleeves Jacket with GANT inscribed on Front Chest and **"GANT STATE UNIVERSITY"** in white on Back Black Pants (Torn Slightly on below the Knees) with Black Belt and Red Colored Slipper on Right Foot.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to identify the man but no clue has come to light so far. Anyone having information about the person, please inform the undersigned.

SHO
P.S Daryaganj, Delhi-110002
Ph.: 8750870421

DP/ 16406/CD/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that one male person (depicted in the photo) namely **Unknown** residence and family is **Unknown** about **65 years** of age was found dead at **Front of C-33, Subhash Park, Netaji Road, Adrash Nagar, Delhi** on **Dated 08.11.2026** at approx. **07:30 PM.** In this regard a **DD No. 79A, Dated 08.11.2026** has been lodged at **PS Adarsh Nagar, Delhi**.

His physical description is as under:-

Sex: Male, **Age:** 65 years**, Height:** 5'2" ft., **Complexion:** Shallow, **Face:** Long, **Built:** Thin, **Wearing:** White Colour T-shirt and Red Lining, White Colour Half Lower and Hawai Sleeper in his feet.

Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address:-

SHO
PS: Adarsh Nagar, Delhi
Ph.: 011-27672452, 27674452
Mob.: 8750870229

DP/16379/NW/2026 (UIDB)

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that one Person (depicted in the photo) namely **Unknown** residence & family is **Unknown** has been found dead at **Studio Apartment Gate No. 2, Sec-16B, Dwarka, Delhi on 22.10.2026 at 01:30 AM.** In this regard a **FIR No./DD No. 09A, Dated 22.10.2026** has been lodged at **PS Dwarka North, Delhi.** His physical description is as under:-

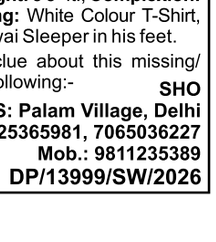
Sex: Male, **Age:** About 28 years**, Height:** 5'2" ft., **Complexion:** Shallow, **Face:** Oval, **Built:** Medium, **Identification Mark:** One Snake & Trishul Tattoo on Chest and Two Tattoo of Snake & one Tattoo of OM on Right Hand, **Wearing:** Yellow Colour Round Neck Half T-Shirt and Blue Colour Jeans.

Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address:-

SHO
PS: Dwarka North, Delhi
Ph.: 9810941545
Mobile: 8750871022

DP/16347/DW/2026 (UIDB)

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION



Rajan

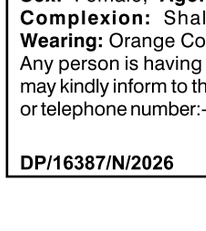
The general public is hereby informed that a Male whose name is **Rajan** S/o Vishawnath Pratap Singh and residence is unknown, whose age was about 38 years was found dead at Safdarjung Hospital. In this regard, an information has been lodged vide **DD No. 67A Dated 07.11.2026 at PS South Campus, New Delhi.** Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to identify the deceased person, but no clue has come to light, so far. The description of the UIDB is as under:

Name: Rajan, **Sex:** Male, **Age:** 38 Years, **Height:** 5'4" ft, **Complexion:** Fair, **Wearing:** White Shirt & Grey Pants, **Identification:** Mole on Neck. If anyone has any information about his relatives, kindly inform the SHO/ South Campus, New Delhi.

SHO
PS, South Campus, New Delhi
Ph. No. 9911538125

DP/16369/SW/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION



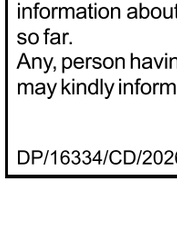
General public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of a male **Age:** Approx 65 Years, **Height:** 5'7", **Complexion:** Fair, **Injury Mark:** Head Injury and multiple injuries on hands and legs, was wearing White colour Kurta and Black colour Payjama, was found dead at Sadar Bazar Road, Near Shiv Mandir & Delhi Cantonment General Hopspital, Delhi Cantt. Delhi on 11.04.2026. In this regard a case **FIR No. 245/2026 dated 11.04.2026 U/s 281/106(1) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, has been registered at P.S. Delhi Cantt., Delhi.**

Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address or telephone numbers.

SHO
P.S. Delhi Cantt., Delhi
Ph.: 7065036229

DP/16341/SW/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION



General public is hereby informed that a male namely **Santosh, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown was found dead on 30.10.2026 From In Front of Tikona Park, Near Delhi Gate Daryaganj, Delhi.** In this regard **DD No. 37A, U/s: 194 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, Dated: 30.10.2026** has been lodged at Police Station **Daryaganj, Delhi.** The dead body has been preserved at Maulana Azad Medical College Mortuary for 72 hrs. Physical Description of male dead body is as under:

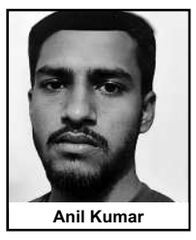
Name: Santosh, Age: About 35 Years, Height: 5'5", Complexion: Shallow, Built: Normal, Face: Round, ID Mark: Cut Right Eye Brow, Wearing: Check Shirt and Blue Colour Pant.

If anyone have any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be inform undersigned.

SHO
Police Station Daryaganj, Delhi
Ph.: 011-23274682, 8750870421

DP/16095/CD/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING



Anil Kumar

General public is hereby informed that a Male namely **Anil Kumar** R/o Village Ranipur PO Dampur Distt. Fatehpur, Uttar Pradesh has been missing from Shangrila Hotel Ashoka Road, Connaught Place, New Delhi. In this regard **FIR No. 305/26 Dated 07.11.2026 has been Lodged at PS Connaught Place, New Delhi.** Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to trace this Missing Male, but no clue has come to light, so far. The description of the Missing Male is as under:

Name: Anil Kumar, **Gender:** Male, **Age:** 28 years, **Height:** 5'7" ft, **Complexion:** Shallow, **Wearing:** Black Kurta and Brown Lower, **Identification:** Tattoo on both Hands. If anyone has any information regarding this Missing Male, kindly inform SHO/ Connaught Place, New Delhi.

E-mail : cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638, 24368641
Fax : 011-24368639
DP/16353/NDD/2026

SHO
PS, Connaught Place, New Delhi
Ph. No. 9868554433

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

AYUSH SAINI

General public is hereby informed that this Boy (depicted in the photo) namely **Ayush Saini S/o Surender Saini R/o F-878, Gali No. 18F, Sadh Nagar, Palam Colony, Delhi** has been missing / kidnapped from **her residence** since **23.09.2026 at 21.00 Hrs.** In this regard a **FIR No. 575/2026, Dated 26.09.2026** has been registered at **PS Palam Village, South West Dist, New Delhi**. Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out this Boy but no clue has come to light so far.

His physical description is as under:-

Sex: Male, **Age:** 18 years 11 months, **Height:** 5'5" ft., **Complexion:** Fair, **Face:** Oval, **Built:** Normal, **Wearing:** White Colour T-Shirt, Black Colour Lower and White Line Hawai Sleeper in his feet.

Any person is having information or clue about this missing/ kidnapped Boy may kindly inform to the following:-

SHO
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
PS: Palam Village, Delhi
E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-25365981, 7065036227
Tel. No.: 011-24368638/24368641
Mob.: 9811235389
Fax No.: 011-24368639
DP/13999/SW/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified female (depicted in the photo) **Name** Unknown **S/o** Unknown **R/o:** Unknown **Age** Approx 40-45 years. She was found dead In a Empty Plot, Adjoining Roshan Properties & Builders, 66 Futa Nala Road, Near Pump House, Tomar Colony, Burari, Delhi In this regard, **FIR No. 798/26, Dt. 10.11.2026, U/s: 103 (1) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023,** has been lodged at **P.S. Burari, Delhi.** Her physical description is as under.

Sex: Female, **Age:** Approx 40-45 years, **Height:** 5'2" **Complexion:** Shallow, **Face:** Long, **Built:** Normal, **Wearing:** Orange Colour Saree and Golden Colour Blouse. Any person is having information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address or telephone number:-

S.H.O
PS: Burari, Delhi
Ph No.: 9953745253, 8750870132

DP/16387/N/2026

Appeal for Identification

General Public is hereby informed that a male dead body **Name:** Ladu Kishor Sethi, **S/o** Panchanan Sethi, **R/o:** Shop No.29, Hog Market, Rajendra Place, New Delhi **Age**: About 60 years, **Height:** 5'8", **Built:** Thin, **Complexion:** Fair, **Wearing:** Blue Jeans he was found dead from Hog Market Tea Shop in Rajendra Place Delhi on 05.11.2026. In this regard, **DD No. 39A Dated 05.11.2026** has been lodged at PS Prasad Nagar, Delhi. Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about this male but no clue has come to light so far.

Any, person having any information or clue about this male may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S., Prasad Nagar, Delhi
Ph.: 011-25725652, 25751048
8750870432

DP/16334/CD/2026

CCTV shows F'bad man taunted neighbour he shot

Debashish Karmakar
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

GURUGRAM: The man accused of killing a Singapore-based executive in Faridabad last week over an argument regarding his dog was allegedly carrying a pistol with intentions to kill the victim and said "Diwali Mubarak" as he shot him, according to police officials and CCTV videos from the area on Thursday.

The accused, Mohan Sharma (42), allegedly shot dead his neighbour Paramjith Dhankhar (43) on November 6 in the stilt parking area of a residential building in Sector 21C. He was arrested a day later from Dealer Chowk in Ballabgarh. He was allegedly motivated by an argument over Sharma's German Shepherd puppy whom he had let defecate in a common area in the building and Dhankhar and his family objected to.

"He was already determined to kill Dhankhar due to which he had kept the licenced pistol ready in his trouser pocket and a fully-loaded spare magazine," said a crime branch official.

The CCTV footage accessed by HT showed the exact sequence of events, which start from the ground-floor where Dhankar and his family resided. The timestamped videos were verified by police as well as family members.

At 9pm, Sharma, who lives on the second floor with his wife and two children, arrived at main entrance of the building and requested that Dhankar remove his car in the stilt parking. The accused can be heard addressing him as "bhaiya" and "Dhankar sahab", the footage shows.

"This was virtually a trap and was meant to lure Dhankar downstairs," said the official quoted above.

Though Dhankhar resists at first, he eventually relents and heads to the parking lot with his son, the videos show.

Sharma, carrying a backpack which was later found to have another pistol and two more magazines with 50 live cartridges inside it, is seen pacing the stilt parking for several seconds in between with his right hand in the pocket of his trouser. He is later seen pulling out the licensed pistol which appeared to be concealed in the pocket.

As soon as Dhankhar arrives, Sharma begins an argument. As Dhankar is heard saying he doesn't want an argument, Sharma suddenly pulls out the pistol and opens fire while inches away from him.

Dhankhar attempts to escape by going towards the main road while his son runs upstairs. Sharma follows, shooting the victim in the back multiple times. In the meantime, Dhankhar's mother and wife reach the scene.

In one video, Sharma can be heard screaming "Diwali Mubarak" and addressing the victim's wife as a "widow".

"Come out you all... Today, I will kill you all," he is further heard saying.

Outside, on the road, Sharma empties his entire magazine onto the victim standing next to the latter's mother, who is trying to help her son. Sharma then loads his pistol with a new magazine. He then gets into a car parked outside and flees.

According to police, Dhankhar had sustained nine bullet injuries to his chest, back, and abdomen.

Dhankhar, who had returned home from Singapore on November 5, was a former business head of the Asia-Pacific region at Tech-Mahindra and was working as a senior vice-president of Vietnam-based firm FPT Software.

The dispute with Sharma had begun three months ago when he had let the dog defecate in the stilt parking and near the underground water storage tank. The victim and his family had raised objections multiple times.

Yashpal Yadav, public relations officer of Faridabad police, said, "Sharma will be produced before a court on Friday when his three-day police remand ends."

15 rounds fired, victim's family abused

Footage from CCTV cameras of the incident that took place on November 6 show the murder of Singapore-based Paramjith Dhankhar was premeditated, say police

WHAT COPS FOUND IN FOOTAGE

- Accused Mohan Sharma, with a backpack, was seen pacing the stilt parking for several seconds with his right hand in trouser pocket, where he concealed his licensed pistol
- As soon as Dhankhar came downstairs, Sharma entered into an argument with him and started firing
- As the victim lay bleeding, Sharma shouted "Diwali Mubharak"
- Sharma addressed the victim's wife as a "widow" when she tried to come to her husband's aid
- Cops say Sharma heard shouting "Come out you all... Today, I will kill you all..."

Delhi CEO to assess timeline for completing SIR process

Saloni Bhatia
saloni.bhatia@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: With the distribution of enumeration forms to voters whose names were left out of the draft electoral roll yet to begin, officials aware of the matter said on Thursday that the office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), Delhi, will review the timelines for the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise.

An official aware of the matter, asking not to be named, said the CEO's office would review whether the schedule required a further extension, either next week or closer to November 25, depending on the progress of the form distribution exercise.

"The process of distributing enumeration forms will begin next week as the ECINet software is being updated. booth-level officers (BLOs) have completed two rounds of reverification and are aware of the number of voters they will have to approach for filling enumeration forms," the official said.

Under the drive, each BLO will be required to contact around 300 voters whose names were deleted from the draft roll and facilitate the filling of enumeration forms. The exercise is expected to cover all such electors across Delhi before November 25, the extended deadline for filing claims and objections.

Meanwhile, over 300,000 applications seeking inclusion in Delhi's electoral roll have been received since August 31, when the claims and objections process under the SIR began, according to the latest bulletin issued by the CEO's office on Thursday.

A total of 304,352 Form-6 applications were received between August 31 and November 11, taking the total to 516,752. The bulletin recorded 549 Form-6A applications during the period, bringing the cumulative total to 1,900. It clocked 30,954 Form-7 applications, seeking deletion of names from the electoral rolls, taking the cumulative number of such applications stood at 82,425.

The CEO's office also received 111,516 Form-8 applications during the period—for correction of entries in the electoral roll or shifting of residence—taking the total to 372,284.

The claims and objections period, initially scheduled to end earlier, has been extended until November 25. Applications received by the deadline are to be disposed of by December 15, while the final electoral roll is scheduled to be published on December 22, the bulletin read.

As per the earlier schedule, the draft roll was set to be published on December 4. If the SIR dates will be extended again, it will be the sixth extension, said officials.

The fresh outreach exercise assumes significance as nearly 4.7 million voters were left out of the draft electoral roll published during the SIR process. Officials said BLOs would have to approach these voters individually and facilitate the submission of enumeration forms, giving them an opportunity to seek inclusion in the electoral roll.

The CEO's office has also urged eligible citizens to check their names in the draft electoral roll and submit Form-6 applications if they find their names missing.

Enumeration forms yet to be distributed

- Process expected to start next week
- Each BLO to contact 300 voters
- Depending on progress, CEO office will assess need for further extension
- November 25 is the current deadline
- 300,000+ applications received since August 31

Amit Shah, LG meet top Delhi Police officials

Union home minister Amit Shah held a high-level review meeting on law and order at the Delhi Police HQ on Thursday, with discussions focusing on women's safety, organised crime, arms smuggling among others. Delhi lieutenant governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu was also at the meeting. HT PHOTO

DU's annual report passed amid dissent

HT Correspondent
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi University's executive council passed its 103rd annual report for the 2025-26 academic session on Thursday, amid criticism from elected members over the university's increasing reliance on Higher Education Financing Agency (HEFA) loans.

Citing figures from the university's balance sheet, EC members alleged that growing dependence on debt could turn the institution from an autonomous, state-funded body into a debtor entity, paving the way for its commercialisation and eventual privatisation.

"The balance sheet of DU as March 31, 2026, reveals that this reliance on debt financing is a structural trend that fundamentally threatens DU's public character," the dissent note submitted by elected EC member Mithuraaj Dhusiya on November 12 stated. "While the ministry of education covers a 90% share of the principal repayment, the remaining 10% share will directly come from DU's 'internal receipts'. This obligation... will culminate in privatisation," the note read.

The dissent note highlighted that the university had an outstanding HEFA loan liability of approximately ₹161.36 crore as of March 31, 2026.

PROF OF SATYAWATI COLLEGE PUT ON LEAVE OVER SEXUAL HARASSMENT PLAINT

NEW DELHI: Delhi University's Satyawati College (Morning) has sent a professor on leave amid an ongoing investigation into a complaint of sexual harassment by a female student.

The college's Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) is probing the allegations of a female student accusing the professor of making inappropriate remarks.

The principal, professor Subhash Kumar Singh, refused to comment; however, a senior college official, requesting anonymity, confirmed the development.

The complaint was received by the student on November 2. "The professor has been sent on leave to ensure transparency in the probe, in view of the allegations, which are of a sensitive nature," the official said. HTC

{ GREEN CORNER } DUMP SITE TRANSFORMED

Tapas, the mini jungle: Ramanujan College's green edu initiative for 'hands-on' experience

Gargi Shukla
gargi.shukla@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Twenty-one-year-old Charulatha, who is pursuing a Bachelor's degree in environmental science at Delhi University's Ramanujan College, says she spends several hours every week observing the transformation of caterpillars into butterflies—not in a greenhouse or a park, but in a mini jungle set up on the college premises.

Students said that a 488-square-metre area, which was a dumping ground until three years ago, has been transformed into a living laboratory, following its ecological restoration by a college professor. The jungle, titled "Tapas", started in 2023 and consists of native tree species from the Aravalli range, including tropical deciduous trees and indigenous shrubs, carefully selected to support local biodiversity.

The site also features dedicated sections for butterflies, succulents, medicinal plants and dragonflies, and two ponds alongside an enclosure for rescued animals. "I believe green education is real education in today's time. We saw it as a great learning opportunity for our students so decided to financially back it," said professor Rajendra Kumar Pandey, the principal of Ramanujan College.

Shrishti Sahu, 22, an alumna of Ramanujan College's environmental science department, said the first few months were spent in improving soil quality. The experience, she said, offered valuable lessons in understanding the challenges of ecological restoration and building resilience.

"Initially, it was 5-6 of us students. We started with clearing the site of construction waste and improved soil quality. Then, we focused on structure and planted a few native species. I was tasked with the upkeep of the project; that's where I learnt the challenges that crop up once restoration is done," she said.

Students said the living laboratory offers them a hands-on learning experience.

"I am interested in butterflies, and their conversation. One day, I spotted a caterpillar in Tapas, and initiated the butterfly incubator. For nearly a month, I tracked its journey from a caterpillar to a butterfly in a controlled environment," said Charulata.

Gaurav Barhodiya, an assistant professor at the college who is the project in-charge and curator of Tapas, said the initiative follows a non-Miyawaki approach, focusing exclusively on native plant species.

"Besides on-ground learning, the site is used for conducting practical assessments from biodiversity analysis, bird and insert sampling, butterfly counts, and nocturnal moth survey. Zoology students of Sri Venkateswara and Ramjas College had visited the site for educational purpose, students enrolled in media course at College of Vocational Studies had come to see the site," said Barhodiya.

Gaurav Barhodiya, an assistant professor, is the curator of Tapas and leads student experiences. ARVIND YADAV/HT PHOTO

Terms and Conditions applied. *Approval of the loan is at the sole discretion of the financiers, and additional documentation may be required. *The interest rates, loan amount, down payment, tenure options, and EMI are based on the financier's assessment of the applicant's credit profile. *Some of the mentioned components of the scheme cannot be clubbed together. *The offers/features may be modified or withdrawn at any time without prior intimation. *Offer valid until 30th Nov 2026. #Up to 10% Instant Cashback (₹2000 - ₹10000) is available on all HMSI models for EMI transactions made using IDFC Bank Credit Cards (Tenure 6 months to 24 months). #The offer is valid on credit card transactions processed through Pine Labs machines only and is applicable for one transaction per card/order during the offer period. #The Instant Cashback offer is valid until 30th Nov 2026. Product shown in the picture may vary from actual product available in the market. Accessories shown in the picture are not part of standard equipment.

Honda Motorcycle & Scooter India Pvt. Ltd., Registered Office: Plot No. 1, Sector - 03, IMT Manesar, Distt. Gurugram, (Haryana) – 122052, India; **Website:** www.honda2wheelersindia.com; **Customer Care:** customercare@honda.hmsi.in

'Dead fish' in Yamuna spark row between BJP and AAP

Saloni Bhatia and Paras Singh
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A political confrontation has erupted between between the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-led Delhi government and the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) over the alleged "deaths of thousands of fish" in the Yamuna, with the two sides trading allegations over pollution in the river days before the Chhath festival.

Delhi irrigation and flood control minister Parvesh Verma on Thursday alleged that groups of people were "deliberately dumping" dead fish into the river to create panic ahead of Chhath and malign the BJP government. He said his department had been instructed to file an FIR and identify those involved.

In a letter dated November 12, accessed by HT, an executive engineer of the irrigation and flood control department's civil division-4 approached the SHO of Sonia Vihar police station, seeking an FIR and an investigation into what it described as the circulation of fake news on social media about chemicals being sprayed into the Yamuna.

"Some unidentified individuals are spreading fake information on social media platforms, alleging that chemicals are being sprayed into the Yamuna thereby disturbing aquatic life. Such information appears to be circulated with malafide intentions to create unnecessary panic among the public and tarnish the image of the Delhi government," the letter stated. It sought the identification of those behind the posts and preventive action.

Verma also alleged that dead fish were dumped into the river a day after the launch of the Yamuna cruise service, in an attempt to disrupt the festival. He said an investigation would establish whether those involved had links with AAP workers. "As soon as ferry services started operating on the Yamuna, just a day later, officials from our department informed me that some people were dumping dead fish into the Yamuna. The major festival of Chhath is approaching, and they are trying to spoil the atmosphere ahead of the festival," Verma said.

"Everything will become clear once the investigation is completed, and the truth will come out," he added.

Hitting back, AAP Delhi chief Saurabh Bharadwaj accused the BJP government of trying to divert attention from pollution in the river. He said the deaths of thousands of fish had exposed the government's claims of cleaning the Yamuna and challenged Verma to produce CCTV footage to substantiate his allegation. "Dead fish have been found in the Yamuna, and videos of the incident are going viral on social media. Why did the fish die? Did they die due to pollution, or was some harmful chemical dumped into the river, contaminating it?" he said.

"Parvesh Verma is claiming that I dumped the dead fish into the river... To procure fish in such numbers, we would have had to source them from the sea or from a large market in Delhi. CCTV cameras are installed across Delhi. Verma must produce footage showing where I dumped the dead fish," he added

Pollution episode or political stunt?

What the BJP has alleged

- Minister Parvesh Verma alleged that people deliberately dumped dead fish into the Yamuna to create panic ahead of Chhath. He ordered an FIR and a probe into the matter

"Officials from our department informed me that some people were dumping dead fish into the Yamuna. The major festival of Chhath is approaching, and they are trying to spoil the atmosphere ahead of the festival." – **Parvesh Verma**, water minister

What the AAP has alleged

- AAP's Saurabh Bharadwaj accused the BJP of diverting attention from river pollution.
- He challenged Verma to produce CCTV footage proving that AAP workers dumped the fish.

"Dead fish have been found in the Yamuna, and videos of the incident are going viral. Why did the fish die? Did they die due to pollution, or was some chemical dumped into the river, contaminating its water?" – **Saurabh Bharadwaj**, AAP leader

Ammonia under watch

The political exchange came amid concerns over pollution in the Yamuna affecting water treatment. The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) said on Wednesday that a sudden rise in pollution levels in raw Yamuna water had led to curtailed production at the Sonia Vihar water treatment plant (WTP). A Delhi Jal Board (DJB) official had told HT on Wednesday, on condition of anonymity, that ammonia levels of around 1.5-2 parts per million (ppm) were being recorded at the Yamuna's inlet point, against a disruption threshold of 0.9 ppm. However, the DJB said on Thursday that ammonia levels near the Wazirabad barrage were around 0.5 ppm, within the manageable range, and that water treatment and supply were continuing normally.

Ammonia enters water bodies mainly through untreated sewage, industrial effluents and agricultural runoff. High concentrations make water harder to treat for drinking. Delhi's treatment plants can handle levels of around 1 ppm through conventional chlorination; beyond that, treatment may need to be curtailed and polluted water diluted with cleaner supplies to avoid the formation of toxic chloramines. The problem is particularly acute at the Wazirabad and Chandrawal plants, which draw water from the Yamuna. The NDMC had warned that supply to parts of New Delhi dependent on the Sonia Vihar plant could be affected. The plant normally draws raw water from the Upper Ganga Canal, whose operations had only recently resumed after annual maintenance.

The DJB has repeatedly blamed ammonia spikes on untreated industrial discharge entering the Yamuna upstream of Wazirabad, including from the Panipat industrial drain and the mixing of industrial wastewater with freshwater canals in Sonipat. Haryana has denied the presence of leaking pollution sources in its industrial areas. Work to prevent the mixing of wastewater and freshwater through a pipeline is under way following directions from the National Green Tribunal.

Delhi typically records 15-22 episodes a year in which ammonia levels cross 1 ppm.

SOUTH DELHI RWAs FLAG 'CONTAMINATED' WATER SUPPLY

HT Correspondent
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Several resident welfare associations (RWAs) in south Delhi have flagged "contaminated water supply" amid rising ammonia levels in Yamuna, disrupting water treatment and supply.

They have reported increased concentrations of untreated waste and pollutants in water supplied by Delhi Jal Board.

"The water smells like that of a gutter, and some residents have replaced water purifier filters and candles twice in a short span of time. Most of the residents are forced to buy bottled drinking water," said Greater Kailash-II RWA president, Sanjay Rana.

B-1 Vasant Kunj RWA general secretary Aby Johnson flagged similar concerns.

"Water supply is normal as of now, but quality is poor. We can't trust the water we are drinking even after boiling it several times," Johnson said.

He said the water also has a distinct taste from regularly supplied water.

However, residents of Lajpat Nagar, Amar Colony, New Friends Colony and Chittaranjan Park reported no such issues.

RWAs said DJB has alerted the them about pollution in the Yamuna affecting the Sonia Vihar water treatment plant's ability to treat water, potentially disrupting supply, and advised them to use water judiciously.

"The water supply in the command area of Sonia Vihar WTP and underground reservoir levels are likely to be affected. All concerned are requested to use water judiciously and avoid unnecessary wastage," the note to RWAs read.

A RWA president said the note by the DJB about the water supply was shared on the official WhatsApp group by the board.

Preparations underway at Sonia Vihar for Chhath Puja. SANCHIT KHANNA/ HT

11km: India's 'longest' ghat unveiled for Chhath rituals

Saloni Bhatia
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NEW DELHI: Ahead of Chhath Puja, the Delhi government on Thursday inaugurated an 11-km-long ghat along the Munak Canal in north Delhi, describing it as the "country's longest Chhath ghat".

The facility is expected to provide a dedicated space for thousands of devotees, particularly those from the Purvanchal community, for performing rituals during the festival.

BJP national president Nitin Nabin and chief minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated the facility in the presence of Union minister of state Harsh Malhotra and Delhi ministers. The ghat is part of a larger ₹115.29-crore project to revive and beautify the long-neglected stretch of the Munak Canal.

The project covers nearly 5.5 km of the canal, from the Outer Ring Road to the point where it meets the Najafgarh drain near Inderlok Metro station. The government plans to develop ghats along both banks, besides constructing roads and bridges and providing public amenities.

Of the Chhath ghat development, work on a 3-km stretch in the Shalimar Bagh assembly constituency has been completed, while another 2.5-km stretch in Wazirpur is under construction, officials said.

The government said the ghats would have steps, lighting arrangements, parks and other facilities for devotees. The space will also be used for other religious and cultural events, including Durga Puja and Ganesh Puja.

Delhi CM Rekha Gupta and BJP national president Nitin Nabin inaugurate the ghat along Munak Canal. SANCHIT KHANNA/HT PHOTO

Addressing the gathering, Gupta said the area had been neglected for years, and residents had been demanding proper facilities for Chhath celebrations. "Chhath celebrations in Delhi will be grander and more divine this year than last year," she said, adding that she would visit different ghats during the festival and offer arghya to the Sun God.

Nabin said the project recognised the contribution of people from Bihar and Purvanchal to Delhi's development and respected their religious and cultural traditions. He said Chhath was not merely a religious ritual but a festival rooted in discipline, purity and gratitude towards nature.

Irrigation and Flood Control minister Parvesh Verma said the facility would allow devotees to perform rituals with dignity. "This is not a favour being extended to them, but a right they should have received long ago," he said. The Chhath ghat is one of seven major works planned as part of the canal's redevelopment.

Meanwhile, the Delhi and Bihar governments have deployed 77 buses from Anand Vihar ISBT to facilitate affordable travel for people heading home for Chhath Puja, with subsidised fares. Delhi transport minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said the initial services would connect Muzaffarpur, Patna, Purnea, Gaya and Darbhanga.

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DIRECTORATE
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Mandi Bhawan, Rudrapur (U.S.Nagar)
Ph:05944-250056 Fax: 05944-50059
U.K.A.P.M.B/2026-2078 Date: 12/11/2026
Public Information
Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board, Rudrapur is developing Kishan Bazar Shops on land located in Mandi Samiti Tanakpur has already published information to give on lease rent.
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General Manager (Finance)

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फोन न0– 0651–2261000,2261856–2261002
मेल आई0डी0–mdnhm-jh@jharkhandmail.gov.in

आवश्यक सूचना
(PR No. 391003)

विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों की निविदा आधारित नियुक्ति हेतु स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, झारखण्ड द्वारा प्रकाशित विज्ञापन संख्या – HMFW/2026(SMO Bid)-2755(MD) दिनांक 01.10.2026 के विरूद्ध आवेदन समर्पित करने की अंतिम तिथि 15.11.2026थी। उक्त तिथि को संशोधित करते हुए उपरोक्त विज्ञापन के विरूद्ध आवेदन समर्पित करने की अंतिम तिथि दिनांक 30.11.2026 तक विस्तारित की जाती है।
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कार्यालय – अधीक्षक, एम0 जी0 एम0 मेडिकल कॉलेज अस्पताल,जमशेदपुर
Email ID : superintendentmgmmch@gmail.com
Bidding Document No :-3901 / 2026 Dated :- 12/11/2026
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A.	Important dates for Tenders	Timelines/other particulars
1.	Date of Publishing of bidding document on www.jharkhandtender.gov.in	On 13.11.2026
2.	Date of pre bid meeting	On 19.11.2026 at 12:00 P.M.
3.	Date of start for submission of Bid	On 21.11.2026 at 12:00 P.M.
4.	Closing date of online submission	On 28.11.2026 till 06.00 P.M.
5.	Hard Copy of Tender Documents	30.11.2026 till 05.00 pm (by registered post/speed post in the office of the Superintendent, M.G.M. Medical College Hospital, Jamshedpur - 831020)
6.	Opening of technical bid	On 01.12.2026 at 12:00 P.M. All the bidders must have submit online EMD 50000/- in through www.jharkhandtender.gov.in. The tenders of only those bidders will be opened, who have submitted the Hard copy of technical bid and Online payment receipt.

Note : -

01.	For details of tender terms, conditions & specification please visit website www.jharkhandtender.gov.in
02.	No claims/changes will be considered after pre -bid queries and finalization of tender documents.
03.	Any information/corrigendum regarding the tender will be given only on the website: www.jharkhandtender.gov.in

Superintendent M.G.M. Medical College Hospital Jamshedpur
PR 393752 (Health Med Edu and Family Welfare)26-27*D

AIIMS develops novel technique to slow brain tumours

Rhythma Kaul
rhythma.kaul@htlive.com

THE STUDY SEEKS TO TURN LONG WAITS FOR BRAIN SURGERY INTO TREATMENT TIME

NEW DELHI: Doctors at the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) in Delhi have developed a novel technique that could help slow the progression of aggressive brain tumours while patients wait for life-saving surgery, potentially turning prolonged waiting periods into an opportunity to begin treatment.

The pilot study combines single-day Gamma Knife radiosurgery with a low dose of bevacizumab -- a cancer drug -- to control glioblastomas before or after surgery. The researchers say the approach could also reduce tumour blood supply and swelling, making subsequent surgery safer and more complete.

Titled "Upfront gamma knife with concomitant bevacizumab — A gamechanger in glioblastoma management?", the study was published in the November issue of the journal Interdisciplinary Neurosurgery: Advanced Techniques and Case Management. Glioblastoma is one of the most common and aggressive forms of primary malignant brain tumour in adults. Despite surgery followed by radiation and chemotherapy, the average survival time is typically 14 to 16 months.

"It is the most common and aggressive brain cancer diagnosed in adults that progresses with great speed. Even with timely and gold standard treatment like surgical removal and weeks of radiation and chemotherapy, the average survival time remains a grim 14 to 16 months," said Dr Deepak Agrawal, professor in AIIMS's department of neurosurgery and the study's lead author.

A major challenge at government tertiary care hospitals such as AIIMS is the long wait for surgery, which can adversely affect treatment outcomes. "Because of the sheer volume of patients seeking care, the wait time from initial diagnosis to brain surgery may at times stretch beyond three months. For a fast-growing tumour like glioblastoma, 90 days can mean the difference between an operable tumour and catastrophic disease progression," said Dr Agrawal.

The research, led by Agrawal along with Dr Mahnaaz Sultana Azeem, Dr Satish Kumar Verma and Dr Shailesh Gaikwad, explores whether treatment can begin even before surgery.

Green cess on effluent plants rises 88-fold in 1 yr

NEW DELHI: Environmental compensation imposed on Delhi's common effluent treatment plants (CETPs) surged 88.5 times in 2025-26 compared to the previous financial year, with penalties touching ₹4.43 crore, according to information obtained under the Right to Information (RTI) Act from the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC).

The fines imposed on CETPs rose from ₹5 lakh in 2024-25 to ₹4.42 crore in 2025-26, according to an RTI reply. The cumulative environmental compensation imposed on these industrial effluent treatment plants between 2023-24 and 2025-26 stood at ₹5.33 crore, the RTI reply revealed. Environmental activist Amit Gupta had filed an RTI seeking information on environmental compensation charges imposed on CETPs.

The information also showed that separate penalties of ₹22.95 crore were imposed on the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) and domestic sewage treatment plants through 17 orders. HTC

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Man who died in Dwarka tunnel crash was driving at 200kmph

Jignasa Sinha
jignasa.sinha@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A 22-year-old man from Gurugram died after crashing his car, which he was reportedly driving at a speed of 202kmph, into a tunnel wall on the Dwarka Expressway in southwest Delhi on Diwali day, police said on Thursday, citing CCTV footage they recovered that showed the car travelling at a high speed in the run-up to the crash.

Police said the victim, Abhinav Singh, got stuck in the car and died of burns as the vehicle caught fire.

Deputy commissioner of police (southwest) Amit Goel said, "The injured person was shifted to Indira Gandhi hospital by NHAI staff where he was declared brought dead... the driver lost control, rammed into a wall, the car jumped to the other side and caught fire. We also later found a Snapchat post from the account of the deceased. It shows the car driving at 202 kmph. His friends had also responded to the post and advised him to slow down."

Police said the victim was stuck in the car which caught fire. HT

Police said they have also recorded two to three videos (Snapchat posts) of the car's speedometer, the road and the car. He had shared the videos with a few friends.

A senior police officer, who did not wish to be named, said, "The impact was so severe that the car's engine was dislodged and thrown some distance away, and the vehicle caught fire. The driver died inside the car."

Police said the victim was from Bihar's Muzzafarpur, and was working in Gurugram.

Police said Singh had met a friend in Ludhiana, Punjab, and was on his way home to Gurugram on the morning of November 8, when the accident took place. The car was on the Dwarka Expressway tunnel, which connects Dwarka and Yashobhoomi to the Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport and Gurugram. The vehicle "went out of control" and hit a tunnel wall, according to the police.

The senior officer cited above said, "While the enquiry is still pending, we have been told that the car, a Volkswagen Virtus, did not belong to Singh and he had borrowed it from a friend. We are verifying the identity of the owner and will question him too. There's also some allegations by the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) side that the car may have been modified."

A second officer said, "The tunnel has a speed limit of 80kmph. This was a heavy violation of the speed limit. The tunnel also had CCTV cameras. They show the car moving at an uncontrollable high speed. Eyewitnesses also said the same and that Singh couldn't control the vehicle while taking a turn."

Police have deployed forensic staff to collect evidence, got an autopsy conducted and initiated inquest proceedings under Section 194 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS).

{ TOP COURT INFORMED } PENDENCY OVER 10K

Fast-track courts take 4yrs for Pocso cases: HC

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NEW DELHI: It takes an average of four years for a fast track court (FTC) set up in the Capital to dispose cases of rape or sexual offences involving minors under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act (Pocso), a report filed by the Delhi High Court in the Supreme Court has revealed.

The affidavit by the Delhi High Court registrar general Reetesh Singh was filed on November 4 in a suo motu petition over the recent rape incidents in the Capital.

Giving a comprehensive report on the functioning of the 23 fast track courts (FTC), 31 special courts, and seven other courts handling rape cases, the high court stated that despite more than 10,000 cases being disposed in the past three years (2023-25), the total pendency of cases in these courts is 15,890.

The total pendency of cases as on September 30, 2026, in FTCs is 6,195 cases; before special courts 8,181 cases; and 1,514 cases before the other seven courts. Pendency of Pocso cases alone comes to 10,616 cases.

In the past three years (January 1, 2023 to December 31, 2025), 10,014 cases were disposed of by these courts.

The Delhi HC affidavit gave court-wise data on average time it takes to dispose of cases. The Pocso FTC courts required an average of 1,720 days (approximately 4 years and seven months) for final disposal of cases. At the same time, the FTC for rape cases require an average time of 1,533 days (4 years and 2 months), and FTC for sexual assault cases require 1,493 days (four years).

The corresponding time taken by special courts for Pocso cases is 1,854 days (a little over 5 years) and for rape cases is 1,639 days (approximately 4 years and four months). The period is counted from the date when the case is registered in the court till the date of its disposal and the total disposal days include the ensuing holidays as well.

Considering the slow progress made by FTCs set up with the purpose of expediting trial in these cases, a committee constituted by the high court examined the issue on three occasions this year. It found that, in Delhi, the average disposal rate per month per FTC for the year 2025 was 4.68, well below the standard of 13.75 cases per month per FTC fixed by the Union ministry of law and justice.

The committee was informed of two major deficiencies causing low disposal of cases – delay in getting scientific and chemical analysis reports from the forensic science laboratory (FSL) and absence of a dedicated public prosecutor in each of the FTC or special courts. While discussions with stakeholders are currently on to improve on the first aspect, as regards the other issue, additional public prosecutors have been assigned to each court.

On September 28, the bench of justices JB Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran issued a slew of directions to the Delhi police, Centre, Delhi government and the Delhi HC to streamline the mechanism for prevention of crimes against women, securing public spaces for citizens, and ensuring speedy trial of cases.

Delhiwale

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Mayank Austen Soofi

Portrait of a life

Proust questionnaire with a fellow citizen

{ PRIVATE CAPITAL } Rickshaw puller Faheem is awaiting customers on a roadside in Central Delhi. This afternoon, he agrees to take part in our Proust Questionnaire series, in which citizens are nudged to make "Parisian parlour confessions", all to explore our distinct experiences.

The principal aspect of your personality.
I have no Aadhaar card, no ID card, no mobile phone. All were stolen. I only have this wristwatch, which a kabadiwala gave me for 20 rupees some weeks ago. And I have been pulling this rickshaw for three years. These are the main things about me. I arrived in Delhi three years ago, leaving my bahu (wife) in the town. I have one son, but when I left, he was too young to have a name. These are also the main things about me. My home is in UP, Badaun, kasba Sahaswan. Thana is also Sahaswan, tehsil is also Sahaswan.

Your favourite qualities in a man.
He should not drink daru. He should live with his family. Look at me. I should have stayed at home. Eating ghar ki dal-roti daily. Bathing daily. Wearing clean clothes.

Your main fault.
Living in Delhi. If I die in this city, nobody here will bother about my body. Another fault at present is that I haven't shaved for some days.

If not yourself, who would you be?
In my childhood, I had seen a movie in which Mithun Chakravarty played a commando. I wanted to be a commando.

Where would you like to live?
I live in this rickshaw.

How do you wish to die?
Never thought about that. But I have often thought of selling my kidney to get good money. Once, I asked a shopkeeper in Gandhi Market how to go about it. He said I would first have to show my ID to the doctor, which I don't have. He also said that no doctor would agree to my request anyway. And what will I do with the money from my kidney?

What is your present state of mind?
I try not to think. Thinking fills me with tension. But right now I am thinking of daru.

READ: For more stories by Mayank Austen Soofi, scan the QR code

Empanelment of Special Public Prosecutor for Narcotics Control Bureau before various High Courts

Applications are hereby invited from Advocates for empanelment as Special Public Prosecutor (SPP) in Narcotics Control Bureau for handling NDPS Cases before Hon'ble High Courts of Gujarat at Ahmedabad, Karnataka at Bengaluru, Madhya Pradesh at Jabalpur, Orissa at Cuttack, Punjab & Haryana at Chandigarh, Madras at Chennai, Delhi at New Delhi, Allahabad at Prayagraj, Gauhati at Guwahati, Manipur at Imphal, Jammu, Kashmir & Ladakh at Jammu, Kerala at Ernakulam, Calcutta at Kolkata, Bombay at Mumbai, Patna at Patna, Jharkhand at Ranchi, Himachal Pradesh at Shimla, Goa bench of Bombay High Court, Lucknow bench of Allahabad High Court, Jaipur & Jodhpur benches of Rajasthan High Court and Jalpaiguri bench of Calcutta High Court.

The eligibility criteria and other details are available in the Terms & Conditions posted on the website of Narcotics Control Bureau, **https://ncb.mha.gov.in/vacancies** (direct link to document: **https://tinyurl.com/mr3fw4s8**).

The interested advocates may apply in the requisite proforma to the AD (Legal) of NCB over email **dlahq-ncb@nic.in** clearly mentioning 'the court/courts applied for' in their application latest by **21.12.2026**.

CBC 19126/11/0108/2627 **Dy. Director General (Special Wing)**

कार्यालय जिलाधिकारी उत्तरकाशी

सार्वजनिक सूचना

(राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग संख्याः 34 के कि0मी0 95.287 से कि0मी0 100.300 के निर्माण हेतु अर्जित की गई भूमि से प्रभावित भूमिधरों को अधिनिर्णित धनराशि प्राप्त करने और कब्जा सौंपने के संबंध में)

सभी भूमिधर एवं हितबद्ध व्यक्तियों का ध्यान दिनांक 12 अप्रैल 2026 (ग्राम बाड़ाहाट, ज्ञानसू उप तहसील जोशियाड़ा, जिला उत्तरकाशी) को निम्न समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित सूचना की ओर आकर्षित किया जाता है, जिसके माध्यम से आपको निम्न बिन्दुओं के बारे में अवगत कराया गया थाः–

01. अभिनिर्णय की घोषणा दिनांक 15 जनवरी, 2024।
02. प्रतिकर को 60 दिवस की अवधि में प्राप्त करने की सूचना ।
03. अधोहस्ताक्षरी को अधिनिर्णित भूमि का कब्जा सौंपने की सूचना।

क्रम सं.	समाचार पत्र का नाम	प्रकाशन की तिथि
1	2	3
1.	अमर उजाला	12 अप्रैल, 2026
2.	हिन्दुस्तान टाईम्स	12 अप्रैल, 2026

विहित 60 दिवस की अवधि का अवसान दिनांक 10 जून, 2026 को हो चुका है। अतः राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग अधिनियम की धारा 3E के अधीन अधिग्रहित भूमि का कब्जा तहसील प्रशासन भटवाड़ी को स्वतः ही सौंप दें, अन्यथा की स्थिति में पुलिस बल के माध्यम से कब्जा प्राप्त कर लिया जायेगा।

परियोजना प्रभावित सभी भूमिधर एवं हितबद्ध व्यक्ति जिन्होंने अभी तक प्रतिकर की धनराशि प्राप्त नहीं की है, वह अधिनिर्णित धनराशि किसी भी कार्य दिवस को कार्यालय समय में उप जिलाधिकारी कार्यालय भटवाड़ी में बैंक पास बुक की स्वप्रमाणित प्रति, 02 पासपोर्ट साईज रंगीन फोटोग्राफ, अर्जित भूमि की खतौनी की प्रमाणित प्रति एवं शपथ–पत्र इत्यादि दस्तावेजों के साथ प्रतिकर प्राप्त करने हेतु आवेदन कर सकते हैं।

सक्षम प्राधिकारी(भू०अ०) / अपर जिलाधिकारी, उत्तरकाशी।

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1.	HPGCL	NIT NO. CH-20/MP-7094/ PRESSURE PARTS/2026 SUB:- OVERHAULING OF BOILER FURNACE PRESSURE PARTS AND HP VALVES FOR 250 MW, UNIT- 7, PANIPAT.	10.11.2026 26.11.2026	Rs. 1,81,56,124/-	www.hpgcl.org.in	01802566015 xenmtcplg1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO. 13/2027/40/50975/I/19/7

25001/1538/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER,
CENTRAL RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR
No. 6892 / Date 06.11.2026
"e" Procurement Notice for Road Works

1.	Name of the Work	:	Road Works under MMSY-Improvement to Existing RD Road for the year 2026-27
2.	Total No. of works	:	06 Nos. of Road Works
3.	Estimated Cost of the work:	:	Varies from Rs.215.42 lakh to Rs.674.86 lakh
4.	Class of Contractor		
	a) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20 Lakhs up to Rs. 3.00 Crores		B Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	b) Estimated cost more than Rs. 1.00 Crore up to Rs. 20.00 Crores.		A Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	c) Estimated cost more than Rs. 6.00 Crore up to Rs. 50.00 Crores.		Special Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	d) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 Crores		Super Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
5.	Period of completion	:	As mentioned in Column-7 of Annexure
6.	Offered rates by bidder	:	The offered rate by the contractor shall be excluding GST.
7.	Other details	:	

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Date & Time of Opening of Tender	
		From	To	Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6
Chief Construction Engineer, Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar	Tender- Online-C.C.34 of 2026	20.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M	07.12.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	08.12.2026 at 11.00 A.M	To be intimated later on

Further details can be seen from the web site:- www.tendersodisha.gov.in

Chief Engineer,
Central R W Circle, Bhubaneswar
OIPR - 25001/25194/1/26-27/0010

32001/1316/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT
AT/PO: MUKHIGUDA DIST:KALAHANDI
ODISHA, PIN: 766026
e-mail address: cceuip1987@gmail.com/louiipbbsr@gmail.com

TENDER CANCELLATION NOTICE

The Tender invited for the work 1)"Improvement of service road with black topping from RD 00 Km to RD 3.0 Km of Junagarh Distributary and from RD 00 Km to RD 3.2 Km of Koilgaon distributary under Right Canal Division- I, Mukhiguda. vide Bid Identification No-CCE,UIP-16(01-02) of e-Procurement Notice No: CCE, UIP -16(02)/2026-27, DATE: 27.10.2026 of O/o the Chief Construction Engineer, Upper Indravati Project, Mukhiguda is hereby Cancelled.

Chief Construction Engineer
Upper Indravati Project
Mukhiguda
OIPR - 32001/32352/1/26-27/0022

32001/1324/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER & BASIN MANAGER
TEL BASIN, BHABANIPATANA
NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)
"e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE NO.- CE&BM, TEL —P1-10/2026-27
Bid Identification No: CETEL-BID-04/2026-27

The Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana (WR Department) on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage rate bid in Double Cover system to be received in on ONLINE MODE only for the construction of works as detailed in the table below:-

1	Nature of work	Civil Works
2	Number of works	01 (One)
3	Approximate amount put to tender.	Rs. 21,04,27,311.00 /-
4	Class of Contractor	`Super' & 'Special' Class
5	Period of completion	18(Eighteen) Calendar months.
6	Date & time of availability of Bid document in the portal	23.11.2026 -10.00 hours to 16.12.2026 up to 17.00 hours
7	Last date & time of seeking Tender clarification.	Dt. 11.12.2026 up to 17.30 hours
8	Last date & time of Receipt of Bids in the portal.	Dt. 16.12.2026 - up to 17.00 hours
9	Date time & place of opening of Technical bids of Double Cover.	Dt. 17.12.2026 at 11.00 hours- in the office of the Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana

The bidders have to participate in online bidding only. The website for online bidding is htpp://www.tendersodisha.gov.in.

Chief Engineer & Basin Manager,
Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana
OIPR - 32001/32317/1/26-27/0015

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR No.	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	FACILITIES FOR DIFFERENTLY ABLED PERSONS IN THE JUDICIAL COURT COMPLEX, JIND IN DISTRICT JIND (PROVIDING 15 PASSENGER LIFT ONLY) + 3 WORKS	11.11.2026 18.11.2026	27.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwdeeedrohtak1@gmail.com
2	PWD B&R, SIRSA	DNIT FOR SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM JIWAN NAGAR TO SAINPAL VIA KARIWALA KM 0.00 TO 18.90 (ROAD ID:5899) IN SIRSA DISTT. IN RANIA CONSTITUENCY UNDER HEAD-3054 (GROUP-4) (WITHOUT GST) + 1 WORKS	11.11.2026 23.11.2026	821.61 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666222959 pwd-eepd2-sirsa@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, SIRSA	DNIT FOR CONSTRUCTION OF TEHSIL BUILDING AT NATHUSARI CHOPTA IN SIRSA DISTT. (WITHOUT GST)	11.11.2026 26.11.2026	738.29 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666222959 pwd-eepd2-sirsa@hry.nic.in
4	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KURUKSHETRA	LAYING OF RCC PIPELINE FROM DISPENSARY TO POND UNDER DISTT. VILLAGE - DHANAGLI, BLOCK - SHAHABAD(M) DISTT. PLAN SCHEME. + 2 WORKS	11.11.2026 18.11.2026	34.16 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896224357 prexeeng.krk@hry.nic.in
5	PANCHAYATI RAJ, FARIDABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF RAIN WATER HARVESTING SYSTEM IN SC CHAUPAL AT VILLAGE SIDHOLA BLOCK FARIDABAD DISTRICT FARIDABAD VANGY + 9 WORKS	10.11.2026 18.11.2026	106.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467905067 prexeeng.fbd1@gmail.com
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	FOR HIRING OF HYDRA MACHINE AND JCB, TRACTOR TROLLY, AT VARIOUS LOCATION UNDER JURISDICTION OF PHESD NO.2 HISAR + 3 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 18.11.2026	37.78 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
7	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	SUPPLY, ERECTION AND COMMISSIONING OF 03 NO. DG SETS OF DIFFERENT CAPACITY AS PER SITE CONDITION AT PERMANENT PUMP HOUSES AT RD 5750 OF PILANA MINOR, RD 169500 OF KAHANAUR DISTY., RD 8000 (SANGHI-I PUMP HOUSE) OF SANGHI MINOR AND RD 10000 OF JINDRAN PUMP HOUSE.	CLOSING DATE 18.11.2026	35.79 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812111077 xenwsdnrtk@gmail.com
8	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	REPAIRING DAMAGED LINING PATCH AT VARIOUS RDS OF ASANDA MINOR YEAR 2026 - 2027.	CLOSING DATE 17.11.2026	1.43 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9464040970 xensampla@gmail.com
9	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, FATEHABAD	CLEARANCE OF BUSHES AND VEGETATION OF KHERI DISTY FROM RD 69000-157500 + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 16.11.2026	16.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466751554 xenwsdivisionfbd@yahoo.com
10	HARYANA ROADWAYS, JHAJJAR	E- TENDER FOR HIRING OF ACTIVITY I.E 1 CLEANING OF BUSES WITH BROOM. 2 WASHING OF BUSES HARYANA ROADWAYS, JHAJJAR.	20.11.2026 08.12.2026	50,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812676073 gmhrjjr@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO No. 11/2027/200/50969/I/19/7

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INFLATION AT 6.09%

CPI basket. The only exception was personal care, social protection and miscellaneous goods, a category that nevertheless continued to record the highest inflation in the basket.

Food and beverages, which account for 37% of the CPI basket, recorded inflation of 8.51% in October, up from 7.36% in September. The number was 2.1% in January 2026, the earliest month for which comparable data is available. Disaggregated data for the food and beverages category showed that eight of the nine food categories and six of the seven beverage categories recorded higher inflation than in September. Among food categories, sugar, confectionery and desserts recorded the highest inflation at 13%.

Core inflation – the non-food, non-fuel component of the CPI basket, which is considered less susceptible to seasonal fluctuations – stood at 4.6%, according to data from the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE).

The RBI's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) noted the rising trend in core inflation in its October resolution and projected it at 4.4% for the full financial year. The MPC's latest projection for headline CPI inflation is 5.2% for the fiscal year, with quarterly projections of 6% and 5.7% for the quarters ending December 2026 and March 2027, respectively.

Transport inflation, which includes the fuel sub-category, has also risen consistently, reaching 5.8% in October. This was despite fuel inflation remaining unchanged at 7.6% since June, as the government has not revised petrol and diesel prices during this period.

While the latest inflation numbers are in line with analyst and RBI expectations, economists believe a rate hike in December is likely.

"CPI inflation is projected to peak in Q3 FY27 and average around 5.0% for the full year. On the monetary policy front, given rising inflation expectations, and broadening price pressures there is a likelihood of a 25-bps rate hike at the December policy meeting", Rajani Sinha, chief economist at CareEdge Ratings said in a note.

"We believe inflation has mostly peaked and while upcoming CPI prints may soften, they will continue to stay elevated, paving the way for measured hikes by the MPC. We expect the hiking cycle to be rather shallow: We expect a 25bp rate hike by the MPC in its December meeting, followed by a terminal 25bp hike in February 2027, taking the repo rate to 6.00%", Barclays India chief economist Aastha Gudwani said in a research note.

2 SPOs FOUND DEAD

prompting police and security forces to launch a search operation, officials said.

The slain personnel's service weapons — an INSAS rifle and a .303 rifle along with some magazines and ammunition — were missing and are believed to have been taken away by terrorists, officials said. Investigators recovered empty cartridges of Pakistani-origin armour-piercing steel-core ammunition from the scene, they added.

Security forces rushed reinforcements to the area, deploying drones to scan dense forest stretches and sniffer dogs to track movement along the Kiyar-Dharna route, officials said.

There was no official statement from the J&K police or the army on the incident till going to print.

Kishtwar legislator and Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader Shagun Parihar condemned the attack.

"Two of our SPOs have been killed; this is deeply tragic. It is thanks to these SPOs that the people in our village remain safe," she was quoted as saying by news agency ANI. "I condemn this attack by terrorists in the strongest possible terms. I have full faith in (Union) home minister Amit Shah and our security forces that the deaths of these two men will be avenged as soon as possible."

The killings come a day after terrorists attacked a CRPF checkpost near Mir Bazaar in Kulgam on Wednesday, injuring three personnel, including one critically, police said. The attack took place around 2.15pm when the jawans were on guard duty.

In recent months, Kishtwar has seen multiple counter-insurgency operations, leading to the neutralisation of several active terrorists. At least four terrorists have been neutralised and am army soldier killed in terror-related incidents in the district so far this year, officials said.

On October 14, another SPO, Bashir Ahmed, 55, went missing from the Pedil police post along with his self-loading rifle. His

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

body was found near his house in Wanipora Trigam two days later, with police subsequently arresting a father-son duo over an alleged land dispute.

(With agency inputs)

JENSEN HUANG RESIGNS

Nvidia shares initially plunged as much as 14% before paring their losses. The stock was down 5.5% to $164.25 as of 11 am IST.

"Jensen's contributions to Nvidia are profound," the board said. "Nvidia is one of the most consequential technology companies in the world. The board and the company thank Jensen for his immeasurable contributions to the company and the industry."

Huang, one of the three engineers who founded the chipmaker in 1993, had been under intense pressure since Sunday, when he admitted to a romantic relationship with Alice Huang, a former executive at the Singapore-based data center firm Megaspeed International.

The Nvidia turmoil is rippling through the entire artificial intelligence complex on Thursday, dragging down shares of semiconductor companies such as Micron Technology Inc. and Marvell Technology Inc., the so-called neoclouds such as CoreWeave Inc. and Nebius Group NV, and even weighing on AI-adjacent companies, including power equipment firms Vertiv Holdings Co. and Bloom Energy Corp. On the other hand, shares of Nvidia rivals such as Advanced Micro Devices Inc. and Broadcom Inc. gained.

"There will be a tremendous loss of credibility for Nvidia overall," Bloomberg Intelligence analyst Mandeep Singh said in a Bloomberg Television interview. "Given their importance in the AI ecosystem and everything that they were doing from a deal perspective," Singh said Huang's exit may have a disproportionate impact on the neoclouds supplying AI computing and open-source and open-weight AI model developers.

Kress, who joined Nvidia 13 years ago after stints at Microsoft Corp. and Cisco Systems Inc., has spent her career in financial roles. While she has represented the company at Wall Street-related events, her public role has been confined to Nvidia's numbers and the majority of the communication with the financial community has been handled by her former boss.

Under Huang's leadership, Nvidia's shares had soared more than 700,000% since it became a public company in 1999. The firm's market valuation has at times topped $5 trillion, ranking it among the largest companies in the world. The staggering growth eclipses anything accomplished by Apple Inc.'s Steve Jobs, Microsoft Corp.'s Bill Gates or Amazon.com Inc.'s Jeff Bezos.

Huang's departure threatens to reverberate far beyond Nvidia. He has used Nvidia's financial strength to back dozens of major AI players including frontier labs OpenAI and Anthropic PBC. He's also both invested in and backstopped financing deals for cloud computing firms including CoreWeave Inc., inspiring others to forge similar arrangements with one another to bolster the entire AI ecosystem. Big names on Wall Street including Michael Burry of The Big Short fame have warned that such circular deals are artificially inflating AI demand.

"As a student of economic history, I don't know if there's ever been such a key man holding so much of this industry up," Blue Bear Capital investor Thomas Ferguson said of Huang while speaking at the BNEF Houston Summit on Wednesday ahead of his departure.

Huang has also led high-profile efforts to promote the worldwide expansion of data centers, traveling extensively to speak at conferences, lectures and other events. Wearing his signature leather jackets, he's drawn crowds of fans swept up in "Jensanity."

The executive has become close with US President Donald Trump, appearing at White House meetings on technology, at state dinners and aboard Air Force One. Huang has enjoyed far greater access to the president than most corporate leaders. Trump on Monday backed Huang as "a very honorable man."

The revelations about the Nvidia CEO's affair with Alice Huang, an executive at Megaspeed, raised serious questions about his judgment. Huang also had a relationship with Kimberly Powell, Nvidia's vice president of healthcare.

Megaspeed, which was spun out of a Chinese gaming enterprise, is one of Nvidia's largest Southeast Asian customers and has been under US investigation for months related to the potential smuggling of Nvidia's advanced AI chips into China, Bloomberg has reported. Megaspeed and Nvidia have denied wrongdoing.

Using a network of companies, Alice Huang also forged ties with DeepSeek, a top Chinese AI startup, the Information reported on Thursday. She invested in the business with the intention of supplying it with advanced Nvidia chips, the news outlet said.

Nvidia's board has been working with an outside firm to identify potential replacements for Huang, a person familiar with the matter said Wednesday, asking not to be identified because the information isn't public. Directors had met remotely on Wednesday to discuss Huang's fate, people familiar with the situation said.

Some highly prominent tech executives named by those in the industry as people that could be looked at by Nvidia's board include Lisa Su, CEO of rival Advanced Micro Devices Inc., Rene Haas, chief at Arm Holdings Plc and Micron Technology Inc. leader Sanjay Mehrotra.

"We see considerable uncertainty around further news flow that is probably going to be coming down the pipe, as well as the ability of any new CEO to truly fill Jensen's shoes given how tightly he managed the direction of the business and its relationships with customers, suppliers, employees and the broader industry ecosystem," Bernstein analyst Stacy Rasgon said in a note.

US lawmakers have called for Huang to appear before congressional committees and threatened a subpoena if he failed to appear. Nvidia's board said on Tuesday that it had hired Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz partner Joon H. Kim, a former career federal prosecutor, "to conduct a thorough and independent investigation."

For the AI supply chain, "we wonder what will happen to the company's myriad of investments in the space, various backstops and residual guarantees," Rasgon said.

While Rasgon acknowledged it had been tough to make a call on the stock, he downgraded Nvidia to "market perform" and lowered the price target to $200. "Our gut tells us that we probably haven't yet fully probed the depths of what might be found here," Rasgon said in the note. "We've had enough, and prefer to watch from the sidelines."

NCPCR to finalise safety guidelines for social media

Sejal Sharma
letters@hindustantimes.com

THE COMMISSION IS AIMING TO RELEASE THE FINAL GUIDELINES IN FIRST HALF OF 2027, SAID OFFICIAL AWARE OF DETAILS

NEW DELHI: The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) is in the final stretch of drafting guidelines for social media and online gaming platforms to improve child safety, holding its "final stakeholder meeting" with companies on Thursday, the commission said in a statement.

It is aiming to release the final guidelines in the first half of 2027, according to an official familiar with the development.

HT was the first to report in August, this year that the child rights commission was preparing the framework, which officials had earlier described as a uniform code of conduct for social media platforms to strengthen safeguards for children, using platforms such as Instagram, Facebook, X and Snapchat.

At Thursday's meeting, representatives of social media and online gaming companies made presentations on their existing child safety tools, awareness programmes for children, parents and caregivers, and their plans for further measures, the NCPCR statement said.

An NCPCR official said, "The draft guidelines will be published for public comments in December, with NCPCR aiming to release the final guidelines in the first half of 2027. Sixteen companies participated in Thursday's consultation, including Meta, Google, Snapchat, ShareChat, Reddit and gaming platform Roblox."

"What the guidelines are trying to do is mitigate legal activities that platforms do but yet are harmful for the children. Like scrolling reels which make people addicted, and algorithms that may repeatedly show harmful content. These are legal but harmful," the official added. Before the meeting, the commission prepared a checklist of proposed child safety measures, called the 'Child Safety Implementation Matrix'. Platforms were asked to indicate whether each safeguard was already in place, whether they planned to introduce it and whether they had any additional suggestions, it said.

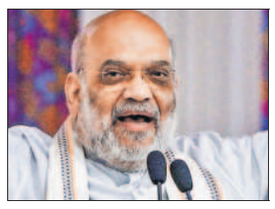
The matrix covers safety by design, age assurance and age-appropriate experiences, protection of children's data, detection and enforcement against child sexual exploitation and abuse material (CSEAM), anti-addictive design and digital wellbeing, reporting and time-bound redressal, and empowerment of children and parents, among other measures.

"The initiative assumes significance in view of the increasing use of digital platforms by children and concerns relating to exposure to harmful and age-inappropriate content, cyberbullying, online grooming, Child Sexual Exploitation and Abuse Material (CSEAM), privacy violations and other forms of online exploitation. These concerns highlight the need for stronger safeguards, greater awareness and enhanced accountability of digital platforms," NCPCR said in its release.

The consultative process began with a meeting with social media and technology companies on May 22, this year to discuss their existing safety systems, content moderation, complaint handling and awareness measures. The commission subsequently held separate one-on-one consultations with individual companies.

On July 24, NCPCR consulted civil society organisations and incorporated their suggestions into the implementation matrix.

It held a separate consultation with online gaming platforms on October 19. The commission said the guidelines are being prepared in consultation with the ministry of electronics and information technology (MeitY), the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) and the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C).



Amit Shah

SHAH MAY ATTEND BSF RAISING DAY EVENT IN MANIPUR ON DECEMBER 1

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Border Security Force (BSF) is set to hold its raising day function in Manipur's Churachandpur on December 1, people aware of the matter said, adding that Union home minister Amit Shah is scheduled to visit the northeastern state for the event.

BSF confirmed the function to be held in the strife-torn state on X. In its statement, BSF said its chief, Director General Praveen Kumar visited Churachandpur to assess the preparations.

"DG BSF visited STC BSF Churachandpur to assess preparations for the forthcoming BSF Day celebrations," it said.

To be sure, the BSF statement did not comment on Shah's visit and only mentioned the DG's visit to Kuki-dominated Churachandpur town to check the preparations. Churachandpur, one of the most densely populated Kuki-Zo-dominated districts, was one of the hotspots of the Meitei-Kuki clashes.

A Manipur-based government officer, who asked not to be named, said, "We have been told that the home minister is coming to Churachandpur for the function. He will be visiting both valley and the hills districts. Likely, he may also visit Naga-dominated Senapati to inaugurate a medical college and later review the security situation in the state."

Senpati is a Naga-dominated district, affected by ongoing the Naga-Kuki clashes.

Meanwhile, the Congress party in the state has also announced that senior Congress leader Rahul Gandhi is also visiting Manipur in the last week of November or the first week of December. Manipur is likely to go to polls early next year.

उत्तराखण्ड शासन

प्रवासी उत्तराखण्डी सम्मेलन

(देश के विभिन्न राज्यों में निवासरत प्रवासी उत्तराखण्डियों का समागम)

मुख्य अतिथि

पुष्कर सिंह धामी
मुख्यमंत्री, उत्तराखण्ड

दिनांक: 13 नवम्बर, 2026 | समय: प्रातः 09:30 बजे
स्थान: नित्यानन्द ऑडिटोरियम,
दून विश्वविद्यालय, केदारपुरम, देहरादून

हार्दिक स्वागत एवं अभिनंदन

देवभूमि उत्तराखण्ड के प्रवासी नागरिकों,

यह हम सभी के लिए अत्यंत गर्व और हर्ष का विषय है कि प्रगति, समृद्धि और खुशहाली के नए कीर्तिमान स्थापित करते हुए हमारा राज्य अपनी स्थापना की 26वीं जयन्ती मना रहा है। प्रवासी उत्तराखण्डी सम्मेलन राज्य स्थापना दिवस समारोहों के एक विशिष्ट अंग के रूप में प्रतिस्थापित हो गया है। इसी क्रम में इस वर्ष हम तीसरा प्रवासी उत्तराखण्डी सम्मेलन दिनांक 13 नवम्बर, 2026 को देहरादून में आयोजित कर रहे हैं। गत वर्षों में विभिन्न प्रदेशों से प्रवासियों द्वारा उत्साहपूर्वक इस सम्मेलन में भाग लिया गया था और इस वर्ष भी हम प्रवासियों का उत्सुकतापूर्वक स्वागत करने को तैयार हैं। मा. प्रधानमंत्री जी के विकसित भारत की संकल्पना के अनुरूप हमने विकसित उत्तराखण्ड राज्य के लिए एक कार्ययोजना तैयार की है। मुख्य रूप से युवाओं के मुद्दों, उनकी भूमिका एवं उनके भविष्य पर फोकस रहेगा। हम विकसित उत्तराखण्ड की रूपरेखा एवं इसमें प्रवासियों की भूमिका पर इस सम्मेलन में चर्चा करेंगे। मुझे पूर्ण विश्वास है कि आप सभी अपने अनुभव, सुझाव और सक्रिय भागीदारी से प्रदेश के विकास को नई दिशा में ले जाएंगे।

पुष्कर सिंह धामी
मुख्यमंत्री, उत्तराखण्ड

"21वीं सदी के विकसित भारत के निर्माण के दो प्रमुख स्तंभ हैं। पहला, अपनी विरासत पर गर्व और दूसरा, विकास के लिए हर संभव प्रयास। आज उत्तराखण्ड, इन दोनों ही स्तंभों को मजबूत कर रहा है। ये दशक उत्तराखण्ड का दशक है।"

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'Dream now has a date': PM on 2047 deadline for Viksit Bharat

Smriti Kak Ramachandran
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NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Thursday India could achieve its goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047, pointing to the country's recent progress in space, infrastructure and economic development. He also urged the media to showcase India's achievements and talent to the world as part of telling the "India story".

Addressing journalists at a Diwali Milan programme at the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) headquarters in the capital, Modi said setting a clear target helps change both the pace and approach of governance. "Deadlines are important... for individuals, institutions and even the country. We are also working on a deadline of 2047 to achieve Viksit Bharat," PM Modi said.

He said the dream of making our country developed has existed since independence, but now it has a set date: 2047. "...That means we must work together to make India a developed nation before we complete 100 years of independence," he told the gathering.

The PM stressed that the 2047 deadline was meant to instil urgency in the pace of work and drive immediate action rather than defer progress. "The 2047 deadline does not mean we have to wait until then. Remember the freedom movement. The goal of complete self-rule was not going to be achieved in a day or two so, smaller goals were set and achieved, and people began to believe that freedom would surely come. The entire country stood united in this resolve," he said.

For achieving the Viksit Bharat dream, he said a similar approach will be needed. "We will move forward by achieving many goals, big and small, and only then will we reach the goal of a developed India," he said.

Modi also questioned whether India was effectively projecting its domestic achievements and talent on the global stage. "Communication is a key element of the 21st century. We have a wonderful India story to share. But are we using this power? Are we going to the world with the India story?" he said, adding that he made an effort to highlight stories of individual achievements in his monthly radio address, Mann Ki Baat.

PM Narendra Modi with defence minister Rajnath Singh and BJP national president Nitin Nabin during the 'Deepawali Milan' event at party HQ in New Delhi on Thursday. @NARENDRAMODI-X

"If the media does this too, it will serve the nation," he said.

He urged the media to take up issues of public interest such as the campaign against drug abuse. "Now we must also raise awareness about drug addiction in the same way. We must get our youth out of all this. When the media gives space to issues of social concern, to issues that strengthen national unity, on its platforms and makes them part of its debates, the campaign for a developed India will gain further momentum," he said.

In a lighter vein, Modi recalled how he witnessed the transformation in the media sector and communication during his political career. He shared the memory of how a group of women journalists in 2001 had learnt of him being sent to Gujarat as chief minister, a piece of information that only a handful of people had. "...very few people knew about the decision at the time, but the group of journalists was already aware of it. Their information was accurate, but it was very difficult for me to answer," he added.

He recalled his role in the BJP which required him to regularly interact with the media. "I have had a natural and longstanding relationship with your world. From press releases to Insta reel releases, I have witnessed a long evolution of media and media interactions," he said.

He also recalled how several journalist friends attended his swearing-in ceremony as Gujarat chief minister in 2001 at their own expense and made their own arrangements.

Modi greets Pitroda with 'happy Diwali' after warm remarks

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NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday exchanged Diwali greetings with Indian Overseas Congress chief Sam Pitroda after the latter praised him as a person, describing him as a warm and caring friend and appreciating his oratory and hard work.

"Happy Diwali and Nutan Varsh Abhinandan to you Sam Bhai and to Anjana Ben. Praying for a joyful and healthy year ahead. Jai Jagannath!" Modi said in a post on X, while sharing Pitroda's comments about him. The Gujarati New Year begins on November 10.

Earlier in the day, Pitroda, a close associate of Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, said in an interview that he shared a personal bond with Modi, whom he had known as a Gujarati friend. "He is a Gujarati friend. I respect him as a person. My wife and I have met him. He has been very warm, kind, loving and caring at a personal level. Of course, he is a good orator and hard-working, and we get along well. We have no personal issues. I have nothing against Mr. Modi as a Gujarati leader, friend or well-wisher..." Pitroda said.

While Modi often extends birthday greetings to political opponents, his response to Pitroda's remarks drew attention given the latter's association with the Congress leadership.

A close associate of former PM Rajiv Gandhi, Pitroda was one of the principal architects and technical leaders of India's telecom revolution in the 1980s. He is also regarded in Congress circles as a mentor figure to Rahul Gandhi during the latter's early political career.

Pitroda's remarks come amid intensified protests by the Congress-led Opposition demanding the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Rahul Gandhi has accused Modi of shielding Kumar and repeatedly targeted the government over alleged "vote chori".

Reacting to Pitroda's comments, Congress leader Zaheer Lalani said personal relations should be seen separately from ideological differences. "Sam Pitroda has stated that he shares a good personal relationship with PM Narendra Modi and has visited his home in Gujarat several times. However, he has also clarified that their ideologies do not match and that he disagrees with Modi on several issues. Personal relations are one thing, while ideological differences are another," Lalani said.

1ST DECADE SINCE INDEPENDENCE WITH OVER 4% AGRI GROWTH: PM

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NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said the past decade was the first since Independence in which Indian agriculture grew more than 4% a year, and that a large number of small farmers have come out of poverty during this period.

Speaking at the Kisan Tak Bharat Agriculture Conference organised by the India Today Group, the Prime Minister cited a World Bank study that 50 crore Indians have overcome poverty in just 12-13 years, with poverty falling faster in villages.

"Agriculture is our culture, our tradition and the basis of our social life," he said, adding that a developed India is not possible without making agriculture "smarter" and farmers "self-reliant".

Modi described agriculture as the main stream among the "seven streams of power" he had mentioned from the Red Fort.

He criticised past governments, saying they were "satisfied" with farmers filling the country's grain stores, even as the market, technology, weather and people's food habits changed.

"It is not enough to fill the grain stores," the Prime Minister said.

Citing achievements of the last decade, he said India exports farm produce worth over Rs 4 lakh crore annually and is the world's top producer of milk, pulses, jute, rice, wheat, cotton, fruits and vegetables, and fish, as well as the largest producer of millets.

Modi said milk production had risen 70 per cent in a decade, egg production 90 per cent, and fish production more than doubled.

The Prime Minister also said about 12 lakh solar pumps have been provided under PM-KUSUM, soil testing labs rose to over 8,400 from a handful in 2014, and there are over 7,500 Krishi Vigyan Kendras.

He added that 10,000 Farmer Producer Organisations have been set up.

Parl session delay puzzles Oppn on Centre's motives

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NEW DELHI: The Union government is yet to announce the next session of Parliament or prorogue the monsoon session, leaving the Opposition and other parties guessing even as 91 days have passed since the Houses were adjourned sine die on August 13.

The delay has fuelled speculation that the Centre may extend the monsoon session by a few days to push through the Delimitation Bill and the Constitution Amendment Bill. With 12 days already gone in November, the government is running short of time if it wants to convene a fresh winter session.

A new session requires the President to summon Parliament, with lawmakers generally receiving at least a couple of weeks' notice. The government, however, can extend the existing monsoon session at short notice without requiring any fresh summon from the President.

According to people aware of the details, the Centre is keen to push ahead with its plan to pass the 131st Constitution Amendment Bill. It is not yet clear whether the government will do so during the winter session or call a special session. "The government has reached out to several parties and we are confident that this time the government will have more than what (votes) is required to pass the bill," said a person aware of the details.

With 12 days of November gone, time is running out to convene a fresh winter session.

The person did not share details of the parties the government has reached out to or the exact number of additional votes it is banking on. The bill requires 360 votes, or a two-thirds majority, for passage. There are currently three vacancies in the 543-member Lok Sabha.

The proposed amendment seeks to increase the strength of the Lok Sabha from 543 to a maximum of 850 through delimitation. The bills are a prerequisite for rolling out 33% reservation for women in Parliament and state assemblies.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will also preside over a meeting of the Council of Ministers scheduled for November 18. According to a person aware of the details, the government has planned an outreach to mark certain milestones and accomplishments of the last 12 years.

In the past five years, the government has announced the winter session schedule after November 15 only once — in 2022. Then parliamentary affairs minister Pralhad Joshi announced the dates on November 18. The session was scheduled from December 7 to December 29, 2022.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh, earlier this week, alleged that the government's decision not to prorogue Parliament was aimed at giving the Union home minister time to secure a two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha for the Delimitation Bills. "This record (of not proroguing the House) has been set to give time to the Union Home Minister to somehow manipulate a super-tainted two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha to get the dangerous and destructive Delimitation Bills passed," Ramesh said.

"The unity and solidarity of the Opposition which defeated his diabolical designs convincingly on April 17, 2026 will prevail once again if he repeats his trademark bulldozer tactics. The Congress President has written to the PM four times in the past six months requesting that an all-party meeting on Delimitation be convened to discuss all proposals transparently and in detail BEFORE introducing any legislation. The PM has steadfastly refused to do so," he posted on X on Monday.

ASP and AIMIM chiefs Chandrashekhar Azad and Asaduddin Owaisi at a press conference on Thursday. ANI

AIMIM-ASP ally for UP polls, Azad is CM face

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LUCKNOW: The Asaduddin Owaisi-led AIMIM and Chandrashekhar Azad's Azad Samaj Party (Kanshiram) on Thursday announced the formation of the 'Samajik Parivartan Morcha (SPM)' to jointly contest all 403 seats in the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, with Azad named as the alliance's chief ministerial candidate.

Owaisi and Azad announced the alliance at a joint press conference in Lucknow, saying that the front would seek to emerge as a strong alternative to stop the BJP from forming the government for a third consecutive term. "I am happy to announce that our brother Chandrashekhar Azad will be the chief ministerial candidate. I can say with confidence that this will be a strong alternative in Uttar Pradesh to stop the BJP from coming to power for the third time," Owaisi said.

He said the alliance was based on "political and intellectual honesty" and would focus on social change, unemployment, education, farmers' issues and the concerns of marginalised communities, which he alleged had long been treated merely as vote banks. Azad rejected the description of the alliance as a "third front" and said it would instead be the strongest political platform in the state. "It is not a third front, it is the first and strongest front in the politics of UP as of now," he said.

He added that the alliance would seek to unite weaker and deprived sections and enable them to use their electoral strength to secure political power and address their concerns. Invoking BR Ambedkar, Azad said political power was the "master key" to resolving people's problems.

The alliance also invited the Samajwadi Party (SP) and Congress to join the Morcha to strengthen the fight against the BJP. Both leaders said seat-sharing was not an issue and would be decided at the appropriate time.

The Morcha's three-point priority agenda, outlined by Azad, includes free quality education from classes 1 to 12, improving hospitals and generating employment for the state's youth. Owaisi also stepped up his attack on the SP, saying it secured around 90% of the Muslim vote in previous elections but failed to defeat the BJP.

YOGI: BULLDOZER NOW A BRAND IN U.P., DEMAND WILL RISE IF MADE HERE

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LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath on Thursday said the bulldozer has "become a brand" in the state, and if companies manufacture bulldozers and tractors in UP, demand for them will automatically grow in India and abroad.

The CM asserted that mafia raj in UP has been replaced by the rule of law, and the policy of zero tolerance towards crime and criminals and bulldozer action has made the state a prime destination for investment. Adityanath was addressing, through video conferencing, the ground-breaking ceremony of the CNH Industrial's new tractor manufacturing plant in the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) area. The plant is being set up at a cost of over ₹1,200 crore.

"You must have heard about Uttar Pradesh's bulldozer. I would like to tell CNH that since you are manufacturing tractors in Uttar Pradesh, you can also manufacture bulldozers here. There will automatically be demand for them in the country and abroad because it has already become a brand here," Adityanath said.

UP's share in India's tractor market is 18.5%, he said, adding that this investment will give new strength to the local economy. The CM assured the CNH management of all possible cooperation and facilities.

AAP drops minister, 6 MLAs in 2nd list for Pjb polls

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CHANDIGARH: The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Thursday announced its second list of 31 candidates for the 2027 Punjab assembly elections, dropping seven sitting legislators, including a cabinet minister and two former ministers, and fielded two Lok Sabha MPs.

The candidates were finalised by AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal, Punjab chief minister Bhagwant Mann, Punjab affairs in-charge Manish Sisodia and other senior party leaders at a meeting earlier in the day before receiving approval from the party's political affairs committee, its highest decision-making body, in Delhi.

People familiar with the matter said the reshuffle hints at a calibrated strategy to field fresh faces in an attempt to counter anti-incumbency against some sitting MLAs and improve the party's electoral prospects.

Talking to media persons, Mann said the selection process was based on survey reports, public feedback and candidates' ground-level work. "According to the AAP's style of working from the very beginning, we have announced 71 candidates.

THE RULING PARTY IN PUNJAB HAS DECLARED 71 NAMES FOR THE ASSEMBLY POLLS SO FAR, WITH 31 NAMES IN 2ND LIST

In other words, you could say we are leading 71-0, because the other parties are caught in their own internal bickering and fighting over chairs," he said.

There was no immediate reaction from any other political parties in the state.

Those dropped include cabinet minister Gurmeet Singh Khudian (Lambi), former ministers Anmol Gagan Maan (Kharar) and Laljit Singh Bhullar (Patti), Raman Arora (Jalandhar Central), Charanjit Singh (Chamkaur Sahib), Amit Rattan Kotfatta (Bathinda Rural) and Kulwant Bazigar (Shutrana). Among them, Khudian and Charanjit Singh were among the giant slayers in the 2022 state assembly elections, who defeated former chief ministers. Meanwhile, the ruling party has fielded Hoshiarpur MP Raj Kumar Chabbewal and Sangrur MP Gurmeet Singh Meet Hayer from Phagwara and Barnala assembly constituencies, respectively.

The list also features five women candidates, taking the total to nine so far.

With the latest announcement, AAP has declared its candidates for 71 of the 117 seats in the state, taking a clear headstart over its political rivals, who have not named any candidates yet.

Kejriwal expressed confidence in the party's preparations for the upcoming elections. "AAP is moving ahead in Punjab with confidence. Best wishes to the candidates," Kejriwal said in a post on X.

EX-PJB SSP GETS 5 YEARS IN JAIL FOR 1992 ABDUCTION

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MOHALI: A special Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) court in Mohali on Thursday sentenced former senior superintendent of police (SSP) Gurmeet Singh Randhawa to five years of imprisonment in the 1992 abduction and disappearance of transporter Amrik Singh Shakri, who was picked up by Taran Tarn police team from a Ludhiana hotel while attending a wedding.

The court also awarded a two-year jail term to Randhawa on criminal conspiracy charges and imposed fines totalling ₹75,000 that would be paid to the victim's family as compensation.

Special CBI judge Yukti Goyal, in her order, said both sentences will run concurrently. The imprisonment in default of payment of the fines, however, will run consecutively, she added.

The verdict came nearly after a protracted 34-year legal battle. Co-accused DSP Parminderjit Singh, represented by advocate HS Dhanoa, was acquitted on Wednesday.

'No one approached me': Sule on NCP merger talks

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MUMBAI: NCP (SP) national working president Supriya Sule on Thursday categorically ruled out any ongoing talks about a possible reunification of the two NCP factions, saying the issue had ended for her with the death of then NCP president and Maharashtra deputy chief minister Ajit Pawar in a plane crash in Baramati on January 28.

Her remarks came shortly after Maharashtra NCP president Sunil Tatkare said he saw no substance in the speculation surrounding merger talks between the two factions.

Sule, who was in New Delhi, chose to break her silence on the speculation nearly two weeks after it gained momentum following a meeting between six senior NCP leaders and Union home minister Amit Shah on November 1. The leaders were learnt to have indicated their support for a merger between the rival NCP factions.

"I have not received any proposal for a merger, so I do not know which proposal you are referring to. No one has approached me or spoken to me about it," Sule said.

Supriya Sule

Asked about several NCP leaders meeting NCP (SP) chief Sharad Pawar over the past week, Sule said she could speak only about her own experience. "When my brother (Ajit Pawar) was alive, we held discussions about the merger of the two parties. He discussed the matter with all of us. A video of one such meeting, held at Govindbaug on January 17, is already in the public domain...However, my brother's sudden demise changed everything. From my side, the matter ended there."

23 AGENCIES TO MONITOR INFLOW OF CASH, LIQUOR, DURING U.P. POLLS

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh chief electoral officer Navdeep Rinwa on Thursday directed senior officials of 23 enforcement agencies of the central and state governments to remain vigilant, ensure coordination and play a key role in monitoring election expenditure and checking distribution of inducements, inflow of drugs, cash and liquor during the 2027 Uttar Pradesh assembly polls.

Rinwa, who chaired a meeting with officials of these enforcement agencies, said an adequate number of flying squads would be deployed to make monitoring more effective in expenditure-sensitive constituencies.

"Nine flying squad teams and nine static surveillance teams will be deployed in each assembly constituency to monitor election expenditure-related activities," he said. "Keeping the electoral process free from money power and inducements is among the top priorities of the ECI. Strict monitoring should be maintained on the illegal transportation and distribution of cash, liquor, narcotics..." HTC

Draft electoral rolls for SSR published in 13 states, 3 UTs; UP to release on Nov 17

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NEW DELHI: Draft electoral rolls were published on Thursday in 16 states and Union territories as part of the Election Commission of India (ECI)'s Special Summary Revision (SSR) 2027, marking the start of a month-long window for claims and objections.

Originally slated for 17 states and UTs with January 1, 2027, as the qualifying date, Thursday's rollout covers 13 states —Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Goa, Gujarat, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur, Punjab, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, Uttarakhand, West Bengal —and three UTs —Andaman & Nicobar Islands, Lakshadweep, and Puducherry — after Uttar Pradesh deferred its draft publication by five days to November 17.

Voters across these regions have until December 11, 2026, to submit claims and objections ahead of the final roll publication on January 4, 2027. The window for UP voters will now run until December 16.

ORIGINALLY SLATED FOR 17 STATES AND UTS WITH JAN 1, 2027, AS QUALIFYING DATE, THURSDAY'S ROLLOUT COVERS 13 STATES, 3 UTS

The qualifying date is the cut-off by which a person must have turned 18 to be eligible for enrolment in a given revision.

The draft rolls published on Thursday show modest net additions to rolls that were pruned heavily during the SIR.

In Kerala, the draft roll has 27,360,254 names, against 26,953,644 in the final post-SIR roll, a rise of about 0.4 million. The state had 27.8 million voters before the SIR began.

In Manipur, the draft list has 1,994,357 electors, about 33,700 more than after the SIR, which deleted 0.189 million names and added 56,871. In Goa, around 43,000 voters were added and at least 11,000 deleted. Assam, where a Special Revision was held instead of the SIR, recorded a net increase of 218,771 electors, taking the roll to about 25.2 million, including 287,233 electors aged 18-19. Rajasthan's draft roll has 52,667,416 registered voters.

Tamil Nadu is still well below its pre-SIR strength. It had 64.1 million voters before the SIR. This number dropped to 56.7 million electors when the post-SIR rolls were published. As per the draft SSR rolls published on Thursday, the state has 57.7 million electors.

In Bihar, the draft roll lists 75.5 million electors. This is about 1.3 million more than the post SIR number of 74.2 million electors.

Thursday's publication marks the formal opening of the public revision phase under SSR 2027, the first routine roll update in most of these states since the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

A senior ECI official told HT, "This is in line with the ECI notification issued on October 15. SSR is a routine process and the exercise will proceed as usual and in accordance with the Representation of the People Act (1950)."

The SSR, which is an annual exercise, uses the existing roll as its starting point, generally carrying forward existing voters' names to the draft roll. The exercise will be carried out in every state after the SIR is completed.

First-time voters can fill Form 6 to get included in the voter list. Advance applications will also open for those turning 18 on April 1, July 1 or October 1, 2027.

Under the SSR, officials start with the existing roll, publish a draft and invite claims and objections.

Booth-level officers verify new applications, and EROs decide on them before the final roll is published. In the SIR, however, electors are largely asked to fill enumeration forms and the roll is rebuilt from those forms, requiring voters to establish their eligibility.

(With inputs from agencies and HT Correspondents in Imphal, Guwahati and Patna)

Govt nod awaited for 4 HC chief justice appointments

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NEW DELHI: The Union government is yet to clear four appointments of high court chief justices recommended by the Supreme Court collegium more than two weeks ago, leaving four high courts functioning under acting heads even as two more incumbent chief justices are set to retire in the coming fortnight.

The collegium, headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and comprising justices Vikram Nath and BV Nagarathna, recommended the appointments on October 26. However, the government has till date neither notified the appointments nor sent any communication to the Supreme Court administration on the recommendations.

The delay has left the Delhi, Gujarat, Telangana and Uttarakhand high courts without regular chief justices, with their respective acting chief justices continuing to discharge the responsibilities of the top judicial office.

The situation could become more pressing in the weeks ahead, with the chief justices of the Orissa and Jharkhand high courts scheduled to retire on November 15 and November 27, respectively. The retirement of these two judges will require fresh appointments to the top posts in the respective high courts, adding to the number of leadership transitions the collegium and the government will have to address.

> THE DELAY HAS LEFT THE DELHI, GUJARAT, TELANGANA AND UTTARAKHAND HIGH COURTS WITHOUT REGULAR CJs

The Memorandum of Procedure (MoP), which governs the appointment of judges, does not prescribe an outer time limit for the government to notify recommendations made by the Collegium.

The Centre has also been inconsistent in processing appointments of high court chief justices, with the time taken to clear recommendations varying from one set of appointments to another.

According to the Department of Justice's list of high court chief justices, as on November 1, the Delhi High Court has been functioning under acting chief justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre since October 6, following the elevation of its then chief justice DK Upadhyaya to the Supreme Court. The collegium has recommended Justice P Sam Koshy, presently a judge of the Telangana High Court, for the post.

Justice Manash Ranjan Pathak, who was recommended to head the Gujarat High Court, is currently its acting chief justice following the elevation of chief justice Sunita Agarwal to the Supreme Court. Justice Koshy himself has been serving as acting chief justice of the Telangana High Court since October 6, after its then chief justice Aparesh Kumar Singh was elevated to the Supreme Court. For Uttarakhand, the collegium has recommended Patna High Court judge Justice Sudhir Singh to succeed acting chief justice Manoj Kumar Tiwari.

The four recommendations involve judges from different high courts, in keeping with the practice of transferring judges across states while appointing them as chief justices. Justice Koshy comes from the Chhattisgarh High Court, Justice Pathak from the Gauhati High Court, Justice Sudhir Singh from the Patna High Court, while Justice Tapabrata Chakraborty, recommended for Telangana, comes from the Calcutta High Court.

The impending retirements in Orissa and Jharkhand add another layer to the appointments process. Orissa High Court chief justice Harish Tandon is due to retire on November 15, while Jharkhand High Court chief justice Mahesh Sharadchandra Sonak is scheduled to retire on November 27.

The government's delay in acting on the October 26 recommendations comes at a time when the Supreme Court has been working through a series of judicial appointments and transfers across high courts. While acting chief justices can discharge the administrative and judicial responsibilities of the office, the prolonged absence of regular appointments raises questions over the pace at which recommendations made by the collegium are being processed.

'YOUR ROOTS MAY BE IN VILLAGES, BUT YOUR FLIGHT HAS NO LIMITS'

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NEW DELHI: President Droupadi Murmu on Thursday urged students from Eklavya Model Residential Schools (EMRS) to dream big and pursue their ambitions with dedication, discipline and self-confidence, saying their rural backgrounds should never limit their aspirations.

"Your roots are connected to your villages, but there is no limit to your flight," Murmu told a gathering of meritorious tribal students during an interaction at Rashtrapati Bhavan.

The President emphasised that education should not remain merely a means of earning a livelihood, but should also equip young people to create employment opportunities for others. "When our youth create employment, the country's inclusive development will gain further momentum," she said.

The interaction was organised by the ministry of tribal affairs to mark the birth anniversary of tribal freedom fighter Bhagwan Birsa Munda.

CAT 26: AI-based facial recognition to be used 1st time

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NEW DELHI: The Common Admission Test (CAT) 2026 will use artificial intelligence (AI)-based facial recognition to verify candidates' identities at examination centres for the first time, with the technology being introduced on an experimental basis alongside the existing physical verification process, Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Indore director Himanshu Rai said on Wednesday.

The AI-based system will act as an additional check and will not replace verification through CAT admit cards by examination officials. Candidates will not be denied entry even if the technology fails to recognise their faces, Rai told HT.

"We are not doing it independent of the physical verification. The physical verification will obviously happen that whoever enters, the face will be checked against the admit card. But AI-based facial recognition technology will also get tested," Rai said.

IIM Indore is organising CAT 2026, which will be conducted on November 29 in three sessions across more than 350 examination centres in approximately 170 cities. The results are likely to be declared in the first week of January 2027, based on which 22 IIMs and other top-B school will admit students in MBA and other management courses.

Explaining the rationale behind introducing the technology, Rai said facial recognition had increasingly become a standard feature in institutional attendance systems. "With the advent of technology, we moved to biometrics, and now attendance is taken through facial recognition. This is a standard technology which most of the good institutions around the world would have adopted," he said.

The institute will analyse the technology's performance after the examination by comparing the machine's identification results with those of officials.

Asked about concerns surrounding the privacy of candidates' facial data, Rai said the technology would not involve collecting any new information. "We are just matching candidates' data and pictures already present in our system," he said.

The AI-based system will act as an additional check along with verification through officials.

Rai said the institute could consider wider adoption of the technology if the experiment proves successful. However, he added that decisions on adopting new technologies would ultimately rest with individual institutions. "Any technology, once it is tried and tested, will be picked up by everyone. I mean, that is my expectation," he said.

CAT registrations dip marginally this year

Meanwhile, CAT 2026 has received 289,961 registrations, marginally lower than approximately 295,000 last year. Rai said the decline was too small to attribute to any particular factor, but suggested that the growing availability of online management programmes could be one possible reason. "Possibly, there are lots of online options also available now. Many of those online options do not require CAT," he said, clarifying that he did not have data to substantiate this explanation.

AI integrated into IIM Indore curriculum

Rai also said IIM Indore had integrated AI into its academic programmes, with standalone courses on the technology and its applications across management disciplines. "For example, if I am teaching marketing, I would also teach how to use AI while making a marketing plan, and how to use AI to do a preliminary financial balance sheet check," he said.

IIT KHARAGPUR BECOMES FIRST IIT TO OFFER PG MEDICAL COURSES

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NEW DELHI: Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kharagpur has become the first among the IITs in the country to introduce postgraduate medical degree programmes recognised by the National Medical Commission (NMC), with the institute offering 12 MD seats across six specialisations for the 2026-27 academic session, according to an announcement by the institute on Thursday.

The programmes will be offered at the institute's Dr BC Roy Multi-Speciality Medical Research Centre, with admissions through the second round of NEET-PG 2026 counselling. Meanwhile, the fees of course and stipends paid to students will be on the lines of All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS).

The six specialisations are general medicine, radiology, physiology, pathology, community medicine and biochemistry, with two seats in each discipline. The programmes will be available for eligible candidates through the Medical Counselling Committee's (MCC) online counselling process. MCC is the Indian government body that conducts online counselling to allot medical and dental seats based on NEET scores. The second round of NEET-PG counselling is being held from November 10 to November 23.

According to the announcement, the move is aimed at bringing clinical medicine closer to engineering, artificial intelligence (AI), biomedical sciences and translational research.

"It also opens possibilities for connecting specialist medical education with real-world healthcare challenges, particularly those affecting underserved populations, and for accelerating the journey from laboratory discoveries to clinical applications," the institute said.

Professor Suman Chakraborty, director of IIT Kharagpur, said, "India's first IIT is now taking a historic step towards shaping the future of medical education. Our vision is not simply to train specialist doctors, but to create an ecosystem where clinical excellence meets engineering ingenuity...," he said.

Woman killed, 3 injured in two Manipur firings

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IMPHAL: A 40-year-old woman was killed and two others injured after unidentified armed people opened fire at farmers working in a paddy field in Manipur's Senapati district on Thursday, police said. In a separate incident, a 52-year-old Naga community member was injured in a firing incident in Ukhrul.

The first attack took place around 11am in Taphou Kuki village. The deceased, Kimneineng Chongloi, died at the spot, while two other farmers, Sehngam Chongloi alias David and Lamkhochon Chongloi, sustained bullet injuries. "All the victims belonged to Kuki communities. Who were involved and what were their motives behind the attack is yet to be ascertained," a senior police officer said.

The injured were taken to Mission Hospital in Kangpokpi for first aid before being referred to Imphal. A case was registered at Senapati police station.

The Committee on Tribal Unity (CoTU), a Kuki-Zo body, condemned the attack, alleging that it was carried out by armed Naga militants in the presence of security personnel. In the second incident, armed people opened fire on farmers in Sinakeithei village in Ukhrul around 3pm. Village guards retaliated, triggering an exchange of fire that lasted until 3.40pm. Newton Mahung sustained bullet injuries to his arms and was taken to a nearby healthcare centre.

India ranks 28th in climate index, down five spots from previous yr

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NEW DELHI: India ranked 28th, down five spots from last year, in the Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) released at the 2026 United Nations Climate Change Conference (COP31) in Antalya, Turkey, on Wednesday.

The index, which tracks the climate mitigation performance of 64 countries and the European Union (EU), found that no country performed well enough across all categories to secure a "very high" rating. The countries assessed account for more than 90% of global greenhouse gas emissions.

The first three positions were left vacant. Denmark ranked highest at fourth, followed by Lithuania and Luxembourg. The EU was placed 19th.

> INDIA RANKED 13TH IN CLIMATE POLICY, 33RD IN ENERGY USE, 40TH IN RENEWABLE ENERGY AND 31ST IN EMISSIONS

India received medium ratings in greenhouse gas emissions, energy use and climate policy. It ranked 13th in climate policy, 33rd in energy use, 40th in renewable energy and 31st in emissions.

"India ranks 28th in the CCPI, down five places from the previous year. It retains an overall medium rating, receiving a medium rating in GHG Emissions, Energy Use, and Climate Policy," said the report released.

It acknowledged India's progress in renewable energy but flagged inadequate storage and grid infrastructure. "The experts identify a mismatch between renewable energy deployment and transmission, distribution, and storage development," it said.

Citing Ember estimates, the report said India curtailed 2.3 terawatt-hours of solar generation between late May and December 2025 to maintain grid security. It recommended coordinated investment in grids, storage and demand flexibility to improve renewable energy utilisation and displace fossil fuels.

There was no government response to HT's request for a comment.

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Economic security, infra in focus at Quad summit

The Quad Leaders' Summit, is expected to be held in the later part of November 17, following the East Asia Summit. AFP

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NEW DELHI: Quad member states are expected to unveil several deliverables, mainly focused on economic security and strategic infrastructure, at the leaders' summit expected to be held on the margins of the Asean Summit in Manila next week, people familiar with the matter said.

The upcoming Quad Leaders' Summit — the first gathering of the leaders of India, Australia, Japan and the US since September 2024 — is set to be hosted by the US, the people said on condition of anonymity. India was set to chair the leaders' summit in 2025, but its efforts to arrange the meeting last year were stymied by lack of clarity on US President Donald Trump's travel plans.

The deliverables expected to be unveiled at the upcoming summit were finalised at the Quad foreign ministers' meeting on the margins of the G20 foreign ministers' meeting in Atlanta on October 31, the people said. The foreign ministers' meet resulted in several outcomes, including the provision of technical and financial aid worth more than $85 million to back access to trusted artificial intelligence across the Indo-Pacific.

Economic security will remain an area of focus for the Quad, even as the grouping continues its work on critical technologies, maritime domain awareness and strategic infrastructure across the Indo-Pacific, the people said.

The people also pointed to the significance of the US hosting the Quad Leaders' Summit in Manila amidst continuing tensions between China and the Philippines. Beijing and Manila have had a series of testy exchanges since last month, when the Chinese envoy reacted strongly to Philippine defence secretary Gilberto Teodoro Jr's description of China as a regional "troublemaker".

The envoy responded by saying that the Philippines should be grateful to have a neighbour like China, adding that "if we want to use force, we may easily win". This was followed by Philippine President Ferdinand Marcos saying the remarks sounded "very much like a threat".

However, there is still lack of clarity on the timing of the Quad Leaders' Summit, which is expected to be held in the later part of November 17, following the East Asia Summit, the people said. Prime Minister Narendra Modi is expected to arrive in Manila in the afternoon of November 16 and leave early on November 18, the people said.

The upcoming summit will also mark a departure from such meetings being held only in Quad member states.

Modi set to visit Manila next week for Asean and East Asia meetings

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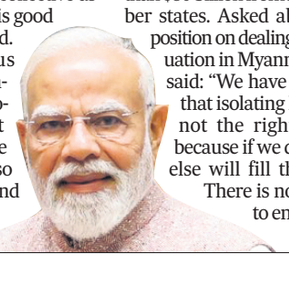
NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi's engagements with leaders of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (Asean) and other countries in the Philippines next week will be crucial for bolstering trade and building resilience amid rapid geopolitical changes, the external affairs ministry said on Thursday.

Modi will travel to Manila on November 16 to participate in the Asean-India Summit and the East Asia Summit the following day, on the margins of the Asean Summit being hosted by the Philippines. He is also expected to join the leaders of Australia, Japan and the US for a Quad Leaders' Summit and hold several bilateral meetings.

Asean has emerged as a central pillar of India's Act East policy and vision for the Indo-Pacific, and Rudrendra Tandon, secretary (East) in the external affairs ministry, told a media briefing that the 11-member bloc serves as a "locomotive for peace, stability and economic prosperity". Annual trade between India and Asean member states is worth about $122 billion.

"India strongly believes that as an Indian Ocean country that abuts this very important Southeast Asian maritime zone, a strong strategic relationship with Asean member states, as a collective as well as individually, is good for both of us," he said.

"It will make us more resilient to handle the very rapid geopolitical changes that are taking place around us. It will also contribute to peace and stability in Asia as a whole," he added.



Tandon highlighted the importance of maritime cooperation with Asean member states, especially for coordinated patrolling and maritime domain awareness, in order to counter problems such as piracy and illegal, unreported and unregulated (IUU) fishing. India can also offer training and other assistance to bolster the maritime capabilities of Asean member states, he said.

At the same time, India has developed strong defence cooperation with several Asean member states, he said, pointing to the deal finalised with Philippines for supplying BrahMos cruise missiles.

In the context of trade with the Southeast Asian block, Tandon said New Delhi wants the review of the Asean India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA) to be completed "as soon as possible". India is also engaged in discussions with individual Asean member states for trade facilitation and trade agreements to open up new opportunities, he said.

Tandon acknowledged that the review of AITIGA is a "difficult" process as it involves developing consensus with all Asean member states. AITIGA entered into force in 2010 and the review began six years ago, largely because of India's concerns about trade imbalance due to imports of more than $80 billion from Asean member states. Asked about India's position on dealing with the situation in Myanmar, Tandon said: "We have always said that isolating Myanmar is not the right approach because if we do, someone else will fill the vacuum. There is no alternative to engagement."

Rajnath Singh

TECH SUPERIORITY, JOINTNESS KEY TO HANDLING FUTURE THREATS: RAJNATH

NEW DELHI: Surprise, technological superiority, and jointness will be critical to boosting the operational readiness of the armed forces to meet future security challenges, defence minister Rajnath Singh said on Thursday. Identifying potential threats before they unfold is equally important, he said.

Charting the way forward for military preparedness at the Air Force Commanders' Conference, he said, "Our defence forces must develop capabilities and methods that leave the adversary with no time to react or recover, while simultaneously ensuring that we are never caught off guard. Surprise can manifest in various forms, both conventional and electronic. Our intelligence and surveillance mechanisms must be further strengthened to respond effectively to any emerging challenge."

IAF chief Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit and defence secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh were present.

Singh said the revamped Agnipath scheme will further strengthen the three services.

He said contemporary conflicts are extending beyond traditional battlefields into non-contact domains, with missiles, drones and advanced weapon systems playing a significant role. Referring to the Russia-Ukraine and Israel-Hamas conflicts, he said that drones and air defence systems have emerged as critical components of modern warfare. He asked commanders to remain prepared for emerging challenges such as kamikaze drones, and counter-UAS (unmanned aerial systems) operations.

"Victory in future conflicts will depend not merely on the number of aircraft, but also on technological sophistication, speed of response and precision in planning." HTC

Professionals' mobility key in Canada deal talks

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TORONTO/NEW DELHI: The mobility of professionals is part of ongoing negotiations between India and Canada for a comprehensive economic partnership agreement (CEPA) that the two sides are hoping to finalise by the end of the year, people familiar with the matter said.

The two sides will hold the sixth round of negotiations for the trade deal this week, and economic ties and cooperation in key areas such as critical minerals and energy have been spurred by a turnaround in the overall relationship since Mark Carney was elected Canada's PM in March last year. The two countries are looking to finalise talks on the trade deal before Prime Minister Narendra Modi visits Canada during December 11-12.

The mobility of professionals is among the items on the agenda, five people familiar with the negotiations said. One of them said mobility is being considered under the services chapter of the proposed trade deal, specially to enable businesses investing in either country to bring in temporary workers.

Discussions have centered around the movement of skilled workers under a quota system for the numbers to be admitted annually, another person said. Mobility of professionals and students has emerged as a focus area for India in recent years, and migration and mobility partnerships have been concluded with close to 30 countries, most of them in Europe.

India and Canada also held their maiden migration and mobility dialogue in New Delhi on October 26. A readout from the Indian side emphasised the "natural complementarity between India's young and skilled workforce and Canada's demographic and labour market trends, which makes well-managed mobility the need of the hour". The discussions focused on mobility of students, professionals, skilled workers and business visitors, and cooperation on migration management.

Union minister Ram Mohan Naidu Kinjarapu with Canada's international trade minister Maninder Sidhu in Visakhapatnam on Thursday. ANI

Canada currently hosts one of the largest Indian diaspora communities, with more than 1.8 million Canadians of Indian origin and an estimated one million non-resident Indians.

While the Canadian side has sought quotas for its export of pulses and lentils, the Indian side has indicated that it prefers to handle this issue through preferential tariff rates or tariff-relieved access for these commodities, on the lines of the arrangements under the India-Australia economic cooperation and trade agreement, the people said.

Canada is second only to Australia as a supplier of pulses to India. India's imports of pulses in the first quarter of 2026 were worth about $6.51 billion, with Canada accounting for $1.01 billion or 15.56% of the total. Canada's top pulses exported to India are lentils, yellow peas and chickpeas. The two sides have also established a Pulse Protein Centre of Excellence in India.

India and Canada are now focused on completing the trade negotiations by the end of November, with officials from both sides expected to meet twice to deal with outstanding issues as items that have already been decided upon undergo legal scrubbing, the people said.

Canada's international trade minister Maninder Sidhu, who is in India for the sixth round of negotiations on the trade deal and met commerce minister Piyush Goyal on Wednesday, told a business meet in Visakhapatnam on Thursday that the two sides are hoping to conclude the talks by the time of Modi's visit. He said Canada is looking to do more with India in fields such as energy, especially LNG, nuclear power, resilient supply chains, fertilisers and investments by Canadian pension funds.

"Our goal is to double bilateral trade to $70 billion by 2030. A free trade agreement will help us get there faster," Sindhu said on social media.

Total trade in goods between India and Canada was worth Canadian $13.55 billion in 2025, with Indian exports accounting for Canadian $9.68 billion, while bilateral trade in services was worth Canadian $19.62 billion, with India's exports pegged at Canadian $4.45 billion. Investments from Canada into India are estimated at more than Canadian $100 billion, and more than 600 Canadian companies have a presence in India.

ED gets four-day custody of Azam Khan

LUCKNOW: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has secured four days' custodial remand of jailed Samajwadi Party leader and former Uttar Pradesh minister Azam Khan in a money-laundering case linked to Mohammad Ali Jauhar University in Rampur. The remand, granted by a special PMLA court in Ghaziabad, will run from 4.30pm on November 12 to 4.30pm on November 16. ED will take Khan to its Delhi headquarters for questioning. The agency alleges diversion of public funds and assets worth ₹426.46 crore. Khan was arrested on October 31.

Cops: Man jumps off mall after girlfriend refuses to marry him

KANPUR: A 36-year-old man allegedly died by suicide after jumping off the second floor of a mall in Kanpur following an argument with his girlfriend over marriage, police said on Thursday.

The incident took place at Rave Moti Mall in the posh Sarvodaya Nagar area on Wednesday evening.

The man was rushed to Regency Hospital, where doctors declared him dead.

His body has been sent for post-mortem examination, said ACP (Swaroop Nagar) Jyoti Shri.

U'khand police seek Delhi, CBI records in plaint against Rawat

DEHRADUN: The Uttarakhand Police have written to their Delhi counterparts and the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI), seeking documents related to a 2016 and a 2003 case after a 39-year-old Assam woman levelled fresh rape allegations against Congress leader Harak Singh Rawat. Police officer Vandana Verma said, "It may take some time as we need to connect the dots." Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma met the woman and extended his support.

CHRISTIAN BODIES OPPOSE FCRA BILL BEFORE PARL PANEL

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NEW DELHI: Some Christian bodies on Thursday vehemently opposed the proposed amendments to the foreign donation laws before a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC), arguing that the bill can destroy the religious independence of the minority communities.

Apostles Methodist Church, National Council of Churches in India, Evangelical Church of India and Jesus Redeems appeared before the JPC led by Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) lawmaker Sanjay Jaiswal on the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA) Amendment Bill. The bodies also said the proposed law can lead to halting services rendered to marginalised sections of the society.

The bodies also opposed the creation of a designated authority under the new Bill that can take control of foreign contributions and assets when an organisation's FCRA registration ceases, is cancelled or surrendered. At least two bodies, according to functionaries aware of the details, also objected to the clause of the Bill that says even assets created partially out of foreign donations can be vested or transferred to appropriate ministries of the government.

According to two functionaries, BJP MP Nishikant Dubey argued that in Kerala, a law was passed in 2023 — The Kerala Forest (Vesting and Management of Ecologically Fragile Lands) Act — and had taken over private land for ecological conservation under specific forest-protection laws. Dubey argued that many temples and churches were vested under the law and wondered why these church bodies didn't raise a hue and cry over it. In the meeting, RSS-linked organisations hailed the proposed legislation terming it as a right step towards regulating foreign funding.

The Bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25 and referred to JPC on August 12.

WB hijack hoax accused held; cites ailing wife, foreign posting

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NEW DELHI: A hijack threat note found in the toilet of a Kolkata-Mumbai flight on Wednesday was written by a 56-year-old passenger who has claimed he wanted to skip an overseas posting by his employer so that he could take care of his ailing wife, police said on Thursday.

The man was identified as the author of the note after passengers were made to take a handwriting test at Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose International Airport in Kolkata, where Air India flight AI 2772 was held up for several hours after the security scare. "The passenger who was to fly to Mumbai was handed over to the airport police after his handwriting matched with that on the threat note," an official aware of the matter told HT.

THE AUTHOR OF THE NOTE WAS IDENTIFIED AFTER PASSENGERS WERE MADE TO TAKE A HANDWRITING TEST AT AIRPORT

The resident of Sodepur in North 24 Parganas was scheduled to board an international flight from Mumbai later in the day, officials said, adding that he was arrested late on Wednesday.

The aircraft, an Airbus A320 (VT-TNH), was to depart for Mumbai on Wednesday morning. The handwritten note warning that the aircraft would be hijacked at 11.10am was found in the lavatory by the cabin crew around 10.37am, officials said.

Air Traffic Control was alerted and the aircraft was moved to an isolation bay. All 105 passengers and seven crew members were deboarded and the aircraft and baggage were searched.

"The wallets of some passengers were also checked. Based on preliminary investigation a man was detained for further questioning," another official said.

The man, who worked for a private company, was being sent abroad. "During questioning the man told airport security officials that he was reluctant to go abroad as his wife was ailing. Hence, he left a note in the aircraft's lavatory stating that it would be hijacked, hoping that the threat would delay the flight and eventually force cancellation of his journey," an official said.

After security checks were completed, the aircraft departed for Mumbai at 5.38pm.

Trainer aircraft mishap

A trainer aircraft skidded off the runway at Solapur airport in Maharashtra on Thursday after its nose wheel tyre burst during landing, police said, adding that the pilot was unhurt. The Italian-made Tecnam P-Mentor aircraft was operated by Redbird Flight Training Academy. In December 2025, the same aircraft belonging to the private academy had crashed near Suktara airfield in Madhya Pradesh. PTI

ARMY JAWAN AMONG 3 HELD FOR KILLING WOMAN IN REVENGE

HALDWANI: Three men, including an Army jawan, were arrested on Thursday for allegedly murdering a woman in Uttarakhand's Nainital district as part of a revenge plot linked to the killing of the soldier's father in 2023, police said.

The woman, Vimla Devi, 56, was allegedly assaulted and drowned before her body was dumped outside a residence in Kishanpur Choi village, police said.

The arrested men were identified as Mohit Fartyal, 32, a jawan posted with the Rajputana Rifles regiment, and Sairan, 21, and Mohammad Abbuzar, 22, both residents of Ramnagar, police said. HTC

20-year-old pushed onto Mumbai tracks after molestation, loses arm

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MUMBAI: A 20-year-old woman lost her left arm after she was allegedly molested and pushed onto the railway tracks at Naigaon station in Maharashtra, police said on Thursday, adding that the 53-year-old accused has been arrested.

Police said the incident occurred on November 4 after the woman confronted the accused Jitendra Hirmukhe for allegedly molesting her while they were travelling in the handicapped compartment of a Virar-bound local train. Hirmukhe was arrested on Wednesday from his house in Naigaon and produced in court on Thursday, when he was remanded in police custody, police said.

"Hirmukhe, who was travelling in the same compartment, began touching her inappropriately once the train passed Mira Road. When she confronted him at Naigaon station, he pushed her out of the train, alighted from the train himself and continued arguing with her on the platform," an officer from the Bhayander Government Railway Police station said.

Hirmukhe flew into a rage and pushed her again, this time onto the tracks, in the space between two compartments of a local train. The train started moving even as she was trying to climb up onto the platform, crushing her left arm beneath its wheels, the officer said.

The woman was later shifted to Cooper Hospital, where doctors had to amputate her left arm beneath the elbow due to the severity of her injuries. "Since the accused had covered his face, it was difficult to identify him. But we traced and identified him by going through CCTV footage. On Wednesday, we arrested him," the officer quoted earlier said.

Hirmukhe has been booked under BNS sections 74 (assault or criminal force to a woman with intent to outrage her modesty) and 109 (attempt to murder).

EMAIL TO MAYOR'S OFFICE THREATENS BIG B, DOSANJH; COPS SUSPECT HOAX

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MUMBAI: A bomb threat email was received by the office of Mumbai Mayor Ritu Tawde threatening to target her office, actor Amitabh Bachchan, singer-actor Diljit Dosanjh and several city-based schools, police said, adding that the responsibility for the email has been claimed by an outfit that calls itself Khalistan National Army (KNA).

The police said they conducted the required checks on receipt of the email and nothing suspicious was found. The email was received by the Mayor's office at 11.30 am on Thursday.

The email threatened to target the Mayor's office at 3 pm, the schools at 1 pm, Bachchan's Jalsa bungalow in Juhu from October 31 to November 27. The police suspect KNA is the same group that has been sending hoax emails over the past few months.

"Singer Diljit Dosanjh's 'India Tour' concert is scheduled on November 27 at the Mahalaxmi Racecourse. The Delhi police have already rejected permission to his concert there citing security concerns," an officer said.

DCP Manish Kalwaniya of Zone 1, Mumbai Police, said, "A threat mail was received at BMC office, checking has been done and nothing suspicious found."

Kejriwal received threats from Bishnoi gang, says AAP MLA; FIR lodged

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MOHALI: Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief Arvind Kejriwal and his daughter have allegedly received death threats and an extortion demand of ₹7 crore from a person claiming to be a Lawrence Bishnoi gang member, following which the Punjab police have registered a case.

Delhi AAP MLA Jarnail Singh said he has lodged a complaint with Mohali cybercrime police, alleging that he received a phone call and messages on his personal mobile number on November 6, with the caller allegedly identifying himself as Bishnoi gang member and asked him to convey the extortion demand to Kejriwal. The caller also sent messages through WhatsApp and SMS from the same mobile number, according to the complaint, he added.

While HT's requests to senior superintendent of police for confirmation went unanswered, news agency PTI said Cyber Crime Police Station in Mohali had lodged an FIR in the case on November 7 under relevant sections including 308 (4) (extortion), 351 (2) (criminal intimidation), 351 (4) (criminal intimidation by anonymous communication), 111 (2) (organised crime) of the BNS and the relevant section of the IT Act

Arvind Kejriwal

In his complaint, Singh said: "Given his stature as a high-profile figure, the threat has caused national and public security risks. The sender has unlawfully used my position as an elected representative to channel extortionist demands and death threats directed at Arvind Kejriwal and his family. The acts committed by the sender constitute serious offences." He also asked the police to trace the number's call records, internet protocol logs and location details, identify those behind the messages and arrest them.

Punjab AAP chief spokesperson Kuldeep Singh Dhaliwal also condemned the threat, saying, "AAP leaders are neither afraid nor will we bow down to such threats. We will not stop working for the people of Punjab and the country. Those involved in this conspiracy must be exposed before the public."

India accounts for 25% of global TB cases: WHO

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NEW DELHI: An estimated 10.6 million people fell ill with tuberculosis (TB) worldwide in 2025, 75,000 fewer than in 2024, while India continued to account for about a quarter of the global burden, according to the World Health Organization's (WHO) Global TB Report 2026, released on Thursday.

The global TB incidence rate declined 1.6% to 129 cases per 100,000 people in 2025, from 131 the previous year. However, the 14% reduction between 2015 and 2025 remains far below the End TB Strategy's target of a 50% reduction by 2025.

The 30 high-burden countries accounted for 88% of estimated cases, with India contributing about a quarter, followed by Indonesia (10%), the Philippines (6.8%), China (6.5%) and Pakistan (6.4%).

India recorded a 38% decline in TB mortality since 2015, compared with a global reduction of 35%. The country also reported a 94% treatment success rate among patients with drug-susceptible TB. The mortality rate fell from 28 per 100,000 population in 2015 to 18 per 100,000 in 2025.

The report acknowledged India's efforts to strengthen prevention and care through the National TB Elimination Programme (NTEP). "In recent years, the National TB Elimination Programme in India has made substantial efforts to improve TB prevention and care, with the goal of accelerating reductions in TB mortality and TB incidence," it said, noting the establishment of district-level surveillance to track TB disease and infection.

INDIA RECORDED A 38% DECLINE IN TB MORTALITY SINCE 2015, COMPARED WITH A GLOBAL REDUCTION OF 35%, THE GLOBAL TB REPORT 2026 SAID

It also highlighted community-based screening under the TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan. Between December 2024 and March 2026, the campaign screened more than 28 crore vulnerable people and notified over 39 lakh TB patients, including nearly 13 lakh without symptoms.

India has expanded its molecular testing network to nearly 11,000 facilities and provides nutritional support through the Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana and Ni-kshay Mitras initiative. The WHO has recommended newer diagnostic approaches, including portable molecular tests, tongue swabs for people unable to produce sputum and pooled sputum testing to reduce costs.

"These achievements, highlighted in the World Health Organization's (WHO) Global Tuberculosis Report reflect India's sustained progress towards eliminating TB through early detection, timely treatment, technological innovation and comprehensive patient care," the Union ministry of health and family welfare said in a statement.

Abhishek Banerjee

HC SLAMS ABHISHEK BANERJEE'S REMARK ON BIAS BY JUDGES

HT Correspondent
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KOLKATA: The Calcutta high court on Thursday took exception to Mamata All India Trinamool Congress (MAITC) lawmaker Abhishek Banerjee's remarks on a section of a judiciary, observing that he should submit a list of judges who favour the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and those supporting All India Trinamool Congress.

"Ask your client. Who are the judges with the BJP? Please give the list. Your client is very intelligent as per the statement. Let your client give the list who belong to the BJP and who belong to the AITC," a bench of justice Krishna Rao said.

Reacting to the development, MAITC leader Baiswanor Chatterjee said, "I am not aware of what he (Banerjee) said under what circumstances. I cannot comment on what the bench observed in courtroom...."

Meanwhile, BJP spokesperson Priyanka Tibrewal said, "...Law takes its own course and no one is above the law. If someone is speaking out against judges, that is surely contempt."

Chhattisgarh liquor case key accused held in UAE

Neeraj Chauhan
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NEW DELHI: Vikas Agrawal, a key accused in an alleged ₹2,883-crore Chhattisgarh liquor scam who was absconding for the past several years, has been caught in Dubai and may be brought to India very soon, at least three officials told HT.

The alleged irregularities pertain to the illegal sale of unaccounted and duty-evaded liquor through state-run liquor outlets, allegedly under the protection of senior excise and other Chhattisgarh government officials between 2019 and 2023. A liquor syndicate led by businessman Anwar Dhebar and retired IAS officer Anil Tuteja manipulated the state's excise system to generate illegal proceeds exceeding ₹2,883 crore, according to the Enforcement Directorate (ED). Senior Congress leader and former chief minister Bhupesh Baghel's son Chaitanya Baghel has already been charged in the case.

"Vikas Agrawal, who is an important link in the Chhattisgarh liquor syndicate's financial operations, was arrested in Dubai in the third week of October. He is in the custody of the UAE authorities right now. His repatriation has also been almost approved by the UAE authorities and we believe that he would very soon be brought to India after completing all the formalities," said one of the officials cited above, adding that he was absconding since sometime in 2023.

SO FAR, 85 PEOPLE HAVE BEEN NAMED AS ACCUSED UNDER THE PREVENTION OF MONEY LAUNDERING ACT (PMLA) IN SIX CHARGE SHEETS

In a statement issued on June 1 this year, while attaching assets worth ₹1,000 crore in the case, ED said that "Vikas Agrawal functioned as the ground-level financial manager of the syndicate, collecting commissions from distilleries and FL-10A (foreign liquor) licensees and routing funds directly to Anwar Dhebar".

According to ED, the liquor syndicate operated through four channels. Under Part A, commissions were allegedly collected from distilleries by artificially inflating the price of liquor procured by the Chhattisgarh State Marketing Corporation Limited, the state-run liquor procurement and distribution agency. Under Part B, unaccounted country liquor was allegedly manufactured and sold through government liquor shops using duplicate holograms, with the proceeds bypassing the state exchequer. In Part C, annual commissions from distilleries were taken to secure fixed market shares, while the fourth mechanism involved extracting commissions from foreign liquor manufacturers through the FL-10A licensing system.

ED's probe has revealed that the syndicate's proceeds of crime were distributed among political executives, bureaucrats and private beneficiaries, a second official said.

So far, 85 people have been named as accused under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) in six charge sheets. Former Chhattisgarh Congress treasurer Ramgopal Agrawal and former excise minister Kawasi Lakhma have also been named in the charge sheets. The agency has also seized or attached assets worth more than ₹600 crore in the case as of now.

ED has been probing the alleged liquor irregularities in Chhattisgarh since 2022 but its previous probe was quashed by the Supreme Court on April 8, 2024 as it was based on an income-tax complaint and didn't form part of the scheduled offence, a requirement for it to proceed with money laundering probes.

However, a day later, on April 9, 2024, ED filed a fresh case in the matter based on a FIR filed by Chhattisgarh police on January 17, 2024.

HC PULLS UP SSC OVER RESTRICTIVE INTERPRETATION OF ELIGIBILITY

Shruti Kakkar
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NEW DELHI: Qualified doctors and nurses should not be denied consideration for positions due to a narrow or restrictive interpretation of the prescribed eligibility criteria, the Delhi high court said while pulling up the recruiting panel.

A bench of Justices C Hari Shankar and Nivedita Anil Sharma said the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) adopted a legally unsustainable and unnecessarily myopic view as it heard its plea against a Central Administrative Tribunal (CAT)'s January 29 order in favour of a woman rejected for a nursing officer (allopathic) post advertised in January 2024.

The candidature of the woman, possessing a post-basic BSc nursing qualification, was rejected because she obtained registration after the prescribed cut-off date. The woman approached the tribunal, which allowed her application.

The CAT observed that the Delhi Nursing Council issued her a certificate registering her as a nurse in 2018, before the cut-off date.

The SSC moved the high court challenging that order. It argued that the certificate issued in 2018 could not have been taken into consideration as it was issued before the candidate obtained the requisite essential BSc qualification prescribed in the advertisement.

The court dismissed SSC's petition and reprimanded it for rejecting the candidature based on a narrow view. It asked SSC to abide by the CAT's ruling in four weeks.

"We feel that the SSC ought to have graciously accepted the order of the Tribunal instead of challenging it...," the court said in it's November 2 verdict, which was released four days later.

The court called doctors and nurses assets to society.

"A professional doctor or nurse, who is actually qualified, should not be thrown out of consideration by adopting an unjustifiably restricted view of the prescribed qualifications," it said.

Six researchers win Infosys Prize 2026

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BENGALURU: The Infosys Science Foundation (ISF) on Thursday announced the winners of the Infosys Prize 2026 in six categories.

The six categories are economics, engineering and computer science, humanities and social sciences, life sciences, mathematical sciences, and physical sciences.

The Infosys Prize 2026 in Economics is awarded to Karthik Sastry, Associate Professor of Economics and Public Affairs at Princeton University, for his pioneering contributions to the field of climate change, and technological innovation, and to the study of business cycle fluctuations.

Engineering and Computer Science award is awarded to Swarun Kumar, Assistant Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering at Carnegie Mellon University, for his pioneering work in low-power wireless networks beyond information delivery to perception and action in the physical world.

In the Humanities and Social Sciences category, Gautam Bhatia, Adjunct Professor at Jindal Global Law School and Green Fellow at the University of New South Wales in Sydney was chosen.

The ISF chose Isha Jain, Associate Investigator at the Gladstone Institutes and Assistant Professor at the Department of Biochemistry at the University of California, San Francisco for her discoveries in oxygen biology, which showed that tissue damage in some mitochondrial diseases arises from excess oxygen rather than energy failure, and for turning fundamental biochemical insights into new therapeutic strategies, including designing a small-molecule to reduce oxygen levels and vitamin-based treatments for inherited metabolic disorders.

In Mathematical Sciences category, the award is given to Riddhipratim Basu, Associate Professor at the International Centre for Theoretical Sciences of the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (ICTS-TIFR) in Bengaluru.

In Physical Sciences category, Manoj Kumar Joshi, an experimental physicist and Assistant Professor at Singapore University of Technology and Design (SUTD) has been chosen.

It further said that the laureates of Infosys Prize 2026 were selected by an international panel of jurors comprising renowned scholars and experts.

"The prize for each category comprises a gold medal, a citation, and a prize purse of USD 100,000 (or its equivalent in INR)," ISF said in a statement.

Narayana Murthy addressed the audience in a recorded message, the statement said.

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{ OUR TAKE }

Fertiliser subsidy move is prudent

It will stretch the overall fiscal math, but fertiliser prices are critical to farm balance sheets. Support amid poor rainfall and supply chain issues is vital

On Wednesday, the Union government announced a revised subsidy allocation for phosphatic and potassic fertilisers for the *rabi* (winter) cropping season. The new allocation of ₹62,370 crore is 64% more than the Union budget allocated. This is yet another indication that the overall fertiliser subsidy allocation — the 2026-27 budget estimate was ₹1.71 lakh crore — will be significantly higher. It will also stretch the overall fiscal math.

These numbers need to be seen in context. Just a month after the budget was presented, the US and Israel attacked Iran which later shut the Strait of Hormuz inflicting a huge disruption on hydrocarbon trade from West Asia. Fertiliser prices went through the roof and supplies nosedived. The real worry back then — not anymore for India, thankfully — was whether India would even be able to source adequate fertilisers for domestic crop production. As the world's most populous country, maintaining adequate food production is absolutely critical for India.

The government did two things in response to the crisis. It made it clear that the higher fertiliser costs would not be passed on to farmers, and it threw the kitchen sink at securing fertiliser supplies irrespective of the prices. This will lead to higher spending, as seen in the revised fertiliser subsidy numbers, but it has achieved something far more valuable.

Because fertiliser prices are critical to farm balance sheets, clarity about them is essential for cropping decisions by farmers. Lingering uncertainty about higher prices and insufficient supplies would have introduced precariousness in cropping decisions. A food inflation shock was almost certain to follow. That this has been a low-rainfall year would have only made the supply shock worse. All of these scenarios are significantly worse than the fiscal deficit being higher by a few basis points.

Beyond this short-term justification for the government's decision to spend more on fertilisers, are there any larger learnings here? Two factors stand out. India's fiscal wherewithal allows it to weather cyclical shocks much better than smaller emerging market economies can. This is what sustained long-term growth achieves for a country. Last but not the least is the importance of building domestic capacity in critical value chains. This is what will bestow low-cost resilience to such shocks on the economy in the future.

Finding treasure in the scrap heap

Critical minerals are now instruments of statecraft, and so is the waste that contains them. China accounts for more than three-quarters of the world's capacity to pre-treat battery waste and 90% of the capacity to recover materials from it. The European Union reclassified black mass, the powder left when spent lithium-ion batteries and battery-factory waste are shredded, as hazardous waste in March 2025, with the stated aim of keeping it in the European economy.

Until this week, India allowed black mass generated here to be shipped abroad, even as, the commerce ministry says, domestic recycling plants ran below capacity for want of feedstock and some recyclers had to import material to meet their needs. The Centre had meanwhile committed ₹1,500 crore, through a scheme the Cabinet approved in September 2025, to building more of that capacity. India was exporting a supply of lithium it did not have to mine. By prohibiting those exports, the Directorate General of Foreign Trade has ended a contradiction that should not have lasted.

An outright prohibition is a blunt tool. Shutting out foreign buyers may depress what domestic recyclers pay for black mass and weaken the incentive to collect it, and Indian refiners will have to show they can recover lithium at scale. Neither is a case for reopening the border.

The ban was the easy half of the task. The harder half is getting dead batteries out of drawers and discarded devices and into licensed plants, which can return their lithium to electric vehicles, battery cells, energy storage and renewable power. The International Energy Agency estimates that recycling capacity announced in India would handle only a tenth of India's battery waste in 2040. There is a lot more to be done to tap into the lithium already in the country.

The East is now central to India's maritime security

New Delhi's approach is to strengthen ASEAN-led institutions while simultaneously building practical security partnerships with individual countries such as the Philippines

India's ties with ASEAN are a means of displaying its strategic autonomy and establishing its credibility as a security partner in Southeast Asia. PTI

Manoj Joshi

With West Asia caught in conflict, India's attention is turning east. There is certainly enough happening in Southeast Asia to command New Delhi's attention. The Philippines will host the ASEAN summit in Manila on November 16-18; the East Asia Summit, the India-ASEAN summit, and the long-deferred Quad leaders' meeting are scheduled to be held in parallel. This provides a unique opportunity for India to advance its diplomatic, economic, and security interests in the Indo-Pacific.

Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi will be leading the Indian delegation and will likely have bilateral meetings with host President Ferdinand Marcos Jr as well as with US President Donald Trump, who will be there for a short while before flying to Shenzhen to attend the APEC summit. The APEC event will likely garner much more international attention, given the possibility of a Trump-Putin-Xi meeting. But for India, which is not a member of APEC, the ASEAN summits will be more rewarding.

The promotion of maritime security, digital integration, and new trade agreements will be India's focus for the meetings. India has designated 2026 as the ASEAN-India Year of Maritime Cooperation. Given how the ongoing Iran war has played out, India will stress not only freedom of navigation but also the safety of seafarers. India's public posture will be to press for adherence to UNCLOS and emphasise the centrality of ASEAN in its East Asian outlook.

But India's policy moves in Southeast Asia will be difficult to sustain unless they are accompanied by stronger trade, investment and connectivity links. To this end, New Delhi will seek a fast-track review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA) to tackle current trade asymmetries and streamline market access. The need to build on the ASEAN-India Digital Work Plan will be another focus area, and India is likely to offer its indigenous Digital Public Infrastructure stack, comprising Aadhaar, e-KYC, and UPI, among others.

New Delhi will back initiatives on supply-chain de-risking both in the context of ASEAN and Quad. India's priorities at the summits show a significant overlap with the goals of Quad on issues such as maritime security, supply-chain resilience and counter-coercion. India is part of the Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness, whose aim is to track dark shipping and illegal fishing.

As for supply-chain resilience, Quad has established clear working groups on semiconductor supply chains, critical minerals, and open-RAN telecommunications. At the EAS, India puts these frameworks into action by backing regional connectivity projects and multi-layered economic infrastructure, directly implementing Quad's tech-security goals across the wider East Asian landscape.

To counter the criticism that Quad is an Asian NATO, all four members explicitly pledge allegiance to ASEAN centrality. PM Modi uses the EAS — where ASEAN is the driving force — to prove this commitment. By strengthening the EAS, India ensures Quad remains a complementary economic and security anchor rather than an alienating alternative to Southeast Asian diplomacy.

India has significantly expanded its strategic and military footprint in the South China Sea, shifting from a cautious stance to active security and defence cooperation — most notably with the Philippines. Over 55% of India's trade passes through the South China Sea and the Malacca Straits, making freedom of navigation and regional deterrence critical national interests. India has backed the 2016 Arbitral Tribunal Award that rejected China's Nine-Dash Line.

In January 2022, India signed a $375-million deal to supply shore-based BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles to the Philippines. These missiles are deployed in western Luzon, facing the contested waters near Scarborough Shoal. Reports suggest that the two countries are in the final stage of talks to expand the deal to cover 60 more missiles.

In August 2025, the Indian Navy and the Philippine Navy conducted their first-ever joint naval exercise inside the Philippines' exclusive economic zone (EEZ) in the South China Sea, where they were shadowed by Chinese vessels. During the State visit of President Marcos Jr. to India the same month, the two sides elevated their ties to a Strategic Partnership and adopted a 2025-2029 Action Plan focused on maritime domain awareness, capacity-building, and defence trade. India has extended support for the Filipino Coast Guard, including offering utility helicopters and maritime capacity-building assistance.

By enabling the Philippines to build coastal and anti-ship deterrence (via BrahMos and joint patrols), India is subtly pushing back against the Chinese salami-slicing tactics it faces in the Himalayas. India's ties with ASEAN are a means of displaying its strategic autonomy and establishing its credibility as a defence supplier and security partner in Southeast Asia.

India has long-standing maritime ties with ASEAN, considering it shares a maritime border with three ASEAN countries — Myanmar, Thailand, and Indonesia. In the 1990s, New Delhi hosted the MILAN exercises in the Andaman Sea with several ASEAN countries. Since 1994, it has held the SIMBEX exercise with Singapore, which is India's longest uninterrupted naval exercise. It also conducts regular Coordinated Patrols (CORPAT) and joint maritime exercises with several ASEAN countries.

In 2023, India inaugurated a formal ASEAN-India maritime exercise (AIME), whose first edition was held off Singapore and the South China Sea. The second set of exercises was held between September 28 and Oct 2, 2026, off the Philippines.

The Manila summit will, therefore, be an opportunity for India to consolidate its growing engagement with Southeast Asia at a time when the strategic contest in the Indo-Pacific is intensifying. New Delhi's approach is to strengthen ASEAN-led institutions while simultaneously building practical security partnerships with individual countries such as the Philippines. For India, the East is no longer simply an extension of its Act East policy; it is increasingly central to its own security, economic resilience and strategic positioning in the Indo-Pacific.

Manoj Joshi is a distinguished fellow, Observer Research Foundation, New Delhi. The views expressed are personal

Not just EVs, India needs a national transport policy

The Union finance ministry's decision to make electric vehicles (EVs) the default choice for Union government staff cars marks a significant change in India's approach to electric mobility. Under the revised guidelines issued on November 10, EVs will be preferred when existing government vehicles are replaced; the permissible purchase price ceiling has been raised to ₹20 lakh, compared with ₹10 lakh for conventional vehicles.

The significance goes beyond government purchasing more electric cars. By making EVs the preferred option, rather than simply incentivising their adoption, the government is beginning to use public procurement to create demand. But the decision also raises an important question: How does India ensure that such interventions contribute to a coherent, long-term mobility transition?

India's EV market has expanded considerably, particularly in two- and three-wheelers, supported by central incentives, State policies and private investment. Yet, adoption remains uneven across vehicle segments and states. More importantly, ministries and agencies continue to advance electrification, alternative fuels, vehicle efficiency and charging infrastructure through programmes that are not always aligned in their objectives or implementation timelines.

Ria Sinha

The challenge is no longer simply to promote more EVs. We must plan to establish how different mobility solutions can collectively reduce petroleum dependence, improve air quality and deliver progressively lower carbon emissions.

Government fleets are well suited to electrification. Their operating patterns, parking arrangements, and replacement cycles are relatively predictable, allowing charging infrastructure and vehicle requirements to be planned together. Aggregated demand can also improve procurement efficiency and provide greater certainty to manufacturers and service providers.

However, increasing the purchase price ceiling should not translate into higher expenditure without corresponding benefits. Procurement decisions must consider total cost of ownership, including vehicle utilisation, electricity tariffs, charging costs, maintenance and residual value.

Equally important is infrastructure readiness. Procuring EVs without adequate charging facilities or electricity distribution capacity could undermine their operational and financial benefits. Government fleet electrification should, therefore, become an opportunity to establish measurable benchmarks for charging reliability, utilisation and lifecycle costs.

These lessons can inform wider electrification across public transport, commercial fleets and state government operations. But scaling such initiatives requires a national framework.

India should adopt a phased transition from Business-as-Usual (BAU) to Clean Mobility and ultimately Green Mobility, guided by a National Clean Mobility Policy. This distinction is consequential. Clean mobility focuses on reducing local pollution and dependence on conventional fuels, whereas green mobility must progressively achieve substantially lower lifecycle emissions, including those associated with electricity generation, fuel production and batteries. Electrification is central to this transition, but other technologies must be assessed against comparable economic and environmental criteria.

A credible roadmap should establish three planning periods. During 2026-2029, the priority must be building readiness: This means strengthening charging infrastructure, distribution network capacity, interoperability standards and financing arrangements. Government fleet procurement can provide valuable operational evidence, while states should identify infrastructure and investment gaps across different transport segments.

Between 2029 and 2035, attention should shift towards scaling solutions that demonstrate commercial and operational viability: Electric buses, urban freight and commercial fleets will require coordinated investments in vehicles, charging infrastructure and electricity networks. Fleet aggregation, leasing, targeted guarantees and risk-sharing mechanisms can help address financing constraints, particularly where high upfront costs and uncertain utilisation discourage private investment.

From 2035 to 2047, the emphasis should increasingly move towards genuinely green mobility: Technology choices must reflect lifecycle emissions, the changing electricity mix, resource efficiency and long-term energy security.

Strengthening public transport and shifting suitable passenger and freight movement towards more efficient modes must remain integral to this transition.

The objective should not be to prescribe one technology across all vehicle categories, but to establish transparent criteria for deciding which solutions are appropriate, where and when. Who will coordinate the transition? A national policy will have limited value without a mechanism to deliver it.

India, therefore, needs a National Clean Mobility Mission that can coordinate implementation across ministries, states, financial institutions and industry.

The division of responsibilities should be explicit: Policy sets the direction, the mission coordinates delivery, schemes provide targeted instruments, and projects translate priorities into measurable outcomes.

Such an arrangement would connect vehicle procurement and adoption targets with charging infrastructure, grid preparedness, financing and institutional accountability. Common national standards would provide consistency, while states retain flexibility to respond to local circumstances.

Annual monitoring, supported by substantive policy reviews in 2029 and 2035, would allow interventions to be adjusted as technologies, costs and market conditions evolve. Progress should be assessed through reliable mobility services, affordability, petroleum displaced, charging performance and lifecycle emissions, rather than vehicle registrations alone.

The wider significance of the finance ministry's decision, however, will depend on whether the lessons from procurement inform larger investment and policy decisions. India has demonstrated that targeted interventions can accelerate EV adoption.

The next task is to ensure that these interventions work together. Making EVs the default choice for government cars is a start; making coordinated, economically viable and progressively greener mobility the basis of national transport policy is the real challenge.

Ria Sinha is senior fellow, Chintan Research Foundation. The views expressed are personal

{ NARENDRA MODI } PRIME MINISTER

There are as many opinions as there are people in the country. And such diverse perspectives uphold our democracy... And in this, the Indian media certainly plays an enormous role

When cancer hits, the cost of treatment shouldn't bite

Cancer changes a family's life in an instant. Patients and their loved ones must confront difficult decisions about treatment, finances and the future. For many households, medicine costs become an added burden at a time when every resource should be devoted to recovery. A compassionate health system must respond to the financial distress the disease causes.

Keeping this in mind, the Union government has rationalised trade margins for 137 identified non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs: The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) capped the margins at 30% of the maximum retail price (MRP). The revised prices came into effect on November 9, 2026. The price a patient pays must reflect fair and reasonable distribution margins, not excessive mark-ups.

Jagat Prakash Nadda

The results are already visible at the pharmacy counter. Over 80 pharmaceutical companies have notified revised MRPs for 1,366 products covering 121 of the 137 drugs. Prices have fallen for more than four out of every five of these products. For nearly half of them, the reduction is more than 50%; some even cost 96% less now. For a family paying for repeated cycles of chemotherapy, this makes a real difference to monthly treatment bills. Based on last year's consumption, patients and their families are expected to save about ₹3,500 crore every year, money that will stay in household budgets.

In 2019, the NPPA undertook a pilot Trade Margin Rationalisation (TMR) exercise covering 42 non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs, which brought down MRPs by up to 90% across 526 brands. The current measure extends this approach to a broader list of 137 drugs, identified on the recommendation of an expert committee. The list will be updated periodically.

Affordability is necessary for equitable health care. A medicine available but unaffordable is of little use to a patient. The NPPA regulates the prices of medicines under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order (DPCO), 2013, issued under the Essential Commodities Act, 1955. While it fixes ceiling prices for essential drugs listed in the National List of Essential Medicines, it monitors the annual price increase of non-scheduled medicines. However, analysis of market data showed that the gap between the ex-factory price and the price paid by the consumer was high for some non-scheduled drugs, particularly cancer medicines. The Centre has acted to correct this anomaly by capping margins.

Effective implementation of the initiative is also a focus area so that the full benefit reaches the patient and the families. Manufacturers must ensure that the revised prices reach every pharmacy and hospital, and pharmacies and hospitals must display them transparently and comply fully. Patients and caregivers can check the revised prices on the NPPA website and the Pharma Sahi Daam app, and can report overcharging.

TMR is part of a larger health transformation of the past 12 years under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The government now approaches health as a foundation for dignity, productivity and social justice. Ayushman Bharat has eased access to hospital care for vulnerable families. Under the National Programme for Prevention and Control of Non-Communicable Diseases (NP-NCD), over 500 day-care cancer centres have been set up to facilitate timely access to chemotherapy and other day-care oncology services. Ayushman Arogya Mandirs provide free screening for common cancers to citizens above 30 years of age, enabling early detection.

To strengthen tertiary care, the Tata Memorial Centre has established six hospitals at Varanasi, Visakhapatnam, New Chandigarh, Guwahati, Sangrur, and Muzaffarpur to provide comprehensive cancer care. Cancer treatment services, including diagnostic, medical and surgical facilities, have also been extended to all 22 new AIIMS.

The Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana ensures the availability of quality generic medicines at affordable prices. The Government has also set up AMRIT pharmacies to provide lifesaving and essential medicines at discounts ranging from 50-90%. To further ease treatment costs, 36 lifesaving drugs and medicines for cancer, rare diseases and chronic diseases have been fully exempted from Basic Customs Duty. The rationalisation of anti-cancer drug trade margins advances this broader commitment to affordable medicines.

TMR recognises that affordability and a healthy pharmaceutical industry must advance together. The cap applies to margins in the trade channel and leaves the manufacturer's selling price untouched. Legitimate manufacturer revenues are, therefore, protected, and with that, the capacity to keep investing in research, development and innovation. A nation's health care ecosystem is measured not only by advances in medical technology, but by whether its people can access them when they need them most. At its centre lie affordable, quality and accessible health services for every citizen. The TMR reaffirms a simple principle: No family should face avoidable financial hardship because of excessive margins on life-saving medicines.

Jagat Prakash Nadda is Union minister for health and family welfare. The views expressed are personal

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HTLS 2026 | NEW RULES. NEW REALITIES

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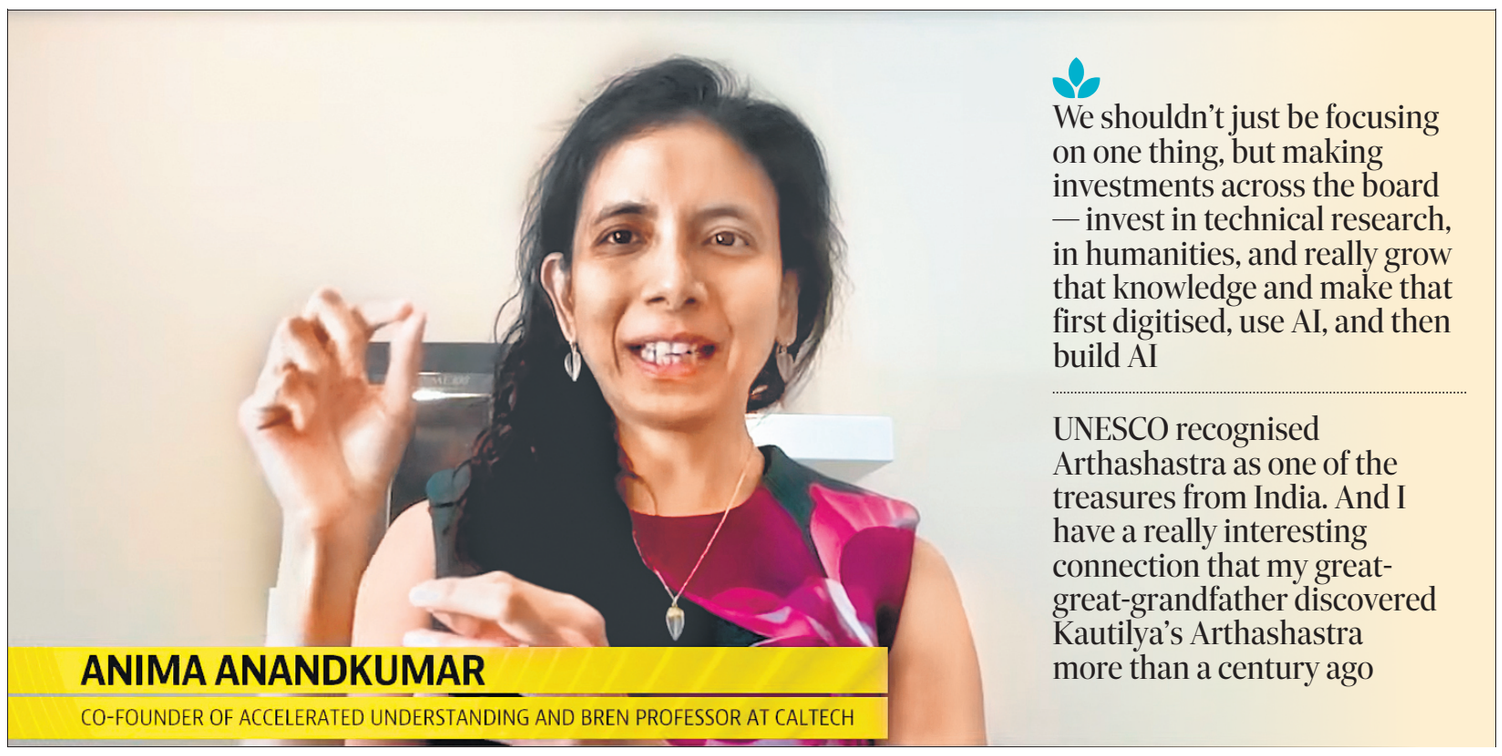
{ ANIMA ANANDKUMAR } CO-FOUNDER OF ACCELERATED UNDERSTANDING AND BREN PROFESSOR AT CALTECH

Junk LLM obsession and use AI to better understand the world



We shouldn't just be focusing on one thing, but making investments across the board — invest in technical research, in humanities, and really grow that knowledge and make that first digitised, use AI, and then build AI

UNESCO recognised Arthashastra as one of the treasures from India. And I have a really interesting connection that my great-great-grandfather discovered Kautilya's Arthashastra more than a century ago

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

A century ago, a quiet scholarly breakthrough unfolded in erstwhile Mysore, when R Shamasastry, a pioneering epigraphist, unearthed and translated Kautilya's Arthashastra, an ancient Indian Sanskrit treatise on statecraft, economic policy, and military strategy, with manuscripts preserved on fragile strips of dried palm-leaf. Shamasastry is the great-great-grandfather of Caltech computer scientist and professor Anima Anandkumar, who drew a link between her expertise – Artificial Intelligence – and the storied history of her family.

"UNESCO recognised Arthashastra as one of the treasures from India. And I have a really interesting connection that my great-great-grandfather discovered Kautilya's Arthashastra more than a century ago. Using AI even to understand our rich history, our culture, and our local traditions, is important," she said on the opening day of the 24th Hindustan Times Leadership Summit. .

"We shouldn't just be focusing on one thing, but on having investments across the board, such as investing in technical research," she said, suggesting India's rich heritage and history as well as local traditions could do with being digitised using AI.

Anandkumar, the Bren Professor of Computing and Mathematical Sciences at the California Institute of Technology and a member of the United Nations Secretary-General's Scientific Advisory Board, held two key pieces of advice. First, AI development, particularly when there is a sovereign angle involved for countries such as India, should be done in a holistic way. And secondly, language models are great, but they're not the only thing to invest in or focus on.

Anandkumar offered a sharp corrective to the industry's obsession with frontier chatbots and autonomous agents. The core flaw in modern AI hype, she argued, was the assumption that language models can reason their way through the physical world simply by generating more text.

"So much of what those generative AI models do is try to mimic the world we see, we perceive," Anandkumar noted, adding, "On the other hand, scientific modelling is about going from microscopic to macroscopic, from atomic scales all the way to planetary scales, and maybe even cosmological scales much beyond our planet."

Anandkumar's mission is to build AI that can simulate and understand the physical world, and speed up discovery. She invented neural operators for learning multi-scale phenomena that frequently occur in nature, and later used those to train the first AI-based high-resolution weather model. A neural operator is a fundamentally different type of AI, which instead of needing supercomputers to break down the atmosphere into billions of tiny mesh blocks for calculations, relies on mathematical calculations to convert physical environments into frequencies. For instance, next-generation weather forecasting, which uses this technique, is projected to be a million times faster than traditional models.

"There are a lot of physical processes that are very difficult for us to grapple with. One example is the weather. Where a hurricane goes next, for example, is really hard to predict. We can't just eyeball it and say this is how it's going to move because it has a lot of really fine-scale interactions that are difficult for us humans to understand," she said, adding that nuclear fusion was another example, where the plasma inside the reactor can behave in unexpected ways.

Her AI algorithms have enabled many other scientific advances such as modelling plasma evolution in nuclear fusion, enabling safer autonomous drone flights, and designing novel medical devices, drugs, and functional enzymes. Speed is only part of the story, Anandkumar insisted. "Speed also helps us create better risk assessment of extreme events like hurricanes, because instead of just making one prediction based on satellite data and other information, you could have hundreds or thousands of predictions based on statistical estimates of path, and other factors," she explained.

The Fourier Neural Operator (FNO) framework that Anandkumar and her team developed forms the foundation of the Nvidia Earth-2 open source suite of AI models designed to forecast weather, climate and atmospheric physics. Anandkumar previously worked at Nvidia.

Anandkumar believed India's engineering talent pool alongside investments in AI infrastructure and budding models gave the country a strong foundation. She warned that the country's focus shouldn't be limited but instead help advance the work of startups in space technology as well as batteries, for instance. "AI can help with all those processes. But it is important to think in a broader way. Language models are great, but they're not the only thing to invest in or focus on," she said.

Anandkumar believed that with frontier language models, it was important to focus on the local language aspect as well for accessibility, something she said India uniquely could achieve.

Anandkumar is deeply skeptical of Silicon Valley's latest buzzword — the autonomous AI scientist. Without rigorous grounding, she warned, such claims are little more than hallucinated "needles in a haystack" that shifts an impossible verification burden onto human researchers. In the next few years, Anandkumar expects a scientific breakthrough on the back of AI connecting multiple disciplines together, because the real world doesn't fall into a specific physics solver or a specific knowledge. "The magic that we will see is all kinds of unexpected connections being made and which accelerate everything. Chip manufacturing, for instance, where bottlenecks are removed and it is all much cheaper to do".

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NEW RULES. NEW REALITIES.

{ ZUBIN KARKARIA } FOUNDER AND CEO, VFS GLOBAL

Zubin Karkaria during the 24th Hindustan Times Leadership Summit. HT PHOTO

Indian students going to foreign nations are more discerning now

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

India has become a "powerhouse" of global mobility and foreign visits have turned from aspiration to necessity for Indians, VFS Global founder Zubin Karkaria said on Thursday.

Speaking on the opening day of the 24th Hindustan Times Leadership Summit, Karkaria said 30 years ago, a foreign holiday was possibly an Indian's highest social desire after buying a house, but that had changed. "Now, it's not a luxury anymore. It's not a desire anymore; it's a necessity," he said. "The passport penetration in India is around 8%. So, there's a huge amount of new travellers that are coming in."

The demand, according to him, spans segments. India sends more skilled workers abroad than any other country, is a growing source of travellers visiting friends and relatives, and also the second-largest source market for international students, said Karkaria. His Dubai-headquartered firm works with 71 countries across the world and processes about 30 million visa applications a year.

Asked which assumption about global mobility had turned out completely wrong, the VFS Global CEO said that the Covid pandemic and conflicts in Europe and West Asia were expected to choke international travel indefinitely. But each time, travel rebounded much faster than expected, he said.

"Whatever geopolitics or whatever environmental conditions are there in the world, travel will always come back, and it will come back with a vengeance," he said. Crises cause only brief anxiety or logistical hurdles, during which domestic travel picks up, he added. Post-Covid "revenge travel" showed the urge never waned, he added.

Karkaria also said that Indian students travelling abroad are changing direction. Their travel to Europe is growing by almost 70% a year, he said, with Germany, Austria, Spain and France drawing students who once defaulted to the US, UK, Canada or Australia. The choice has shifted from parents to students, who now weigh a host of factors before making a decision.

"Now, the students have become very discerning. They want to see, okay, what is the course all about? What is the environment?... India is today the second-largest source market for students, but it's growing and could become number one," he said.

Europe is competing for Indian students. India has signed migration and mobility agreements with several EU countries. "A lot of countries are going the extra way to support Indian students and to get the right Indian students to their countries," Karkaria said. "Maybe they will get into the fabric of those countries in the future."

He also said that while artificial intelligence will ease travel, it will not decide who gets a visa. "It will be a support but not the decision maker," Karkaria said, adding that no country's laws currently allow AI to make that call. Governments have a sovereign right over entry and "security is paramount", he said, though "for the genuine traveller, I still see no worries".

Addressing concerns over data safety and privacy, Karkaria said his company stores no applicant data. Biometrics are captured in booths monitored live by embassies and pushed in real time over an encrypted pipeline, and names and addresses are purged once passports are returned. Passports come back in sealed envelopes, so VFS does not know whether a visa was granted, he said.

He said that VFS Global reports touts to local authorities, including those who falsely use its name, as they prey on students and workers. "The touts build on the fear of the person who is travelling," he said. "VFS Global uses its customer touchpoints, such as its website, social media channels, and notices at its premises, to advise applicants to apply well in advance and beware of fraudulent entities who promise early appointments and guaranteed visas for an additional fee. Remember, only embassies and consulates can decide on your visa."

Access to the global visa system has widened too, according to him. In the late 1990s, applicants outside Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai and Mumbai took trains and queued from the previous night; India now has more than 23 application locations and doorstep services. The process itself is getting lighter. A UK visa that once meant submitting documents and waiting for a sticker in the passport is now largely a fingerprint appointment.

India is today the second-largest source market for students, but it's growing and could become number one... A lot of countries are going the extra way to support Indian students and to get the right Indian students to their countries

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1	ITI Trainee (Fitter)	17	KP/S/20/2026 dt:13/11/2026
2	ITI Trainee (Electrician)	27	

Candidates who are willing to take up challenging roles in the domains may please visit the career page on BEML website "**www.bemlindia.in**" for detailed advertisement and application process , which will be hosted shortly.

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102–क्यूँकालेश्वर, कण्डोलिया, देवप्रयाग रोड़, पौड़ी (गढ़वाल)
कार्यालयः– 01368–222387 फैक्सः– 01368–222387 ईमेलः– sepauriupjn@gmail.com
पत्रांकः 2109/वी–12/68 **"ई–निविदा सूचना"** दिनांकः 12/11/2026

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, निर्माण मण्डल, उत्तराखण्ड पेयजल निगम, पौड़ी के पत्रांक 2009/वी–12/55 दिनांक 22.10.2026 द्वारा एस०बी०एम०–2 कार्यक्रम के अन्तर्गत पौड़ी नगर सीवरेज आदि कार्यों हेतु राज्य सरकार की वैबसाईट **http/www.uktenders.gov.in** के माध्यम से दिनांक 24.10.2026 से 12.11.2026 तक ई–निविदायें आमंत्रित की गयी थी, जिसमें आंशिक संशोधन के उपरान्त इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 2108/वी–12/67 दिनांक 12.11.2026 के द्वारा उक्त दिनांक के स्थान पर दिनांक 24.10.2026 से दिनांक 21.11.2026 तक निविदा आमंत्रित की तिथि बढ़ायी गयी है, जिसके उपरान्त उक्त निविदा दिनांक 23.11.2026 को खोली जायेगी। निविदा की नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी जो उपरोक्त वेबसाईट से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (OPERATION & MAINTENANCE), GARHWAL ZONE, 26-CIVIL LINES, ROORKEE

E-TENDER NOTICE

Power Transmission Corporation of Uttarakhand Ltd. Invites the following e-tenders.

1. Construction of Protection wall for Tower No. CD 62 at Panyali Village of 220 KV Chamba- Dharashu Line under 220KV O&M Division Chamba, Tehri (G), against e-tender specification **No.CE/GZR-34/2026-27.** Last date of submission online/offline of e-tender is **14.12.2026** upto 15:00 hrs. which shall be opened on **15.12.2026** at 15:00 hrs.

2. Construction of RCC and Revetment wall for protection of RC 94 of 220 KV Rishikesh-Chamba Line under 220KV O&M Division Chamba, Tehri (G), against e-tender specification **No.CE/GZR-35/2026-27.** Last date of submission online/offline of e-tender is **14.12.2026** upto 15:00 hrs. which shall be opened on **15.12.2026** at 15:15 hrs. Details of e-tender can be obtained from e-tender website **www.uktenders.gov.in** and information of e-tender can be seen from PTCUL website **www.ptcul.org.** For any assistance on e-tendering, please contact on Mb. No.91-8899890000.

CHIEF ENGINEER (O&M)
No. 1139/CE(O&M)/GZR/Advt. Dated: 12-11-2026
"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF NATION"

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
Office of Chief Engineer (O&M), Kumaon Zone, 220KV S/s, Campus, Kamaluaganja, Haldwani-263139
Corporate ID U40101UR2004SGC028675 Phone No. 7088117917

E-Tender Time Extension Notice-1

Due to unavoidable circumstances the date of submission of **E-Tender Specification No. CE/OandM/PTCUL/HLD/68/2026-27, TENDER ID (2026_PTCU9_101141_1)** has been extended upto 26.11.2026, 17:00 Hrs. For more details please visit E-Tender Website ***www.uktenders.gov.in*** and E-Tender time extension notice is available at PTCUL Website ***www.ptcul.org***. All other terms and conditions of the above tenders will remain same. For any assistance on E-Tendering, please contact +91-8899890000

Letter No. 2268/CE(O&M)/PTCUL/HLD/E-Tender
Date : 12.11.2026 **"Save Electricity in the Interest of Nation"**

Chief Engineer (O&M)
Kumaon Zone
PTCUL, Haldwani

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Civil Engg. ▪ E-TENDER NOTICE ▪ No. W.623/15, Date 11.11.2026
Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination), West Central Railway, Kota, for and on behalf of the President of Union of India, invites following 2 open E-Tenders.

Sr. No.: 1 **Tender No.:** 211-2026. **Description of Work: ADEN/RMA Section - TSR(P) - 30.437 Kms. by PQRS with contractor's portal 28.175 Kms. & manual - 2.262 Kms. including subsidiary work with BCM. Approx. Cost:** ₹ 8,02,86,875.34. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 16,05,700/-. **Last Date & Time of submission of Tender:** 15.30 Hrs. on dt. 03.12.2026.

Sr. No.: 2 **Tender No.:** 212-2026. **Description of Work: Outsourcing for USFD Rail & Weld testing as per Indian Standard Specification for Ultrasonic Testing of Rails and Welds (Provisional) Revised 2020 (with latest amendment) and manual for Ultrasonic testing of rails and welds revised 2022 (with latest correction slip) issued by RDSO with contractor's own operators in Kota Division for 3 years. (Pre BID conference schedule to be held on 20 Nov 2026 at 11.30 Hrs. at DRM Office, WCR, Kota Division). Approx. Cost:** ₹ 3,21,35,448.78. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 6,42,700/-. **Last Date & Time of submission of Tender:** 15.30 Hrs. on dt. 15.12.2026.

Complete details are available in the E-Tender Notice uploaded on the Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in** and also placed on the notice board of the Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination), DRM Office, West Central Railway, Kota's Office.

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान - एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

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RESERVE BANK OF INDIA
www.rbi.org.in
Department of Information Technology

Notice inviting e-Tender

Department of Information Technology, Central Office, Reserve Bank of India invites tender through e-tendering at Government e-Market place -Central Public Procurement Portal (CPPP) (**https://etenders.gov.in/eprocure/app**) from eligible bidders for **"Procurement of Software subscription Licences and associated services for Network Traffic Analysis (NTA) solution under the existing NTA solution at Data Centres of Reserve Bank of India (RBI)"**.

For details, please visit Tender Section of RBI website (**https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/BS_ViewTenders.aspx**). Further corrigendum/ addendum, if any, will also be uploaded on the same URL. RBI reserves the right to reject the tender or any or all the bids to the tender.

Chief General Manager-in-Charge
Department of Information Technology, RBI, Mumbai

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RECRUITMENT OF VICE PRINCIPAL ON FIXED TERM BASIS (04 ACADEMIC SESSIONS) THROUGH LOCAL SELECTION BOARD (LSB) : 2026

VACANCIES

1. Army Public School, Meerut Cantt invites applications **for the post of Vice Principal on Fixed Term Basis.**
2. **Eligibility criteria and detailed advertisement** are available on the School website of APS Meerut Cantt **(www.apsmeerut.com)** under the **"Notice Board"** tab. The guidelines, conditions and instructions published on the website shall take precedence over this advertisement and interpretation of the same shall be final and binding.
3. Last date for submitting application to school is **12 Dec 2026 (12:00 PM)**.
4. The School Management reserves the right to call shortlisted candidates only and cancel vacancy without assigning any reason.
5. No TA/DA will be admissible.
6. For any queries, please contact to Mr Pradeep Kumar at **6399126061.**

Principal, APS Meerut Cantt
for Chairman, APS Meerut Cantt

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UN-AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS (STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED) FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED ON SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

The Board of Directors of the Company, on the recommendations of the Audit Committee, at its meeting held on Thursday, November 12, 2026 has approved the Un-Audited Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended on September 30, 2026.

The aforesaid Financial Results, along with the Limited Review Report, have been uploaded on the Company's website and websites of BSE and NSE. The same is available at [https://www.irctc.com/assets/images2/OutcomeMeetingBoardDirectors12Nov2026.pdf] and can be accessed by scanning the QR code.

For & on behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Rahul Himalian
Chairman & Managing Director
DIN: 10393348

Place: New Delhi
Dated: 12th November, 2026

Note: The above intimation is in accordance with Regulation 33 read with Regulation 47 (1) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

IRCTC Limited, 4th Floor, Tower-D, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029

WORLD

HUANG LOSES HIS SHINE IN BIRTHPLACE TAIWAN AFTER AFFAIR REPORTS

Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

TAIPEI: Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang had been widely adored like a rock star in his birthplace, Taiwan. That image is now tainted after the FBI began an investigation into his affair with an alleged Chinese agent.

Like the rest of the world, the island was shocked by the scandal over Huang's relationship with Alice Huang, a Chinese businesswoman reportedly described as a Chinese spy by US officials. A video of the pair visiting a restaurant in the capital city of Taipei in 2025 went viral and was broadcast globally. Jensen Huang resigned on Thursday after facing growing calls to do so because of the affair. His troubles compounded late Wednesday after media reports said Huang had another extramarital affair with an Nvidia employee who reported to him.

The 63-year-old poster boy for the artificial intelligence revolution was born in Taiwan and spent his early years there before he moved to the United States for his schooling. He regularly visited Taiwan for business events.

Jane Hsieh's tofu pudding shop was one of many restaurants and stores in Taipei that proudly displayed photos of Jensen Huang visiting their premises. Hsieh, 70, was shocked by the dramatic headlines and felt deep regret for him, saying Huang used to have a near-perfect public image.

She wondered whether people would still be as warm to him as before if he returned to Taiwan again. "If he comes into my shop again as a customer, I'd be fine, but I think it would be awkward because he's no longer the familiar person we used to know," she said. "I'd be polite to him, but my feelings towards him would be different."

Resident Jeff Huang, 72, noted some customers were already suggesting the removal of Huang's photos in shops.

"He used to be very popular, but after his personal moral scandal and allegations of corporate espionage came out, he instantly fell from grace," he said. Taiwan's presidential office spokesperson Karen Kuo said that national security agencies have full knowledge of the pair's travel itinerary while they were in Taiwan. Local media reported Jensen Huang visited Taiwan for two weeks between May and June, and he made a short stopover in August.

China may be the biggest loser from Jensen Huang's downfall

Bloomberg
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: Jensen Huang's resignation from Nvidia Corp. may give the company he's led for three decades a path out of the mess he created. For China's artificial-intelligence industry, the fallout is just beginning.

The spiraling crisis goes far beyond the sad and stunning scandal of alleged affairs with a Chinese spy and a direct report. Washington will demand answers over how much he and his company knew about their products being used in China. And none of it looks good.

Huang's relationship with the suspected espionage asset Alice Huang reportedly helped facilitate Chinese companies' access to at least $7.5 billion worth of Nvidia chips, according to The Information.

Her company, Megaspeed International, is the single largest buyer in Southeast Asia, and has raised red flags for more than a year. Nvidia allegedly intervened in a US investigation into Megaspeed (both have denied acting improperly). All of this gives major ammunition to China hawks in the US.

Tighten export controls

Expect export controls to tighten much further — including on the approved and legal routes that Chinese companies have had to access Nvidia hardware.

At one level, isn't this what Beijing wanted all along? Officials have certainly signalled their desire to accelerate the shift to homegrown alternatives, including through the government's own restrictions on approved Nvidia products re-entering the market.

But technocrats can't will mass production of cutting-edge AI processors into existence. That takes time. The gray market and loopholes cushioned the blow of a hard cutoff.

This reliance is still apparent, most recently in reports that Beijing-based AI champion Moonshot, maker of breakout model Kimi K3, accessed a trove of Nvidia's most advanced chips this summer. Huawei Technologies Co., the company's chief Chinese rival, has acknowledged it can't meet demand at home.

If anything, there's a lesson on the worst possible way to execute export controls. Washington imposed enough aggression to light a fire under Beijing and Huawei to rally an all-out effort for local alternatives, while leaving enough work-arounds to blunt the transition.

Dilemma for Chinese firms

For Chinese AI firms caught in the middle, threats of new restrictions couldn't come at a worse time. Despite rapid technical advances, many are still struggling to compete with each other, let alone find a path to profits. As Nvidia's board met to discuss their CEO's fate on Thursday, Chinese AI stocks tumbled.

Chips aren't the only problem. In addition to being an ardent advocate of selling hardware to China, Huang was also one of Silicon Valley's most powerful champions of open models, where Chinese firms have concentrated their bets.

In July, he used his first-ever X post to rally America's tech industry behind open-weight AI after fears mounted of a US ban on Chinese offerings. He has defended distillation, or training one model on the outputs of another, as a "widely used technique" and "competition". The distillation debate has become central to efforts to restrict Chinese open models in the US amid accusations from companies and lawmakers that Chinese firms are shoplifting American AI progress.

Without one of the industry's most influential voices speaking up for distillation and open models more broadly, pressure for a crackdown will grow.

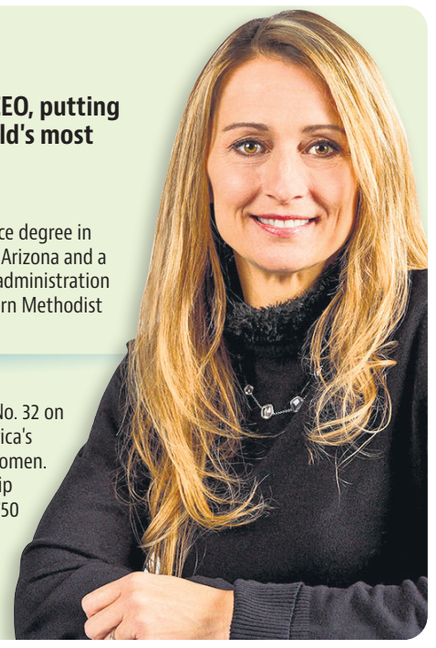
This scandal broke mere weeks before US-China AI safety talks were set to take place, extinguishing already faint hopes for cooperation on that front. The Nvidia crisis will deepen mistrust and reduce visibility on both sides.

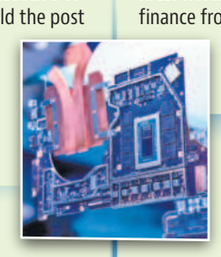
The result is likely a more blind and reckless race for dominance. If that sounds like the Cold War, well, look at this throwback spying case.

Huang's legacy had seemed to be one of building improbable bridges in the hope that the AI revolution didn't have to be so cleanly divided in two. Now, it may be about how quickly one man can incinerate those bridges. And China might find itself stranded on the other side.

Colette Kress in limelight

Nvidia finance chief Colette Kress is set to take over as interim CEO, putting her in charge of the chipmaker whose processors power the world's most advanced supercomputers and AI data centres.





CFO SINCE 2013
Kress joined Nvidia in Sept 2013 as executive VP and chief financial officer and has held the post since. She has appeared alongside Jensen Huang on the company's quarterly earnings calls. Nvidia's revenue was $4.13 billion in the fiscal year she joined and $215.9 billion in fiscal 2026.

CAREER BEFORE NVIDIA
Before Nvidia, Kress spent eight years in finance roles at Texas Instruments, then worked at Microsoft from 1997 to 2010. She moved to Cisco in 2010 as senior VP and chief financial officer of its Business Technology and Operations Finance organisation.

EDUCATION
Kress holds a bachelor of science degree in finance from the University of Arizona and a master of business administration degree from Southern Methodist University.

WEALTH
Forbes ranks Kress No. 32 on its 2026 list of America's richest self-made women. Her shares in the chip firm were valued at roughly $750 million, as of Wednesday's close, down from more than $1 billion at the stock's peak last month

Singapore says it barred Alice Huang from entry over Megaspeed probe

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SINGAPORE: Singapore said it barred Alice Huang from re-entering the country in February and gave her a "stern warning" after finding insufficient evidence to prosecute the alleged Chinese spy in a scandal that led to the ouster of former Nvidia Corp. leader Jensen Huang.

Alice Huang, a former Megaspeed International Pte CEO, "provided information which she knew to be inaccurate" to Singaporean authorities to downplay her role in the company during a probe into its operations, the Ministry of Home Affairs said on Thursday. It said she wasn't investigated for espionage.

Alice Huang, also known as Huang Le, was a Hong Kong resident and wasn't based in Singapore. Her passport was returned on February 26 and she left Singapore that day, the ministry said.

"Singapore does not condone companies using their association with Singapore to circumvent or violate other countries' export controls through fraud or dishonest practices," the ministry said.

Alice Huang is under scrutiny for her role at Megaspeed, a Singapore-based Nvidia cloud partner investigated over the suspected diversion of advanced computing servers to China amid US export restrictions. She's also been linked to Nvidia's Huang, who admitted to a romantic relationship with her. Singapore started an independent probe in February 2025 into Megaspeed and several other companies over suspected false declarations involving the purchase of servers and related offenses. Investigations into Megaspeed and six other individuals are ongoing.

Alice Huang with Jensen Huang in Taipei, on May 22, 2025. AP

Alice Huang is back in Beijing

The suspected Chinese spy at the centre of a scandal has returned to her home country, people familiar with the matter said. Megaspeed International founder Alice Huang is currently living in Beijing with the knowledge of security officials, one of the people said, asking to remain anonymous to discuss a sensitive situation.

It wasn't immediately clear when or why she travelled to the capital, nor what she may be engaged in, the people said.

Alice Huang's whereabouts have been the topic of intense speculation since Nvidia's founder admitted to an extramarital affair and the company's board began an investigation into allegations she's a Chinese spy.

Scott Colom AP

{ MISSISSIPPI }

DEMOCRAT SCOTT COLOM FLIPS U.S. SENATE SEAT IN STUNNING UPSET

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WASHINGTON: In a historic upset, Democrat Scott Colom has won his US Senate race in traditionally conservative Mississippi, networks projected on Wednesday, making him the first African-American elected to the chamber from the southern state in more than 140 years.

Colom, a 43-year-old district attorney, prevailed over Republican incumbent Senator Cindy Hyde-Smith in perhaps the most extraordinary seat flip of an already extraordinary US midterm election, in which Democrats crushed the Republicans to reclaim the majority in both chambers of Congress.

In a prayerful and solemn speech, Colom praised Mississippi's long tradition of Black activism and faith in progress.

"Mississippi, our prayers have often changed the course of history," Colom told the jubilant crowd of his supporters in Jackson on Wednesday night. "God didn't want us to get it the easy way. He wanted us to get it the Mississippi way."

Colom's win in the deep South adds sting to the stunning rebuke of President Donald Trump as voters around the country shunned his Republican Party, even in states that had not sent a Democrat to Washington in decades.

The latest win, called on Wednesday by US news outlets that included CNN, NBC and CBS, will give Democrats 55 seats in the 100-member Senate, with 44 for Republicans and one race — in the state of Alaska — still outstanding.

The midterms result was a personal humiliation for 80-year-old Trump as a Democratic wave swept through the Republican heartland, leaving him as a lame duck president for the remaining two years of his term.

The damaged part of Nasser Hospital after it was hit by an Israeli airstrike overnight in Khan Yunis, Gaza Strip, on Thursday. AP

Israeli strike on Gaza hospital deadliest since parl elections

KHAN YUNIS: Israeli fire killed 11 people in Gaza on Thursday, six of whom died in the bombing of Nasser hospital in south Gaza early in the day, health officials said, the deadliest single strike since Israel's elections last month.

The Israeli military confirmed the attack on the medical complex, saying they targeted "the commander of Hamas's Khan Yunis brigade Muhammad Abu Ismail and additional terrorists hiding inside of Nasser hospital", which it has long accused the Palestinian Islamist movement of using to shelter militants.

Hamas has denied this, and both parties frequently accuse each other of violating the terms of a US-backed ceasefire agreement that took effect in October 2025.

Nasser hospital, located in Khan Yunis, confirmed the six deaths in a statement, while a doctor there said that nearly 30 people were wounded.

Goher Rahbour, a British surgeon volunteering at the hospital, told AFP that a Palestinian doctor with whom he had conducted a surgery on Wednesday evening was among those killed in the strike.

"I was on my phone just doing a bit of reading and the strike occurred just after midnight. It was very loud, very quick. The building shook, there was a lot of smoke that came up," Rahbour told AFP.

The army said that Abu Ismail was "responsible for directing terrorist attacks against Israeli civilians and IDF troops and for holding numerous hostages captive throughout the war" and that Hamas used the hospital as a command-and-control centre, to store weapons and conduct "interrogations and torture".

Hamas in a statement denied using the hospital for military purposes, saying Israel put forward "a false narrative" to justify airstrikes.

Gaza's civil defence agency said the bodies from the strike had been recovered from the targeted building, which a medical source said was the surgery ward of Nasser hospital. AFP

Suspect among 2 dead in DC shooting

Shashank Mattoo
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WASHINGTON: A shooter killed one person and injured several others before turning the gun on himself in America's capital, a short distance from the White House. According to law enforcement, another shooting victim is in critical condition while three others have suffered non-life threatening injuries.

The shooting took place around a gym in the Logan circle neighbourhood, following which the assailant barricaded himself in an apartment above the gym.

"The suspect was in litigation recently with his building owner. And we believe the suspect went into Vida Fitness to target the building owner and shoot him and kill him, which he did," said city council member Brooke Pinto to local media, describing the chain of events that led to the shooting, which occurred around 8am. Pinto added that the shooter proceeded to leave the gym and shoot several bystanders, including construction workers and a woman in the area. In the course of barricading himself in a nearby apartment building, the shooter also set parts of it on fire.

Law enforcement authorities stated that police communicated with the assailant for an hour before hearing a gunshot from inside an apartment. Officers then forced entry into the apartment to find the shooter suffering from a self-inflicted gunshot wound, to which he ultimately succumbed.

Indonesian VP in high school diploma scandal resigns

JAKARTA: Indonesia's vice president resigned on Thursday in the midst of a scandal over his high school diploma that has added to pressure on a government facing widespread dissatisfaction over the economy, graft and wildfires. There had been repeated calls for Gibran Rakabuming Raka, 39, to step down following a Supreme Court ruling last month to annul his high school qualification, obtained abroad. On Thursday, he submitted his resignation to President Prabowo Subianto and parliament. AFP

Two sisters of jailed Pakistan ex-PM released from prison

LAHORE: Two sisters of jailed Pakistani former prime minister Imran Khan were released from prison in Lahore on Thursday, their lawyer and Khan's political party said.

Noreen Khan and Uzma Khan "were released from Kot Lakhpat at 2:00 pm (local time)", their advocate Rana Mudassar told AFP over the phone, explaining that the government had withdrawn their joint detention order, while a third sister, Aleema Khan, remained in prison. AFP

{ DR. AMISH SHAH } HOUSE MEMBER-ELECT

'Tariffs one of the big reasons for acrimony in Indo-US ties'

Shashank Mattoo
letters@hindustantimes.com

Indian-American Amish Shah, a physician and former state legislator, was elected to Congress after flipping Arizona's 1st congressional district in one of the most closely watched races of the midterm elections.

In an interview with HT, Shah spoke about his family's journey to America, the rise in anti-Indian sentiment, and the future of United States (US)-India ties.

Could you tell us how your family came to the US?

It was the late 1950s, in Zaveri Bazaar in Bombay (Mumbai). A man named Mark Howard, a retired judge from Michigan, was wandering around. This was before cell phones. It was a hot day. He nearly passed out, and he was clearly in trouble. So my mother's elder brothers went out, took him in, brought him into the air conditioning, and gave him a can of Coca-Cola. He said, "Wow, I haven't had Coca-Cola in some time." And they started talking.

My uncles had expressed some interest in possibly doing business in the US. Their jewellery business was thriving, but they knew they could expand further. Based on that conversation, and by keeping in touch, he eventually sponsored my mother to come to the US to study. She was a student at the Milwaukee School of Engineering starting in 1969. It was an act of generosity that my mom really made sure we knew about, because it is the reason I am standing in front of you today.

You are among six Indian Americans elected to the House of Representatives. There has been a conversation about rising anti-Indian sentiment in the US. What does that mean to you personally, what are you hearing from the community, and what do you intend to do about it?

We have clearly seen that anti-Indian hate has risen, probably more in the last six months to a year than I have ever seen in my lifetime. It is surprising, because for many years we were praised as people contributing to the community, creating jobs as entrepreneurs, serving in the medical field, working in all sectors of the economy.

It can be hurtful to hear, despite all of those contributions and wanting to pay back the generosity and goodwill of the American people, that some individuals have made really negative comments. Unfortunately, you can go on Twitter and see some of that, and it is really sad to see.

Dr Amish Shah speaks during the Arizona Democrats' election night watch party for midterm results in Arizona on Nov 3. REUTERS

Sometimes you even saw it from candidates for public office, like a gentleman from Texas running for railroad commissioner. That was particularly hurtful to a lot of people, because those kids were cheering on their football team. That could have been me in the student section at Northwestern in the 1990s. I am still a football fan today, and the Chicago Bears are my team. So seeing that happen is disappointing to the community.

A lot of people feel scared and alone at times like this. What they want is for their elected leaders to see it, condemn it, stand with them, and combat it in the ways they can: first, with the bullhorn we have been given in public office, and also, where there are legislative opportunities, by providing enhanced security. I know other communities have been feeling the same. I hear this a lot from Jewish Americans, who have been combating anti-semitism for a long time. A lot of communities are speaking out, and I think our responsibility as elected officials is to set the moral tone.

Is the US-India relationship going to be a priority for you? What is your sense of the state of the relationship and the Trump administration's handling of it? And will you be joining the India Caucus?

Certainly, we will be joining the India Caucus. But when we are sworn in on January 3, the priority has to be taking care of the needs of my district. My district is concerned, first and foremost, about costs. The war in Iran is causing costs to go up, and tariffs.

The Indian-American community specifically has been hit by tariffs that have been on and off, on and off. A lot of our entrepreneurs have come to me specifically and complained, and those concerns are top of mind, just as they are for all the people of Arizona.

Then there is the One Big Beautiful Bill and its Medicaid cuts, and finally water for Arizona. We are living in a desert, and we are running out. Those are the problems we were sent here to fix, and they will be our top priorities.

Eventually, there will have to be a review of the US-India relationship. I think the tariffs were one of the big reasons we have had some acrimony in the relationship. And not just for India but for the rest of the world, Congress should take that authority away from the President and reclaim it for itself, as is rightfully ours. Once that happens, we believe we can actually improve the US-India relationship.

Blackstone leads race for BluPine

Deal may value green energy co at $1.8 bn, add to Blackstone's India infra portfolio

Sneha Shah and Priyamvada C.

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MUMBAI: Global private equity firm Blackstone is emerging as the frontrunner to acquire renewable energy platform BluPine Energy from UK-based Actis in a deal that could value the company at $1.7-1.8 billion, three people with direct knowledge of the matter said.

"Blackstone seems to be leading the talks and may soon enter exclusivity," said one of the people cited above. Blackstone is competing closely with Brookfield and INOX Clean Energy, to acquire BluPine, the people said.

Mint was the first to report private equity and strategic investor interest in the deal, including that of Blackstone, on 18 August. Blackstone and Actis spokespersons declined to comment. Emails sent to INOX did not elicit a response till the time of publishing. Brookfield declined to comment.

Actis launched BluPine Energy in 2022. AP

The scale of India's renewable energy opportunity has attracted both domestic and global investors. Investments in the sector have gathered pace in recent years, with the government targeting 500GW of installed non-fossil-fuel capacity by 2030. Achieving this target will require an estimated investment of about ₹42 trillion, according to government estimates.

Actis launched BluPine Energy in 2022, targeting 4GW of utility-scale solar, wind and energy storage capacity through a buy-and-build strategy. The company develops projects with both government and commercial and industrial (C&I) power purchase agreements (PPAs) across India. In the same year, BluPine acquired an operating solar portfolio of 404MW spread across the country as part of its expansion.

Led by Neerav Nanavaty, the Gurugram-based company develops, builds, owns and operates renewable energy projects across India. It has expanded its C&I business through customized renewable energy solutions using captive, group captive and open-access models, helping businesses across sectors meet their sustainability and decarbonization goals.

Actis is a global infrastructure investor with a track record of building businesses and operating assets across markets. It has deployed more than $7.1 billion across different investment strategies in Asia. The firm has built or operated more than 8GW of installed energy capacity in the region, including over 5.5GW of renewable energy capacity. Blackstone, meanwhile, has stepped up efforts to build a large infrastructure portfolio in India.

Goyal pitches India as global investment hub

Rajeev Jayaswal

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NEW DELHI: India is a safe harbour for global investors, promising preferential access to three-fourths of the $115 trillion world economy as New Delhi already finalised free trade deals with countries representing a combined GDP of $70 trillion and plans to add another $15 trillion soon, commerce and industry minister Piyush Goyal said on Thursday.

He was addressing around 3,000 national and international delegates from 60 countries at the inaugural session of the 31st Partnership Summit in Visakhapatnam.

The two-day summit is being organised by the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) in association with the ministry of commerce and industry, with the Andhra Pradesh government as the host.

"In this turbulent global world, India offers an oasis in the desert," Goyal said, referring to geopolitical conflicts and trade disputes that have disrupted global supply chains.

Goyal drew a parallel between India's trade policy and the Motupalli pillar inscription, or the 'abhaya-sasana' (charter of protection), issued by Kakatiya king Ganapatideva about 800 years ago.

Piyush Goyal, commerce and industry minister. ANI

"It made a simple promise: duties would be fair and if a storm wrecked your ship on our coast, your cargo would be protected," he said, adding that "India renews that charter for every investor".

"Whatever storm rages around the world, whatever may be the wars and conflicts that trouble the rest of the world, our policies will remain predictable, our laws will be fair and your investment will be safe," he said.

Goyal said India offered investors three assurances — open markets, the capability to deliver and reliability or trust.

On open markets, he said India had finalised nine free trade or preferential trade agreements in the past four-and-a-half years with 38 developed countries. "In the last four-and-a-half years, we have finalised nine free trade agreements or preferential trade agreements covering 38 developed countries. And friends, these 38 countries together represent $60 trillion of global GDP," he said.

"If we add the earlier FTAs before 2014, we now have preferential market access to a GDP of nearly $70 trillion across the world. We are in active engagement with several countries, multilaterally and bilaterally, which will add another $15 trillion of GDP where Indian businesses, Indian products, goods, merchandise, and services will have preferential access," the minister said.

According to government officials, India is in an advanced stage of finalising a free trade agreement with Canada, which is expected to be announced during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to the country next month. Trade talks are also progressing with the Russia-led Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU), the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), Peru, Chile, Israel, Mexico and the Maldives.

ANDHRA PLANS LAW TO SHIELD INVESTORS FROM REGIME CHANGES

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HYDERABAD: Andhra Pradesh plans to formulate a state-level investment protection law to insulate investors from changes after change in the state's ruling party, chief minister N Chandrababu Naidu said on Thursday, and urged the central government to consider a similar law at a national level.

"We are bringing in an Investment Protection Act at the state level to safeguard investors from regime changes and political vendetta. The Centre must support it," Naidu told the gathering of business leaders, diplomats and foreign investors at the two-day CII Partnership Summit being held in Vishakhapatnam.

In his presentation, the chief minister said concerns over regime changes and vindictive politics that follows a regime change created apprehensions among investors.

"The proposed legislation would protect investments from regime changes and ensure that incentives, land allotments and approvals granted to investors by the state government cannot be reversed by future administrations," Naidu said.

He expressed confidence that such a central act that offered protection to investors would encourage a stronger flow of investments into India and attract global investors. "Such a measure would help make India an unstoppable investment destination," he said.

The chief minister, who returned to power in 2024, did not get into the specifics of the law, or his experience that led him to consider such a law.

When he lost the state to the YSR Congress Party in 2019, then chief minister YS Jagan Mohan Reddy hit the brakes on Naidu's Amaravati capital city project and terminated a bunch of contracts for projects as well as the power purchase agreements (PPAs) awarded by the previous TDP regime.

Nvidia India staff lose $570 mn on paper as AI scare, spy scandal hit stock

Shouvik Das and Varun Sood

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NEW DELHI/BENGALURU: Even as scandal-hit Jensen Huang resigned as chief executive of Nvidia Corp. in the middle of an espionage probe and an office affair, employees of the company's Indian unit are staring at paper losses of as much as $570 million.

Just a month ago, employees at Nvidia Graphics Pvt. Ltd, the chip maker's Indian branch, were sitting on a stock windfall; however, a market panic around AI companies and a scandal around Huang have erased much of it.

Employees held about 7.05 million unvested restricted stock units (RSUs) as on 31 March 2026, a Mint review of the company's financial statement filed with corporate affairs ministry showed. At the time, shares of the world's most valuable company traded at around $170, making these RSUs worth about $1.2 billion. Between then and 6 October, the shares rose to $244, boosting the RSUs' value to $1.73 billion.

Since then, the on-paper gains have plunged. As of 10:30 pm India time, Nvidia shares were trading at $165.08 per share, down 5% from the previous day. This values the unvested RSUs for Indian employees at about $1.16 billion— down roughly $570 million in paper gains in six weeks.

Nvidia did not respond to questions.

To be sure, the figure for Nvidia RSUs received by employees could have changed since March. Nvidia RSUs usually get credited to employee accounts over four years: 25% after the first year and 6.25% every three months after that, according to information the chipmaker gave to the US Securities and Exchange Commission.

While the total value mentioned above is for shares not yet credited, some employees must have received some of their RSUs during this time, possibly affecting their earnings during India's main festive season.

The biggest impact could be on the long-serving employees at Nvidia India, which had 5,590 employees at the end of March 2026. *Mint* could not determine how many of its India staff qualify for RSUs. The impact of the share price fall depends on when employees received their shares and whether they held on to them. Assuming 6.25% of the shares are credited to employees' accounts every three months, the last two such releases would have been in the weeks starting 17 June and 16 September, when Nvidia shares traded at $204.42 and $213.90, respectively.

Employees who retained these shares would have paid tax on their value when they were credited. Since then, the shares have lost about 17% and 21% of their value, respectively. The next vesting round is likely in the week of 9 December.

A senior executive, who has been with Nvidia India for over a decade, was not unduly worried. "Most of us who sell our shares over the years do so for big life events: buying a house, a wedding, and so on. So, fewer people would be affected right away, and they probably saw their shares grow a lot over the years. Only their recent gains would have been lost."

TV NARENDRAN TO HEAD TATA INTERNATIONAL, NOEL NAMED CHAIR EMERITUS

NEW DELHI: The Board of Directors of Tata International has approved the appointment of TV Narendran as Chairman of the company and Noel N Tata as Chairman Emeritus, as per a statement by the company.

"Board of Tata International Limited has approved the appointment of Mr. T. V. Narendran as Chairman and Mr Noel N. Tata as Chairman Emeritus of Tata International Limited, effective 12th November 2026," the company said in the release.

"Over the years, Tata International has built a strong legacy of enterprise, resilience and partnerships. I thank all our colleagues for their commitment and contribution to this journey and wish them my very best for the years ahead," said Noel Tata.

Commenting on his appointment, TV Narendran said, "It is a privilege to take on the role of Chairman. I look forward to building on the strong foundation and legacy of the organisation to pursue sustainable growth, strengthen our capabilities and create enduring value for all our stakeholders."

Separately, Tata Investment Corporation on Wednesday announced that Noel N. Tata would retire as its Chairman and Director at the close of business hours on November 11, with Bahram Vakil assuming the role of Chairman from November 12.

In a stock exchange filing, the company said the retirement was in line with the Tata Group Governance Guidelines, which outline provisions governing board composition, board committees and the retirement of directors.

"In accordance with the aforesaid Guidelines, Mr. Noel N. Tata (DIN: 00024713) will retire from the office of Chairman and Director of the Company with effect from the close of business hours on November 11, 2026," the company said.

In another board-level change, Tata Investment Corporation approved the appointment of Abizer Shabbir Diwanji as an Additional Non-Executive Independent Director from November 12.

The appointments come amid ongoing differences between Tata Trusts and Tata Sons over governance and control of the Tata Group. ANI

{ SUNIL BHARTI MITTAL } FOUNDER AND CHAIRMAN OF BHARTI ENTERPRISES

Balance sheet never been better; debt-free by 2029

Jatin Grover and Josey Puliyenthuruthel

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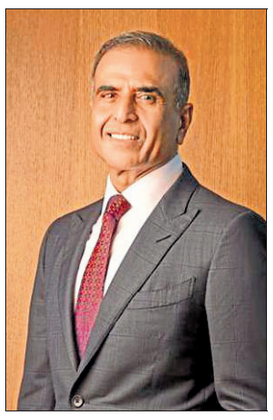
NEW DELHI: As Sunil Bharti Mittal, founder and chairman of Bharti Enterprises Ltd, which owns telecom company Airtel, completes 50 years in business this year, he reflects on the journey, the decisions that shaped the group and the challenges of building businesses across sectors, in a conversation with *Mint* at his New Delhi office.

"To start from the ground up and create a $120 billion enterprise, for me it's not going to be possible (at this stage)," said Mittal, 69, reflecting on the scale of what has been built and the limits of starting afresh at this stage of his career.

He also discussed Airtel's future, tariff hikes, investments in artificial intelligence (AI) and data centres, the group's other businesses, and his views on succession planning at the company. *Edited excerpts:*



You said you would retire at 50.

No, not retire; I would never retire. I had said I would go into politics or something away from business.

Recently, you brought back the entry-level tariff plan. Usually, tariff hikes are followed by peers. Why did it not work out, this time?

The market is so competitive that you cannot stand alone beyond a point. Today, most of my plans command a premium, but there is a limit to how far we can go. You cannot have a supreme premium in a very difficult, competitive market.

In our case, you can consume whatever you want. If you actually want all of Jio's traffic to come to me, I will take it. I have the capacity, and vice versa. So the capacities are unlimited. Vodafone Idea does not move, as you know, because it sells with a lot of difficulties, and if Jio does not move, then it gets difficult. We tried, but it is an experiment.

What about the target of reaching around ₹400 Arpu (average revenue per user)? How will you get there?

We need to reach ₹350. India's whole quest to become a digital powerhouse over the next 10–15 years requires massive compute capacity and zillions of AI agents on the network. You need a much stronger network than we have today. That means more fibre, more subsea cables, more space technologies coming in, and mobile radios.

China has over a million towers; India has 350,000 today. We have to get to 600,000–700,000 towers, which means doubling from where we are today. We need serious financial capacity to do it.

The upper end, which is stuck at ₹400–500, can easily go up to ₹600, ₹700. We have kept it artificially all free, unlimited at ₹400–500. That is the broken architecture.

Will tariff hikes ultimately be decided by the market leader, Jio?

No, Jio cannot move without... if he moves and we don't, he is toast. The industry has to do it. But if the industry says, I want to kill you before I get to nirvana, that does not work. Even Vodafone Idea is out there; BSNL is out there.

Across Bharti Enterprises' 50-year journey spanning telecom, space, hospitality, and real estate, what are your biggest bets outside of telecom?

There were multiple experiments that we started; we could not scale any one of them like telecom, and two or three of them had potential.

One was retail, clearly, with Walmart, which started very well; we opened up a lot of stores—both cash-and-carry and retail—and insurance.

But our focus could not move to those businesses away from telecom because almost every time we thought we could put more money, more capital, more resources into other businesses, we had fires burning here.

One by one, we exited software and skilling businesses, which were too sub-scale. Our insurance company went to ICICI Lombard, and for life insurance, we are now bringing in Prudential to really fire up their engine with 75% equity.

Real estate, we will carry on doing ourselves. And then we have invested in Haier, where Warburg Pincus and we took a 49% stake; we got 25%, and we will stay in this. Hospitality is a big business, which is mostly outside India.

Telecom is now the large mainstay that will remain largely the way it is today, very professionally run, with stewards of the shareholders. There, we are going to do big bets. Data centres, AI data centres, I think billions of dollars will go there.

And the third is financial services. We have Airtel Payments Bank, we have Airtel Money in Africa, which has got listed on the FTSE 100, and we have just started Airtel Money here as a non-banking financial company for lending to our customers.

In terms of raising capital, do you think you have enough on the books to spend?

Airtel's balance sheet has never been better. At one point in time when things were really tough, we were coming closer to four times debt to Ebitda (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortization). Today, we are less than one.

And if you do the projection, by 2029, we'll be a debt-free company. And if you're generating $14–15 billion Ebitda, your capacity to borrow is huge. So I don't see us doing any more rights or fresh issues and all that. The company would be in a position to start buybacks.

{ THE CROSSWORDS }

CRYPTIC CLUES

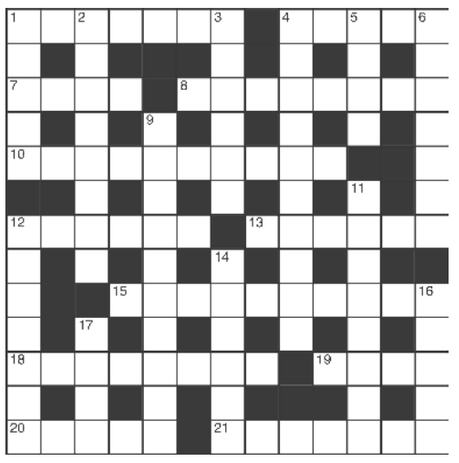
ACROSS

1 Common knowledge (3-4)
4 Like a ship taking many to port (5)
7 Acts like devotees of jazz (4)
8 Blamed head chef before having made certain (8)
10 Choice of size expressed in round numbers (4,2,4)
12 Accommodate cheat (4,2)
13 Edible seed for vegetable and fruit (6)
15 Against rigid price control for winter motoring (10)
18 Sort of feeling one gets when the siege is broken (8)
19 Requests time off from jobs (4)
20 Wins the game in pairs (5)
21 How people who snore sleep? (7)

DOWN

1 Medical substitute (5)
2 Risk a wet form of sport? (5-3)
3 Pointer to what the heckler tries to do (6)
4 Becomes discouraged when short lease is arranged (5,5)
5 Head from Dartmouth in old ship lacking lights (4)
6 Surely bound to come unstuck (2,5)
9 Still waiting for a formal proposal? (10)
11 Not skilled and prosaic presumably (8)
12 A bad-tempered pet (7)
14 Several who have taken the plunge (6)
16 Literary effort? (5)
17 Ground for conspiracy (4)

PUZZLE 17642 © Gemini Crosswords 2018 All rights reserved



QUICK CLUES

ACROSS

1 Shoot selectively one by one (4,3)
4 Easily frightened (5)
7 Offensive to the sight (4)
8 Extremely impressive (8)
10 Sheer physical strength (5,5)
12 Unfaltering (6)
13 Holy (6)
15 Athletics contest other than race (5,5)
18 Fine metal open work (8)
19 Small twist of straw (4)
20 Small piece of glowing coal (5)
21 Set in action (7)

DOWN

1 Exactly (5)
2 Well-educated, with refined taste (8)
3 Get to the bottom of (6)
4 A quinine-flavoured mixer (5,5)
5 Principal (4)
6 Cornus (7)
9 Seemingly exact lookalike (4,6)
11 Meeting for giving orders (8)
12 Light spongy egg-based dish (7)
14 Speaking quickly and easily (6)
16 Become gradually less (5)
17 Association with common interest (4)

YESTERDAY'S SOLUTIONS (17641)

{ SUDOKU } DIFFICULTY LEVEL ★★★★★

			5		8			
		8				4		7
				9		5	8	
				7		1	9	
	7	2		8		3	5	
	6	9		2				
	4	1		6				
7		3				6		
			1		3			

Fill in all the squares in the grid so that each row, column and each of the 9X9 squares contains all the digits from 1 to 9.

GAME ZONE: Scan the QR code for more daily puzzles and brain teasers

{ WEATHER }

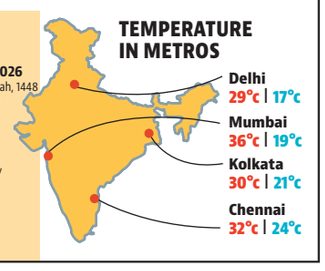
TEMPERATURE ■HIGH ■LOW

FRIDAY	SATURDAY	SUNDAY
Generally cloudy sky towards afternoon evening mist shallow fog	Fog mist in the morning and partly cloudy sky later	Fog mist in the morning and partly cloudy sky later
29°c | 17°c	28°c | 17°c	27°c | 16°c

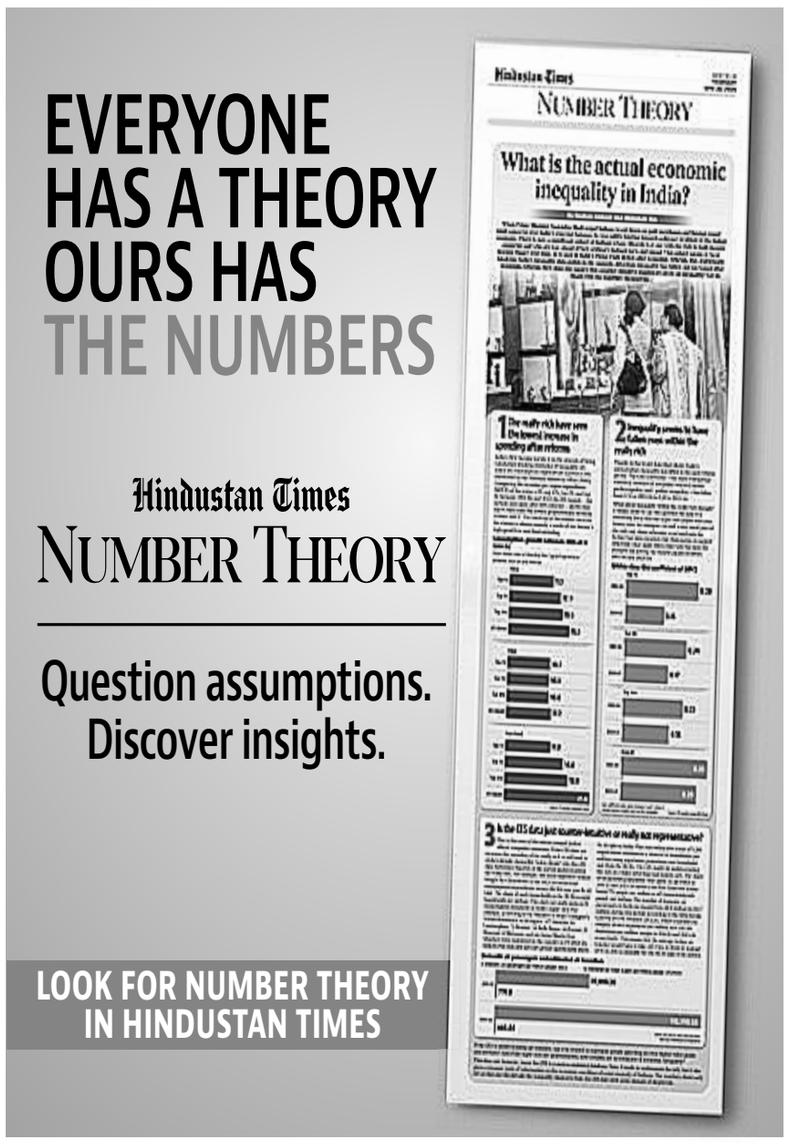
ALMANAC
Today is 13th November 2026
- 02 Jumada Al-Akhirah, 1448
- 19, Kartika, Shukla Paksha, 04
- Samvat 2083

Sunset: Friday at 05:28 p.m.
Sunrise: Saturday at 06:42 a.m.
Moonrise: Friday at 10:16 a.m.
Moonset: Friday at 08:26 p.m.

TEMPERATURE IN METROS



Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.



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UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 website:www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 1070 **e-Tender Notice** Date: 12/11/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (M&G) Dhalipur Power House, invites on line bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No: e-19/EE/M&G/DLR/2026-27
Name of services.: Annual Maintenance of Unit-B of Dhalipur Power Station, Dehradun.
Estimated cost: Rs. 64,42,280/- (GST Extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 13.11.2026
Last date for submission of tender on website: 04.12.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal **"http://uktenders.gov.in"**

(Executive Engineer)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (OPERATION & MAINTENANCE), GARHWAL ZONE, 26-CIVIL LINES, ROORKEE

E-TENDER CORRIGENDUM

"Work of Strengthening of 220 KV Bus Bar (Tarantulla 1200 Amp) by Twin Moose Conductor (2000 Amp) & Associated works at 220 KV Substation Virbhadra Rishikesh" against e-tender specification **No.CE/GZR-27/2026-27** is hereby extended. The last date of submission of online offline e-tender is **26.11.2026** upto 15:00 hrs which shall be opened on **27.11.2026** at 15:15 hrs. Details of e-tender can be obtained from e-tender website **www.uktenders.gov.in** and information of e-tender can be seen from PTCUL website **www.ptcul.org.** All other terms and conditions shall remain same. For any assistance on e-tendering, please contact on Mb.No.+91-8899890000.

CHIEF ENGINEER (O&M)
No. 1142/CE(O&M)/GZR/Advt. Dated: 12-11-2026

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF NATION"

श्यामा प्रसाद मुखर्जी पोर्ट कोलकाता
Syama Prasad Mookerjee Port, Kolkata
(Formerly KOLKATA PORT TRUST)

E-Tender No. : 2026_KoPT_929729_1
Development of Drainage Master Plan at Industrial & Railway Zone (IZ&R), H.D.C., Haldia
Estimated Cost : ₹ 24,27,43,096.06 (excluding GST)
Last Date of submission: 25.11.2026 upto 15.00 hrs. | Bidding through : https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app

Tender No. SDM(P&E)/T/22/2026-27
GeM Bid No. : GEM/2026/B/8250935
Supply, Installation, Commissioning, Operation and Maintenance of 02 nos. 140 Ton Capacity Pit-less Electronic in-Motion Railway Weighbridge as per latest RDSO specification for a period of 10 years at Haldia Dock Complex, SMPK.
Estimated Cost : ₹ 6,15,32,468.00 (including GST) | Bidding through : https://gem.gov.in
Last Date of submission: 01.12.2026 upto Time as per GeM Policy

For details including Corrigendum / Addendum (if any), please visit: https://smportkolkata.shipping.gov.in, https://eprocure.gov.in and https://gem.gov.in

राजस्थान सरकार
कार्यालय प्रमुख चिकित्सा अधिकारी एवं सदस्य सचिव मेडिकेयर रिलीफ सोसायटी राजकीय उप जिला चिकित्सालय जमवारामगढ़ जयपुर प्रथम

क्रमांक:- **Manpower/2026/199** दिनांक: **5.11.2026**

Notice Invited Bid (2026)

Bids for rate contract for **Hiring of Various Manpower Services** at Govt SDH Jamwaramgarh hospital Jaipur-I are invited from interested bidders up to 5.00 Am/Pm Date 16.11.26. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.raj.nic.in**) of the state.

UBN: MHS2627SLRC04354
Est Cost: 100.00 lacs

Sd/- **PMO**
DIPR/C/18326/2026 **SDH Jamwaramgarh Jaipur-I, Jaipur**

बिहार सरकार
न्यायालय– बंदोबस्त कार्यालय, गोपालगंज
आम–सूचना

सर्व सधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि निम्नांकित कॉलम–08/09/10 में अंकित बिहार मद्यनिशेद्य और उत्पाद अधिनियम के तहत जप्त वाहन के अधिग्रहण की कार्यवाही अधोहस्ताक्षरी के न्यायालय में चल रही है लेकिन कुछ वाहन मालिक का नाम, पता प्राप्त नहीं हो सका है एवं कुछ संबंधित वाहन मालिक अबतक इस न्यायालय में उपस्थित होकर अपना दावा प्रस्तुत नहीं किये है तथा कुछ मामले में दावा प्रस्तुत करने के उपरांत अधिरोपित शास्ति जमा नहीं किया गया है।

SL NO.	CASE NO.	DM CASE NO.	THANA	LTR NO	NAME AND ADDRESS	THANA/ CASE NO	REGISTRATION NO	CHASIS NO	ENGINE NO
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	219/2026	1206/26	गोपालपुर	1900/विधि, दिनांक 08.08.2026	उदय त्यागी सा0–C/o-Susheel tyagi, M-100, M Block, Middel circle haldi ram cannaughat place, New Delhi	गोपालपुर थाना कांड सं0–172/26	DL13CA4816	MA3EFJC1S 00211478	M16AN2046401

अतः समाचार पत्र के माध्यम से उक्त जप्त वाहन मालिक को सूचित किया जाता है कि इस सूचना के प्रकाशन के 15 दिनों के अन्दर अधोहस्ताक्षरी के न्यायालय में स्वयं या अपने अधिवक्ता के माध्यम से उपस्थित होकर लिखित रूप से कारण बतावें कि क्यों नहीं कॉलम–08/09/10 में अंकित जप्त वाहन को राजसात कर लिया जाय। निर्धारित **तिथि–24.11.2026** तक पक्ष प्रस्तुत नहीं करने पर यह माना जायेगा कि संबंधित मालिक को इस संबंध में कुछ नहीं कहना है और तदनुसार अभिलेख में उपलब्ध कागज के आधार पर आदेश पारित किया जायेगा।

यदि सूची में उल्लेखित वाहन पर किसी अन्य व्यक्ति का दावा बनता हो तो वैसे व्यक्ति भी ससमय न्यायालय में उपस्थित होकर साक्ष्य सहित अपना पक्ष रख सकते है।

विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

बंदोबस्त पदाधिकारी –सह– अपर समाहर्त्ता (लो0शि0नि0) गोपालगंज

PR- 015346 (Revenue) 2026-27 नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Government of Rajasthan
Office of the Chairman, NEET PG Admission/Counseling Board-2026
SMS Medical College, Jaipur, Rajasthan
Email:- chairmanneetpg2026@gmail.com

No. State PG Counseling Board/2026/42 Dated: 12.11.2026

NOTIFICATION

State Medical PG Seats (M.D / M.S) / Post MBBS DNB / Post MBBS Diploma Allotments-2026 (Round-02)

In continuation to earlier notification and MCC Notice, the Registration and choice filling process for State NEET PG Counseling (Round-2) will commence out from 13.11.2026 as per the detailed schedule available at website **www.pg.neetrajasthan.com**. The candidates are advised to visit the website for all details and further updates.

DIPR/C/18361/2026 **CHAIRMAN**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 32/2026 **Dated: 09.11.2026**

E-Procurement Tender Notice

On behalf of President of India, Divisional Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites the E-procurement tenders:

Tender No.	Description	Total Qty.	EMD (₹)	Tender Opening Date
19267755	2x500 KVA IGBT BASED HOTEL LOAD CONVERTER	02 SET	4,31,880/-	16.12.2026

Note: (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender is available on **IREPS** website i.e. **http://www.ireps.gov.in**. **(2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against Above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by **CCA** under **IT Act-2000**. **(3)** Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. **(4)** Documents being attached should be signed on their body. **(5)** The above tender notice has been uploaded on **http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in** **(6)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the **IREPS** website may be approached. **2560/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

RURAL WORKS DEPARTMENT

Office of the Engineer-in–chief-cum-Additional Commissioner-cum-Special Secretary/Engineer-in-Chief
Rural Works Department, Bihar
5th floor, Visvesvaraya Bhawan, Nehru Path, Patna-800015

DETAILED NOTICE INVITING TENDER (through e-procurement mode only http://pmgsytendersbih.gov.in) for Initial Rehabilitation, Minor improvement, Surface renewal, Construction of drainage /protection work including Operation & Management for works to be executed by "Financial Incentive" as Central Assistance under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY).

Short Notice Inviting Tender No.- PMGSY-Post DLP/2026-27/04

1. Designation and Address of the Advertiser : Engineer-in–chief-cum-Additional Commissioner-cum-Special Secretary/ Engineer-in–chief, Rural Works Department, Govt. of Bihar
2. Date of Notice Inviting Tender : 06.11.2026
3. Period for download of Tender Document : From 20.11.2026 (9:00) to 27.11.2026 up to 15:00 hrs
4. Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid meeting (Office of Respective Works Circle, RWD) : Date 23.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
5. Last Date & Time for uploading tender documents by bidder : Date 27.11.2026 till 15:00 hrs http://pmgsytendersbih.gov.in
6. Date and time of opening of Technical Bid : Date 27.11.2026 Time 15:30 hrs.
7. (i) Bid Security (EMD)**and cost of BOQ shall be submitted Online.**No other forms of Earnest Money (Bid Security) **and cost of BOQ** will be accepted. The Earnest Money deposited by the non -responsive bidder will be automatically refunded. In case the bid of non-responsive bidder is reconsidered whose EMD has been refunded automatically, will be collected and refunded manually in the shape of Fixed Deposit Receipt.
(ii)Bidders are required to upload an Affidavit regarding correctness of Information furnished with bid document. Original Affidavit regarding correctness of Information furnished with Bid document shall be submitted at the time of signing of agreement.
8. **The Engineer-in–chief-cum-Additional Commissioner-cum-Special Secretary / Engineer -in–chief, Rural Works Department** on behalf of Governor of Bihar invites bids for the works detailed below.
9. **Details of Works and Services:**
10. Bid Validity : **180 days.**
11. The amount of Earnest money to be deposited are as follows: -

Engineer -in–chief
Rural Works Department

PR- 015200 (RWD) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट//state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

विद्युत कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
विद्युत भवन प्रमण्डल संख्या–1, भवन निर्माण विभाग पटना

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या– 08/26–27
(केवल ई–निविदा पद्धति बेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
(SBD)

वर्णित कार्य हेतु तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय बीड सिस्टम में ऑन लाईन ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है :–

कार्य का विवरणी :–

क्र०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि (रू. में)	निविदा कागजात का मूल्य (रू० में) (अप्रत्यर्पणीय)	ई–निविदा प्रक्रिया शुल्क (रू०)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	Supplying & Laying of Additional 400 sqmm, 33 KV 3 Core HT Cable from 33 KV Collectorate New Substation of Main DP Structure along with SITC of 450 KVAR APFC Panel in Samrat Ashok Convention Centre, Patna	Rs. 3,00,17,706/-	Rs. 6,00,500/-	10,000=00	As per Online requirement	03 माह

1. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता : विद्युत कार्यपालक अभियंता, विद्युत भवन प्रमण्डल संख्या–1, पटना।
2. निविदा आमंत्रित करने की तिथि : दिनांक– 06.11.2026
3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक– 23.11.2026 से 15.12.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक केवल बेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
4. निविदा कागजात अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक– 16.12.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक केवल बेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
5. निविदा कागजात हार्ड कॉपी जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं स्थान : 1) विद्युत कार्यपालक अभियंता, विद्युत भवन प्रमण्डल संख्या–1, पटना। 2) विद्युत अधीक्षण अभियंता का कार्यालय, विद्युत भवन अंचल, पटना। 3) मुख्य विद्युत अभियंता–1 का कार्यालय, भवन निर्माण विभाग, बिहार, पटना। दिनांक– 17.12.2026 को 15:00 बजे तक।
6. निविदा तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक– 17.12.2026 को 15:30 बजे। केवल बेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
7. निविदा वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सक्षम पदाधिकारी से तकनीकी बीड मूल्यांकन के पश्चात्।
8. प्री–बीड मीटिंग की तिथि एवं समय : (क) दिनांक– 28.11.2026 को विद्युत अधीक्षण अभियंता का कार्यालय, विद्युत भवन अंचल, पटना। 15:00 बजे से (ख) दिनांक– 30.11.2026 को मुख्य विद्युत अभियंता–1 का कार्यालय भवन निर्माण विभाग, बिहार, पटना। 15:30 बजे से
9. निविदा की वैधता की अवधि : 120 दिन।
10. निविदा स्वीकृत करनेवाले पदाधिकारी का पदनाम एवं पता : सक्षम पदाधिकारी।

विद्युत कार्यपालक अभियंता
विद्युत भवन प्रमंडल सं0–1, पटना

PR- 015203 (BCD) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट//state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TUBERCULOSIS AND RESPIRATORY DISEASES

(An Autonomous Institute under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India)
Sri Aurobindo Marg, Near Qutab Minar, New Delhi-110030

SHORT TERM OFFLINE TENDER NOTICE

Ref. No.:- NITRD/Ten./2026-27/2

National Institute of TB and Respiratory Diseases, New Delhi invites tender bids for the following:-

S.No.	Name of Items	Date of opening
	Various Medicines for 2026-27	**27.11.2026**
1	MT-21 Anti-tussive Medicines	-do-
2	Miscellaneous Medicines (Tablet/ Capsules/Solutions/Syrup Items)	-do-
3	Miscellaneous Medicines (Injectable Items)	-do-
4	Miscellaneous Medicines (Intravenous Fluids)	-do-

Date of tender sale: - 13.11.2026 to 26.11.2026
Date, Time and place of tender opening are 27.11.2026 at 11:00 AM in Procurement Cell of NITRD.
The Information regarding this Tender Notice is also available on Institute's Web-site www.nitrd.mohfw.gov.in **DIRECTOR**

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, TECHNICAL CELL
EPC Mission, Planning Department, Lucknow
(technicalcellepcmission@gmail.com)

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER
PRESS NOTICE

Letter No: 291 (SE) /General/Technical Cell/2026 Dated: 05.11.2026

Superintending Engineer, Technical Cell, EPC Mission, Planning Department, Lucknow on behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites online bids for construction on Design, Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) basis from eligible bidders working in any central/state departments or government/semi government undertakings or in private sector for building works through e-tendering from eligible contractors/firms in two bid system for the following works: -

S. No.	Name & Description of work	Estim ated Cost (excluding GST)	Completion Period of Work	Cost of Bid Document	Bid/ Tender Fee	EMD/ Bid Security Amount
1.	Design, Engineering and Procurement for Construction of Residential and Non-residential building s of 04th Battalion of Special Security Force at district Mathura , Uttar Pradesh, India on EPC Mode	Rs. 251.00 Cr.	18 Months plus Defect Liability Period of three years to make good all the defects.	Rs. 35000 + GST	Rs. 300+ GST	Rs. 2.51 Crore

- The bid document shall be available online from 17.11.2026 at 11:30 am to 08.12 .2026 at 03:00 pm & the last date of submission of bid document shall be 08.12 .2026 upto 03.00 pm (Online). Opening of Technical Bid shall be 08.12 .2026 at 03:30 pm.
- Pre bid conference to be held on date 26.11.2026 at 11:30 pm in the office of CE (Technical Cell), Planning Department, Yojana Bhawan, Lucknow. The queries can be sent to email ID - technicalcellepcmission@gmail.com.
- For submission & other tender details, please refer detailed NIT available on website e-tender port al https://www.etender.up.nic.in . under Tender by Organization in Planning Department, U.P. Other details are available on e -tender portal https://www.etender.up.nic.in and Corrigendum/amendments etc., if any, will be notified on this e -tender portal only and separate advertisement will not be made for the same.
- Planning Department, U.P. reserves the right to accept or reject any application without assigning any reason or incurring any liability whatsoever.

(Munish Kumar)
Executive Engineer,
Technical Cell, EPC Mission,
Planning Department, Lucknow

(Rajesh Kumar)
Superintending Engineer,
Technical Cell, EPC Mission,
Planning Department, Lucknow

UP 260852 Dt. 12.11.2026
Website: www.upgov.nic.in

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
PWD BRIDGE CONSTRUCTION DIVISION, GWALIOR (M.P.)

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (FIFTH CALL)

NIT NO.- 06/SAC/SETU/2026-27 GWALIOR, DATE 03.11.2026

Online Tender for the following works is being invited. Details of the work can be seen on the portal **http://mptenders.gov.in**

Gr No.	TENDER NO.	DISTRICT	TYPE OF WORK	NAME OF WORK	PAC (Rs. IN LAKH)	SUBMISSION OF EMD, TENDER FEES & TENDER DOCUMENT
01	2026_ PWDRB_ 547500_1	BHIND, DATIA & MORENA	BRIDGE WORK	**REHABILITATION, SPECIAL STRENGTHENING AND REPAIR OF BRIDGES-** (1) HL BRIDGE ACROSS ASAN RIVER ON BHONPURA-SIHONIYA ROAD IN DIST BHIND (2) HL BRIDGE ACROSS VAISHLY RIVER ON KHITOLI-DHAMSHA ROAD IN DIST BHIND (3) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS KHAR NALLA ON PRATAPPURA-GIRGAON ROAD IN DIST BHIND (4) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS VAISLY RIVER ON KANATHAR-BARASO ROAD IN DIST BHIND (5) HL BRIDGE ACROSS SINDH RIVER ON LAHAR-AMAYAN ROAD IN DIST BHIND (6) KUNWARI RIVER BRIDGE ON SIMRAO-KAMAI ROAD IN DIST BHIND (7) ASAN RIVER BRIDGE ON KHARAGPURA-ANHO ROAD IN DIST BHIND (8) VAISLY RIVER BRIDGE ON HATILE HANUMAN BRIDGE IN DIST BHIND (9) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS PARON NALLA ON INDERGARH-KAMAD ROAD IN DIST DATIA (10) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS KUNWARI RIVER ON MAHAVEERPURA-JAITPURA-TILAWALI ROAD IN DIST MORENA (11) KARRAI NALLA BRIDGE ON JADERUA-SUMAWALI ROAD IN DIST MORENA	495.19	ONLINE ONLY
02	2026_ PWDRB_ 547501_1	GWALIOR SHIVPURI SHEOPUR GUNA ASHOK NAGAR & MORENA	BRIDGE WORK	**REHABILITATION, SPECIAL STRENGTHENING AND REPAIR OF BRIDGES-** (1) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS BETWA RIVER ON BEENA-KANJIYA ROAD IN DIST ASHOKNAGAR (2) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS PARVATI RIVER ON KOHANJAPUR-SURTHANG ROAD IN DIST SHEOPUR (3) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS DHATUNI RIVER ON MANPUR-BAGADIYA ROAD IN DIST SHEOPUR (4) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS NANAWAD NALLA ON PREMSER-MUNDLA ROAD IN DIST SHEOPUR (5) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS SINDH RIVER ON MIYANA-NAI SARAI ROAD IN DIST GUNA (6) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS CHOPAT RIVER ON VIJAYPUR DHARNABADA ROAD IN DIST GUNA (7) HL BRIDGE ACROSS MEGHRA NALLA ON DABRA-CHINOR ROAD IN DIST GWALIOR (8) ROB AT KM 5 OF GWALIOR-JHANSI ROAD STATE HIGHWAY NO 37 NEAR AG OFFICE IN DIST GWALIOR (9) SUBMERSIBLE BRIDGE ACROSS CHHACHHOOD RIVER ON DABRA-JANGIPURA ROAD IN DIST GWALIOR (10) ASAN RIVER BRIDGE ON MS ROAD TO JARENA-SUMAWALI IN DIST MORENA (11) ASAN RIVER BRIDGE ON KHANETA-SUMAWALI ROAD IN DIST MORENA	471.85	ONLINE ONLY

Tender Document can be purchased from the above-mentioned portal after making online payment. Last date of purchase and uploading of Tender is **30.11.2026 till 17.30 PM**. Details of NIT and other information can only be seen on portal. All amendments in the tender will be published on website only. It cannot be published in Newspaper separately.

Sd/- **Executive Engineer**
PWD Bridge Construction Division Gwalior (M.P)

G-21350/26

Jharkhand Silk, Textile & Handicraft Development Corporation Ltd.

RFP No:1471

JHARCRAFT, a Government of Jharkhand Undertaking, invites proposals from eligible and experienced firms/agencies for undertaking the interior and civil works of JHARCRAFT Emporiums located at Bandra Linking Road Mumbai, Patratu Ramgarh, Ratu Road Ranchi, Birsa Munda Airport, Ranchi and JTDC Ranchi, including renovation, civil and interior works, branding, display infrastructure, MEP services and finishing works, as specified in the Request for Proposal (RFP).
Interested agencies may download the RFP document from the websites www.jharkhandtender.gov.in and www.jharcraft.in and submit their proposals in accordance with the eligibility criteria, scope of work, technical specifications and terms and conditions stipulated in the RFP.

1	Date of Publication of RFP	13/11/2026
2	RFP submission start date	13/11/2026 by 4:00 pm
3	Last date of submission of RFP	04/12/2026 by 12 :00 pm
4	Technical Proposal opening of RFP	05/12/2026 at 02:00 pm
5	Pre- bid Meeting Date & Time	18/11/2026 at 12.00 pm
6	Place of opening RFP	The Managing Director, Jharcraft, 1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ratu Road, Ranchi834001, Jharkhand

Jharcraft reserve the right to cancel, postponed, or reject any bid without assigning any reason at any stage.

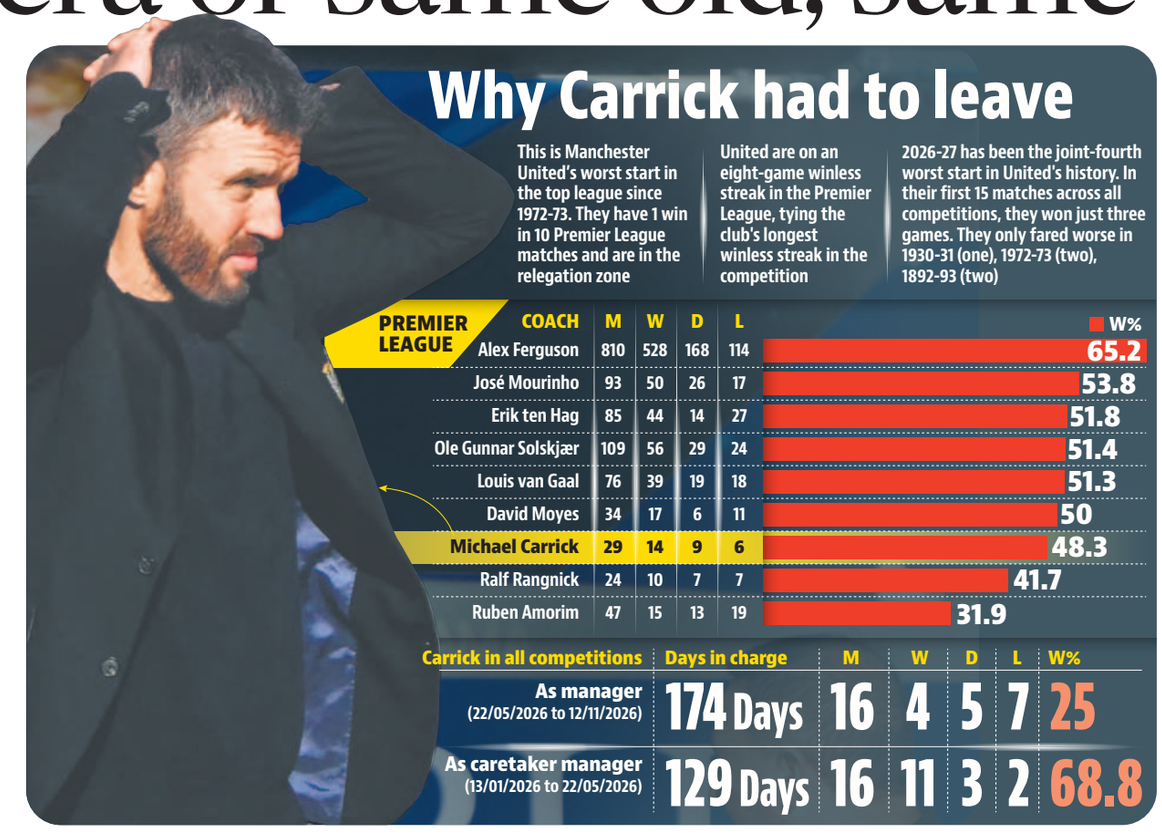
Sd/-Managing Director Jharcraft

PR 393749 (Jharkhand Silk Textile Handicraft Dev. Co. Ltd.(JHARCRAFT))26-27*D

Contact Detail: DGM (Marketing), Jharcraft
Udyog Bhawan ,Ratu Ranchi 834001 ,Jharkhand
Mob: +91-9771498540

Carrick out of United: Dawn of a new era or same old, same old?

Dhiman Sarkar
dhiman@htlive.com



KOLKATA: "Changing, changing, changing manager. But what about other areas?" Lisandro Martinez's question will remain unanswered for now because the conversation has shifted to what has become an annual autumn/winter affair at Manchester United: changing the head coach. So, goodbye Michael Carrick and an (almost certain) hello Mauricio Pochettino,

Since this has happened for the third time in three seasons, Martinez questioning the competence of those who hire and fire coaches is relevant but things work differently at a club that once won a record 13 Premier League titles but are now in the relegation zone with one win in 10 games.

"You are going down with City," Aston Villa supporters chanted at Old Trafford on Sunday. This, in the same month that news broke of 16-year-old JJ Gabriel wanting to leave the club for Real Madrid.

Even when they were relegated in 1973-74, Manchester United had not started this poorly. So, Carrick's position was untenable. Trailing 0-2 inside four minutes against Aston Villa was the earliest Manchester United had leaked a brace in Premier League history. Shipping 30 goals in all competitions is the most by any team in Europe's top five. Something had to give.

Appointed last January to replace Ruben Amorim who had come in for Erik ten Hag in October 2024, Carrick, 45, had spectacularly turned things around. Manchester United took 39 points from 17 Premier League matches, the most by any team. They finished third, returned to the Champions League and were under a club legend whose son trains at the United academy.

Injuries and a lack of squad depth notwithstanding, it made the fall even more stunning.

Carrick achieved results by reverting players to their positions. That meant Bruno Fernandes playing further up and Kobbie Mainoo's career being resurrected. For progress, the club needed to buy in summer but they chose to strengthen only the midfield.

The gaping hole at left-back remained. Luke Shaw started every Premier League game last term but he was injured. Diogo Dalot, who has seen nine managers come and go, is the symptom, not the problem. When Benjamin Sesko is injured, the club do not have a No.9. "Expected more from up," said Martinez in that interview after the loss to Atletico Madrid. He meant signings.

Problem is: if you don't sell, you can't buy. Manchester United have players few want. Dalot would be on that list along with Joshua Zirkjee, Marcus Rashford, Harry Maguire in his present avatar, Noussair Mazroui and Mason Mount. The list is by no means complete.

Before they were sacked, Carrick's predecessors wanted Erling Haaland, Harry Kane and Frenkie de Jong – players who have the experience and can be leaders in the change room. They got Cristiano Ronaldo before he moved to Saudi Arabia.

So, in fruity language, Manchester United supporters target their anger at and seek accountability from Omar Berrada and Jason Wilcox, chief executive and director of football respectively, men in black responsible for Carrick's hiring, firing and now his replacement. Television cameras turn to these former Manchester City employees when things go south on the pitch. Of which there has been a lot of late.

And, of course, to the owners. "History. Dignity. Honour. You stole it all," said a banner at Old Trafford on Sunday. A club that was run well and won things is saddled with debt, a leaking roof and former players making a career in punditry by dissing it.

All of this has led to what Martinez said in that flash interview. Players' body language tends to become negative when things don't go their way, he said. Lenny Yoro's back-header, Dalot's foul on Alysson, Senne Lemmens's errors and failure to protect a 2-0 lead against Brighton (Carabao Cup) were proof of how brittle this squad is. "Standards," said a banner with picture of former legends at one game. Never has one word conveyed so much.

An article in The Guardian last month pointed out that only Matt Busby and Ferguson have "knocked the club into shape." John Brewin then analyses how their outsize influence meant the job became a poisoned chalice for those who came after.

Into this cauldron (likely) enters Pochettino, 54, whose foul on Michael Owen led to David Beckham exorcising the ghosts of the 1998 World Cup. Pochettino made Harry Kane better, transformed Son Heungmin and Tottenham Hotspur. He took Chelsea to a final and a semi-final in England, won the league in France and who knows how USA would have fared in the World Cup had the Balogun saga not blown up in their face.

But can he get a squad that regularly runs less than their opponents to adopt the kind of aggressive, pressing game he is known for?

Manchester United are said to have been wanting him for 10 years, but after paying what should be a massive severance fee, are they getting him at the right time? Will Manchester United be able to work the transfer market like they need to? "It's hard to hold a candle in the cold November rain," the Guns N' Roses line feels evocative as one comes in and another bites the dust. Or, days after Manchester United marked 40 years of Ferguson joining, will this be the start of a new era?

Vivaan wins silver and LA Olympics quota spot in trap

Avishek Roy
avishek.roy@htlive.com

Vivaan Kapoor. NRAI

NEW DELHI: Vivaan Kapoor delivered a stellar performance, holding his own against some of the biggest names in trap shooting to secure India's third LA Olympics shooting quota at the ISSF World Championships in Doha. The 24-year-old was on a hot streak but narrowly missed the gold medal, losing a tense shoot-off to Kuwait's Abdulrahman Al-Faihan after both shooters were tied at 29 hits out of 30.

Both shooters were in top form as they finished level, forcing a shoot-off to decide the gold medal. Vivaan blinked first after hitting the target twice, while Al-Faihan registered three successful hits to take gold, much to the delight of the home crowd. China's Qi Ying won the bronze medal with 22 hits. The three medallists secured the LA Olympic quota places. The quotas, however, belong to the country, and Vivaan will have to come through the Olympic Selection Trials before LA to secure his place on the Indian team.

On Thursday, competing in his first-ever final at the World Championships, Vivaan showed little sign of nerves as he shot his way to a silver medal and an Olympic quota for India.

"I gave my best. It was a tough final and I wanted to focus on my job. I have competed against these shooters before and that experience helped. A big thanks to coach Peter (Wilson) for guiding us before the competition. In the end, I was flowing," the Jaipur-based shooter told the ISSF.

"It's great the silver came along with the Olympic quota. I have to give my best, get better and better," said Vivaan, only the fourth Indian trap medallist at the World Championships.

It was India's third Olympic quota at the World Championships. Jaypal Malviya (10m air pistol) and Niraj Kumar (50m rifle three positions) are the other two shooters to have secured quotas.

There were disappointments too. Double Olympic medallist Manu Bhaker qualified for two finals but failed to secure a quota. She came close in the 25m pistol, finishing fourth. This was the first ISSF event offering Olympic quota places, and there will be more opportunities next year.

Earlier, India's two trap shooters, Vivaan and Udaivir Singh Jaijee, qualified for the final from a strong field of 122 competitors. Paris Olympic champion Nathan Hales of Great Britain topped the qualification with 123 hits. China's Qi Ying was second with 122, and Al-Faihan was third with 121.

Vivaan and Udaivir were among seven shooters who finished with 120 hits and had to negotiate a shoot-off to secure their places in the eight-shooter final. Zoravar Singh Sandhu, who won a bronze medal in the previous edition, finished 55th.

In the company of Olympic and World Championships medallists, Vivaan, a former Asian junior champion competing in a major final for the first time, shot as if he belonged on the big stage. He was on target from the start, with his first and only miss coming on his 28th shot. He gave the experienced Al-Faihan a tough fight before bagging silver.

Strengthening of Public Financial Management (SPFM) Project
Assisted by the World Bank
37-A, IT Park, Sahastradhara Road, Dehradun (Uttarakhand), Pin: 248013
Contact No.: +91 94115 71697; E-Mail: pmu.spfm@gmail.com

Reference No.: 393 /01/RFQ/Goods/IT/SPFM/2026-27 Dated: 12/11/2026

NOTICE INVITING QUOTATION

Online quotations are invited for Procurement of IT Equipment (Laptop, AIO, Printers, Smart TV, LCD Screen etc.) from eligible bidders under the SPFM Project being implemented under the Finance Department, Government of Uttarakhand.

The RFQ Document for above procurement is available in **https://uktenders.gov.in** from 13/11/2026 at 03:00 PM. The last date for submission of quotations is 01/12/2026 respectively at 11:00 AM. The Technical Part will be opened on same date at 11:30 AM. The procurement activity may be searched on www.uktenders.gov.in under the Organisation "Chief Project Director PMU SPFM."

Project Director SPFM Project

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
Office of Chief Engineer (O&M), Kumaon Zone, 220KV S/s, Campus, Kamaluaganja, Haldwani-263139
Corporate ID U40101UR2004SGC028675 Phone No. 7088117917

E-Tender Time Extension Notice-2

Due to unavoidable circumstances the date of submission of **E-Tender Specification No. CE/OandM/PTCUL/HLD/59/2026-27, TENDER ID (2026_PTCU9_100573_1)** has been extended upto 26.11.2026, 17:00 Hrs. For more details please visit E-Tender Website ***www.uktenders.gov.in*** and E-Tender time extension notice is available at PTCUL Website ***www.ptcul.org***. All other terms and conditions of the above tenders will remain same. For any assistance on E-Tendering, please contact +91-8899890000

Chief Engineer (O&M)
Kumaon Zone

Letter No. 2267/CE(O&M)/PTCUL/HLD/E-Tender
Date : 12.11.2026 **"Save Electricity in the Interest of Nation"** PTCUL, Haldwani

NIQ Reference No. PGSC/458

Notice Inviting Quotation

Sealed offers are invited from internet service providers for providing optical fiber based internet leased line connectivity at Pushpa Gujral Science City Kapurthala for the period from 01.01.2027 to 31.12.2027. Last Date for submission of quotation is 25.11.2026 (1500 Hrs) at PGSC, Kapurthala. The proforma for submission of the quotation may be downloaded from **https://pgsciencecity.punjab.gov.in**

Administrative Officer
RO No. 3079/12/2026/27/16932 **Pushpa Gujral Science City, Kapurthala**

GHAZIABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Navyug Market, Opp. Old Bus Stand Ghaziabad 201001, Uttar Pradesh
E-mail:gzb.nagar.nigam@gmail.com Website:www.ghaziabadnagarnigam.in

TENDER NOTICE NO: 143/Nirman/2026-27 Dated 12-11-2026
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of RFP	Selection of Transaction Advisor & Project Development Consultant for Development of the Ghaziabad Integrated Business and Innovation Hub, Ghaziabad, on Public–Private Partnership (PPP) / Design–Build–Finance–Operate–Transfer (DBFOT) Mode.
Ref No.	143/Nirman/2026-27 Date 12-11-2026
Date of Publication of e-Bid notice	13-11-2026 on e-Tender Portal https://etender.up.nic.in
Last date for submission of e-Bids on e-Tender portal	21-11-2026, 3:00 PM
Site for Submission of e-Bids e-Bid Inviting Officer	e-Tender Portal https://etender.up.nic.in Municipal Commissioner, Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam
Date of Opening of Technical e-Bids	21-11-2026, 4.00 PM
Date of Opening of Financial e-Bids	To be informed at a later stage
Venue of Opening of e-Bids	Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam Navyug Market, Opp-Old Bus Stand Ghaziabad – 201001 (UP)
Contact addresses	Chief Engineer (Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam) Email: nirmanvibhag01@gmail.com gzb.nagar.nigam@gmail.com Phone: 8178016833
Consortium:	Allowed
Tender Fee:	Non-refundable fee of INR 5,900, (including GST 18%) to be paid on E-tender website i.e. https://etender.up.nic.in
EMD:	INR 1,00,000/- to be paid on E-tender website i.e. https://etender.up.nic.in

Chief Engineer
Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam

कार्यालय नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल
Email : nppnainital@gmail.com (दूरभाष: 05942–235153)

पत्रांक : 1271/xv-18 दिनांक : 12.11.2026

ई–निविदा सूचना

सर्वसाधारण/इच्छुक फर्म/व्यक्ति को सूचित किया जाता है कि नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल सीमान्तर्गत निम्न कार्य की (दिनांक 01 दिसम्बर 2026 से 30 नवम्बर 2027 तक 01 वर्ष हेतु) निम्नानुसार ई–निविदा अमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा में प्रतिभाग करने हेतु www.uktenders.gov.in पर नियम व शर्तें देखी एवं अपलोड की जा सकती हैं।

क्रमांक	कार्य का विवरण	ई–निविदा संख्या	पोर्टल विवरण
01	नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल अन्तर्गत समस्त 15 वार्डों में डोर टू डोर कूड़ा एकत्रीकरण, स्थानीय परिवहन एवं हल्द्वानी ट्रंचिंग ग्राउण्ड तक कूड़ा परिवहन ठेका वर्ष दिनांक 01 दिसम्बर 2026 से 30 नवम्बर 2027 तक 01 वर्ष हेतु)	2026_NPNTL_102356_1	www.uktenders.gov.in

अतः इच्छुक फर्म/व्यक्ति/निविदादाता ऑनलाईन निविदा मे प्रतिभाग कर सकते हैं। जो कि निविदा फॉर्म में उल्लेखित विवरण के अनुसार शासन द्वारा गठित कमेटी के समक्ष निविदादाताओं की उपस्थिति में खोले जाऐंगे। तकनीकि निविदा खोले जाने के उपरान्त ही वित्तीय निविदा खोली जायेगी तथा तकनीकि निविदा में सफल हुए निविदादाताओं की ही वित्तीय निविदा खोली जायेगी। किसी भी निविदा को स्वीकृत/अस्वीकृत करने का पूर्ण अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरिओं के पास सुरक्षित होगा।

अध्यक्ष, नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल
अधिशासी अधिकारी, नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Letter No- E Office File No: NCR-AGC0COMM(MISC)/16/2026 Date: 09.11.2026

E-Tender Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager- North Central Railway- Agra invites GeM Bid Number:- GEM/2026/B/8246779, Date:- 05.11.2026 as per details given as under:-

GeM Bid Number: GeM Bid Number:- GEM/2026/B/8246779, Date:- 05.11.2026
GeM Bid Details: Custom Bid for Services - Tender for the work for outsourcing of comprehensive management of parcel activities mentioned in FM circular 26 of 2025 for AGC under Agra Division for 03 years.
GeM Bid End Date and Time: Date:- 26.11.2026 Time:- 18:00
GeM Bid Opening Date and Time: Date:- 27.11.2026 Time:- 18:00
Note: Prospective bidders are requested to visit GeM Portal website **(https://gem.gov.in).** The above mentioned GeM Bid details are available therein under the above mentioned GeM Bid Number. **2566/26(K)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
Regd. office: PSEB head office, The Mall, Patiala-147001
Corporate Identity Number: U40109PP20SGC033813

TENDER ENQUIRY No. 04/BTI/GCD/TS/PSPCL/2026-27 DATED: 12.11.2026

Dy. CE/Grid construction circle, Power colony-1, Sarabha Nagar, PSPCL, Ludhiana invites open e-Tender for **hiring 01 No. mobile crane of 150 ton capacity for loading, unloading and placement of power transformers upto 31.5 MVA for carrying out various works under Grid Construction Circle, Ludhiana.** For detailed NIT Tender Specifications please refer to **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 12.11.2026 (11.30 AM onwards).

Note: Corrigendum and amendments, if any, will be published online at **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in**.

RO No. 1079/12/2026/27/17023 C1089/26

PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033814, www.pstcl.org
O/o: Dy. CE/Projects, Tele: 96461-04141, E-mail: se-projects@pstcl.org

Notice Inviting E-Tender

Enquiry No.	STQ-3080
Description	Construction of 220 KV Substation at Shri Hargobindpur (to be upgraded from 132kv)
Starting date of downloading/Publishing date	17.11.2026
Last date of downloading	15.12.2026 upto 11.00 A.M.
Pre-Bid Meeting Date	01.12.2026 at 11.00 AM
Last Date & Time for receipt of tender	15.12.2026 upto 11.00 A.M.
Date & Time for Opening of tender	17.12.2026 at 03.00 P.M.

Detailed NIT/specification may be downloaded from PSTCL e-tendering website **www.eproc.punjab.gov.in**. Corrigendum, if any, will not be published in newspapers. As such the website may be visited regularly for updates.

Sd/- **Dy. CE/Projects**
RO NO. 1078/12/2026/27/17006 **PSTCL, Patiala**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. AGC/Br/L/2026-27/04 Dated : 10.11.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Engineer/Bridge/Line/North Central Railway/Agra acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-TENDERS on prescribed form for the following work up to **15:00** Hrs on **04.12.2026.** The details of the Tender are as under:-

Tender No. : BR-AGC-2026-13
Name of Work : "Extension of NDLS end FOB at Agra Cantt station to 2nd entry circulating area" and "Extension of existing FOB (Mathura end) at Agra Cantt station towards circulating area with other ancillary works"
Approx. Cost of work : ₹ 145825932.90 | **Bid Security :** ₹ 2916500.00
Completion Period : 12 Months | **Date of Opening of tender :** 04.12.2026
Eligibility Criteria for similar work : "Fabrication and erection/launching of steel bridges/FOB."

Note: 1. E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderer. **2.** The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15.00** Hrs on the due date of tender opening. **3.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act, 2000. **4.** Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightway ignored and shall not be considered. **5.** The tenderers shall submit certificates as given in tender document as "Annexure" in standard format without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. **6.** The supplier / contractor of goods and / or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. **7.** Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. **8.** This tender notice has also been uploaded on **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. 9.**Payment of Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through net banking or payment gateway only. **10.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of **IREPS** may be approached. **11.** Tender online can be submitted up to **15.00** Hrs of due date of tender opening. **12.** The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of IRGCC-2022 (Works matter) mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as Incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered. **2565/26 (PH)**

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1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ROUGH COST ESTIMATE FOR REPAIR, MAINTENANCE OF (MOTORS, PUMP, STARTER ETC.) BOOSTING STATION OF SECTOR 29, 30 IN WARD NO. 30 FOR A PERIOD OF 1 YEARS, DIV. V. + 13 WORKS	10.11.2026 17.11.2026	1,96,31,491/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf5@gmail.com
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Bumrah is a great because he is never satisfied: Bond

Ex-MI coach, who worked with the pacer for 9 years, talks about his experience of working with Bumrah

Rasesh Mandani
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MUMBAI: The days when India's national selectors contemplated whether Jasprit Bumrah would adapt to all formats now seem light years ago. Fifty-two Test matches into his journey, Bumrah has put all doubts to rest and become the foremost fast bowler of his generation across formats.

Shane Bond served as bowling coach of Mumbai Indians for nine years between 2015 and 2023 and saw peak Jasprit Bumrah from close quarters.

So how does he coach a genius like Bumrah? "It's the same as anybody," Bond straightforwardly explains in this interview.

Currently working as a commentator with Sky Sport New Zealand, the former Kiwi quick is among the few coaches whose counsel the Indian pace ace seeks from time to time.

"There are always elements to any player where you look for improvement," Bond said. "It's about making sure that you're pushing for those improvements, even if it's in small areas. Otherwise, there's no point in being a coach. You're just a cheerleader.

"I think the beauty of the time I spent with him...the IPL allowed us to be two months together and we worked for nine seasons. So you get to know someone pretty well. I think that really helps — just the continuity and the relationship with the player. So you can understand how they tick, the days where you can get a sense when they wake up, in a good mood or a bad mood. And you've got eyes on them all the time, so you can pick up on stuff."

Even the great fast bowlers are always keen to strike conversations to upskill. "I think that's the key to being a great bowler. The reason why players are great players is because they're always looking for improvement, never satisfied," said Bond.

"As a fast bowler, you probably recognise that towards the back end of your career, you're going to lose a little pace. So you've got to find different ways to be successful. With Jas, given the level of his competitiveness, you were just asking and posing questions about areas where he can improve. As a coach, I certainly don't have all the answers for everybody. But the job of the bowler is to just listen and consider it. Sometimes you just strike a good relationship with certain people and you can have an impact on them."

> "I feel like the change of pace is probably an underutilised ball in Test cricket. So if you've got an arsenal of weapons that's so effective in short-form cricket, there's no reason why it can't be used in Test cricket, especially when you're sort of not expecting it.
>
> "Statistically, he (Bumrah) sits at a level above every other bowler. People would recognise that he's been the best bowler in IPL for a number of years. When you played MI, you always had to account for the Bumrah factor. He could take wickets at any stage, but when you are chasing and if he had two overs left... he sort of impacts the whole way that you structure your chase. — **Shane Bond**

In 2023 when Bumrah underwent back surgery in New Zealand, Bond was by his side and had plenty to share from his own experiences. "I'd go and see him and take him across to my son's school to meet all his mates when they were playing cricket. It was cool. So when you've gone through a similar experience, you can relate to it. I suppose it just makes that relationship even closer," he said.

Successful athletes often talk about the work that happens when no one is watching — in training. It's no different with Bumrah. "With some seasons, you come with a lot of cricket, some you haven't had as much. Once you are older, wiser, you sort of understand how to manage yourself," Bond said about Bumrah's preparations for IPL. "I think it looked like last season he was carrying an injury, which he was managing himself through the season. When he hasn't been injured, he's been the best bowler by some distance. When he's on, he's that bowler."

Part of Bumrah's excellence is his ability to integrate white-ball deliveries in Test match spells, never apprehensive that he might lose his lengths.

"I feel like the change of pace is probably an underutilised ball in Test cricket. So if you've got an arsenal of weapons that's so effective in short-form cricket, there's no reason why it can't be used in Test cricket, especially when you're sort of not expecting it," said Bond. "In Indian conditions where the wickets are flat, you might get some reverse swing. Then, you know, it's such a surprise. Bumrah is so good with it that it becomes that wicket-taking delivery."

One such iconic delivery was the reverse-swinging yorker that uprooted England's Ollie Pope's stumps in the Visakhapatnam Test of 2024. The beauty about Bumrah is his defensive masterclass in T20 cricket is so good, it receives the same recognition.

"Statistically, he sits at a level above every other bowler. I think people would recognise that he's been the best bowler in the IPL for a number of years," said Bond. "When you played Mumbai Indians, you always sort of had to account for the Bumrah factor. A, he could take wickets at any stage, but particularly when you were chasing and if he had 2 overs left...he sort of impacts the whole way that you structure your chase. In my time at MI, you always felt like he could change the game.

"We won a couple of IPL finals (2017, 2019) by one run, and he was hugely influential on that. Obviously in the 2026 T20 WC semi-final and the 2024 T20 WC final, he was the game changer. And you don't have too many like him in T20s, particularly fast bowlers, who are that impactful. And that's no disrespect to some incredible bowlers. But his statistics are almost ridiculous. So, yeah, it's fun watching the best at work, especially when they're at the peak."

Bond added, "One thing that's always struck me about Boom is his self-belief and confidence in his own ability. And you marry all that stuff together, the prep, that's why you've got such a great bowler."

India still favourites to add to their gains

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KOLKATA: If the forecast is to be trusted, rain won't follow India to Mount Maunganui. And that is the best news to come out of a series between two evenly matched sides that has been disrupted far too many times by inclement weather.

India, leading 2-0, can't lose this series. But that doesn't mean this series has been won yet. Zealously guarding a home record that for the last seven years has remained unscathed, New Zealand must be sniffing an opportunity to win the last two ODIs in Mount Maunganui and square the series. Under a new captain in Shreyas Iyer, India's job is to keep building on their momentum, starting with the fourth ODI on Friday.

Considering the slight change in personnel, it could be a slightly tricky proposition though. Shubman Gill and KL Rahul have joined the Test squad, but Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli have stayed back.

Kohli has struck runs but not Rohit, while Iyer seems once again plagued by the short ball. Expect some more spunk down the order in the form of Ishan Kishan, with the possibility of Tilak Varma and Ruturaj Gaikwad entering the foyer of one-day cricket.

It leaves India in a slight conundrum about the batting order if Kishan opens with Rohit, followed by Kohli and Iyer.

Earlier in the series, Axar Patel was sent at No 6, ahead of Rahul, a strategy based purely on the insurance Rahul brings to the table as an all-weather anchor.

In his absence, Gaikwad becomes the most viable candidate to anchor the middle order but it remains to be seen if India are still open to sending Patel ahead of him. Gaikwad takes a little time to open up and the thinktank would be wary of sending him too late. Adding Varma to this order would be a heist considering it would reduce India's bowling strength and they won't want that at this juncture.

The fourth ODI at Bay Oval is an opportunity to finish the job, ideally with the bowling specialists India have brought. Enter Kuldeep Yadav and Mohammed Siraj, both of whom have puzzlingly not bowled a single delivery in the white-ball series so far.

Siraj could finally get a game now that Anshul Kamboj has left, but it remains to be seen if Iyer pairs Patel with Kuldeep. To Iyer, this is much more than an administrative promotion.

Not only is he being asked to work with several players who have been on the fringes for some time, Iyer himself has been battling a psychological war with the spongy bounce at New Zealand. That tactic might again be deployed in the fourth ODI, though the pitch at the Bay Oval isn't a drop-in surface and is getting considerably more sun compared to the tracks in the previous three ODIs.

That should also be good news to New Zealand, whose decision to split the ODI team has prompted the return of opener Finn Allen at the top of the batting order. Allen and Seifert are a thing in T20, and the same could be expected in one-dayers as well.

Beyond the bragging rights of the series is a larger context difficult to ignore. With the 2027 ODI World Cup approaching, neither side can afford to treat the remaining two one-dayers as merely a bilateral engagement. India need to identify and establish a spin bowling hierarchy.

The fast bowlers already given a good workout, focus needs to be trained on the all-rounders bit. If Naman Dhir is to be persisted with, maybe an out-of-turn batting promotion would do him a world of good. Likewise, Auqib Nabi too needs to have more overs under his belt.

Nabi's debut at home (against West Indies) was forgettable, but much better displays at Auckland (0/33) and Wellington (2/31) must have calmed him. Advice from Kohli, Rohit and Gill have helped too.

"Here, you have to depend more on the seam movement. Because the top level batsmen play swing. So, that was their feedback (Kohli, Rohit, Gill)," said Nabi. "Here, if you do scramble seam or hit the deck, there is a chance to get more wickets here. That is what they told me."

With so much going for Nabi, it's hard to fathom that he won't bowl in the fourth ODI as well. The same goes for Siraj, who India must be thinking of warming up soon keeping in mind the Test series next week. It's why despite the Test split, India are favourites to add to their gains in this series. New Zealand have home advantage, but little else going for them right now.

India in New Zealand in bilateral one-dayers

	M	Won	Lost	NR	Tied	Sequence
2026/27*	3	2	1			
2022/23	3	1	2			
2019/20	3	3				
2018/19	5	4	1			
2013/14	5	4	1			
2008/09	5	3	1	1		
2002/03	7	2	5			
1998/99	5	2	2			
1993/94	4	2	2			
1980/81	2	2				
1975/76	2	2				

*Ongoing series

YOUTH OLYMPICS: AMBEKAR PUNCHES HISTORIC GOLD FOR INDIA

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NEW DELHI: Boxer L Ambekar Meetei created history at the Youth Olympics in Dakar on Thursday, winning India's first-ever gold medal in his sport. The 50kg pugilist defeated Ireland's Kristian Jubani 3-2 in a closely-contested 50kg final.

Ambekar's gold is India's first at the ongoing edition in Dakar. The triumph marks a landmark moment for Indian boxing at the Youth Olympics, with Shiva Thapa's (60kg) silver medal at the 2010 Games being the country's previous best performance in the sport. Vikas Krishan won a bronze in the same edition in Singapore.

The 17-year-old enjoyed a dominant run to the final, stopping Namibia's Abraham Kalenga in the first round of their quarter-final bout before registering a comprehensive 5-0 victory over Colombia's Izzon Jeffrey Galea Arevalo in the semi-finals. In the summit clash, Ambekar mounted a remarkable comeback after losing the opening round on all five cards to the reigning European U17 champion. The Indian responded by going on an all-out attack in Round 2. Jubani was up to the task but Ambekar's better accuracy meant he took the round 3-2.

The final round was more one-sided with Ambekar landing a flurry of punches to take the round 4-1 and secure an overall 3-2 win.

Ambekar, whose training base is Army Sports Institute in Pune, tuned up for the competition at a preparatory camp in NIS Patiala. Hailing from Imphal East district in Manipur, he took up sport at the age of nine at the insistence of his uncle who got him enrolled in National Sports Academy in Khuman Lampak SPorts Complex in Imphal.

{ TEMBA BAVUMA } SOUTH AFRICA CAPTAIN

'A World Cup at home will be an occasion in itself'

Vishesh Roy
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NEW DELHI: *His name is Temba; he comes from Langa; He came to score, came to score, came to score, score, score; Temba Bavuma, he comes from Langa; To play for Protea*

This was the chant that echoed as South Africa ended the silverware drought last year by winning the World Test Championship final at Lord's. From there on, the legend of South Africa captain Temba Bavuma has never stopped growing. The 36-year-old led from the front as the Proteas fought back to defeat Australia 2-1 to clinch the recent three-match Test series.

The Proteas are now getting ready to host Bangladesh in a two-match Test series, and ahead of the opener in Johannesburg on Sunday, HT caught up with Bavuma. Excerpts:

A WTC final win, series wins over India and Australia. What do you think SA are doing right in Tests?

There are a lot of things that we are doing right. A lot of our success has been built over the last couple of years as we've come together as this new Test team. You have a sense of 15 guys playing for each other and trying to achieve something remarkable. I would say that, intrinsically, those are the types of values that allow us to be consistent in our success.

The series against Australia didn't start off well; how did you rally the troops?

It was a rude introduction for us, a re-introduction into Test cricket.... South Africans are known to be resilient. I had a self-introspection before turning it on to the players and how we could find ways to go forward.

Your thoughts on off-spinner Simon Harmer

Simon has been superb for us in his second life, I'd say, within Test cricket. He's carried on from his performances in India to come here in this Australian series. He identifies moments when the team needs motivation and is courageous enough to put himself on the line at times. I know Simon from when we were trying to make it into First-Class cricket. So I have a better sense of the character behind the man.

Temba Bavuma celebrates his ton against Australia. AP

Can you speak a little about your association with head coach Shukri Conrad?

We work well together. He's yin to my yang. He's a little more exuberant and, at times, unorthodox in his thinking and in ways; he challenges me and the team in many of our approaches. And it's all in the effort to get the best out of individuals. A lot of our early chat was about how we could create an environment where guys could play freely, express themselves, and be who they naturally are.

We recognise that by doing that, that's when guys will be able to play at their best. Having that alignment and synergy from the beginning has helped create the required foundation.

What do you reckon is the bigger achievement? The WTC final triumph or the series wins over India or Australia?

The biggest achievement is definitely the WTC final. That's something that we've been yearning for as a South African team to have silverware, to bring back a trophy. We've had a lot of heartache as a nation, as a cricketing team. To be at the forefront, to lead that, that's definitely something. In India, we hadn't won a series for several years. I think Hansie Cronje was the last time we did that, then beating Australia. Those two are achievements as well.

South Africa will co-host the ODI World Cup. Do you think it can truly cement your legacy?

Oh boy, that's a big question. Just that opportunity, right, to lead the team in the World Cup, in a home World Cup. That will be an occasion in itself. The opportunity, again, to do something that we haven't done in a 50-over World Cup. That's a prospect that I'm trying to get my mind around. In terms of legacy, I think that's for the people out there.

That's not really something that I chase as a player, but I'm sure it will do a world of good. It's definitely going to be one of the highlights of my career, if not the best.

Are you aware of the love and adulation you receive online? Have you seen those memes and all?

Definitely not aware. I'm glad people are finding enjoyment in me. I sometimes see the memes that are floating about, some good, some not so flattering, and the nicknames as well. Look, it's nice to be seen in a joyful way, if I can put it that way. I'm not that big on social media. I've got accounts there, but I really try not to dive too deep. But super cool to know that people are enjoying anything related to me there.

Bembem, Ancheri file nomination

NEW DELHI: Former India captains Oinam Bembem Devi and Joe Paul Ancheri were among nine former players who filed their nominations for the election of four Sportspersons of Merit ahead of the AIFF polls.

India enter U-19 Asia Cup final

AL AMERAT (OMAN): Skipper Lakshya Raichandani struck 93 as India pummelled Afghanistan by eight wickets in the semi-final on Thursday to set up a final clash against Pakistan in the U-19 Asia Cup here.

New Zealand beat India 5-0 in friendly

AUCKLAND: The Indian men's national team suffered a 0-5 defeat to New Zealand in its first international friendly of the November FIFA window here.

Srikanth stuns Naraoka in Japan

KUMAMOTO: Veteran shuttler Kidambi Srikanth and Lakshya Sen progressed to the men's singles quarter-finals with contrasting wins at the Japan Masters here.

Pak-Sri Lanka Test hit by bad weather

RAWALPINDI: Rain and bad light hit the first Test between Pakistan and Sri Lanka after pacer Saqib Khan took 7/130 on debut to lead the home team's fightback on Thursday as Sri Lanka collapsep from 404/4 to 446 all out.

Ice hockey body nominates Usha for IOA polls

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NEW DELHI: In a fresh twist to the IOA election, president PT Usha who lost the polls of Sportsperson of Outstanding Merit (SOM) earlier this week, was nominated by the Ice Hockey Association of India (IHAI) as one of its representatives for the IOA polls.

Usha is part of the 70-member provisional electoral college published by returning officer Sanjay Kumar Srivastava on Thursday. Members of the electoral college can cast vote and run for elections to the IOA executive council to be held on Dec 5.

All 30 eligible federations have sent names of one male and one female representative for the elections. AFI has nominated Adille Sumariwalla, who withdrew from the SOM elections.

PT Usha. PTI

It remains to be seen whether there are objections to Usha's nomination. She became IOA president as SOM in 2022.

IHAI itself has been going through internal turmoil. On Thursday, IHAI vice-president Ajit Kakkar wrote to IOA to debar IHAI from participating in the elections.

The final electoral roll will be published on Sunday after scrutiny, verification and disposal of objections. Filing of nominations will be from Nov 22-24.

Usha lost a bitter SOM election after finishing fifth behind Anju Bobby George, Dola Banerjee Rani Rampal and Saina Nehwal. Four female and four male SOMs were elected to the IOA general assembly.

Questions have been raised over the conduct of SOM elections. Olympic champion Abhinav Bindra made public a letter he had written to electoral officer on Oct 31 raising concerns over apparent inconsistency between the IOA constitution (Article 3.7) and the rules followed during the recently concluded SOM elections. Though Bindra voted in the SOM elections on Monday, he did not contest. Bindra received a response but said his specific questions remained unanswered.

"It is important that our constitutional provisions, electoral rules and administrative procedures are clearly aligned and communicated leaving little room as possible for ambiguity," Bindra had written on Oct 31.

Pragg loses to Caruana, Bibisara takes down Arjun

BENGALURU: The second round of the group stage didn't get off to a great start for the Indians. Praggnanandhaa lost to world No 3 Fabiano Caruana after inviting a piece sacrifice. Hans Niemann avenged his blitz loss to Vaishali with a win in the fast classic format. Bibisara Assaubayeva pulled off the biggest win of her career, beating Arjun Erigaisi, who is rated almost 200 points above her, in the Total Chess Pilot in Budapest.

"My first impression of fast classic is that it's very exciting. I had so much fun playing it," Arjun said during his visit to the confessional booth. The fast classic group stage is crucial, since only the winners of each of the four groups will advance.

Seventeen-year-old Abhimanyu Mishra, who broke Sergey Karjakin's record to become the world's youngest GM at 12 years, four months and 25 days in 2021, managed to hold world No 1 Magnus Carlsen to a draw in Round 2.

After the first game of Round 2, Firouzja, Jan-Krzysztof Duda, Caruana, Liem Le, Ian Nepomniachtchi, Anish Giri and Maxime Vachier-Lagrave were leading their respective groups. HTC

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ENTERTAINMENT & PROMOTIONAL FEATURES

PHOTO: INSTAGRAM/ KIARAALIAADVANI

People had already started calling out the hypocrisy of the comments. So, I really didn't feel the need to justify it.

KIARA ADVANI, Actor

Grow up: Kiara to critics of intimate scenes

Actor Kiara Advani had a simple rapid-fire response to those objecting to her performing intimate scenes in *Toxic* as a married women: "Grow up". Appearing with husband, actor Sidharth Malhotra on *Koffee With Karan*, she said, "Such things have been happening for decades, and many wonderful actors have faced them, starting with Aishwarya Rai (Bachchan, actor)."

She added that despite trolls commenting, "That's Sidharth's wife btw", her husband never reacted to any noise. "I fed off his energy because he had not cared about it. He never even brought it up. We have never even spoken about this," she said.

On the film's underwhelming box-office performance, she said, "As a team, I don't think any of us saw it coming, when the movie misfired despite it opening to what it did (₹100 crore, reportedly). It was heartbreaking, especially during the opening weekend. I was very low."

Kiara also spoke about bonding with actors Alia Bhatt, Katrina Kaif and Patralekhaa during her postpartum phase in 2025. "We were checking up on each other. All of us are in the same field. I remember calling [Alia] up and asking about getting back to shoot, and understanding how do we make this work. Your priority is your family as well, and at work, you are a professional. How do you blend these two worlds in a way that doesn't make you feel guilty at times? Mom guilt is just there," she said.

PHOTO: INSTAGRAM

STOP PRESS

Actor Johnny Depp has returned to Hollywood after eight years with Ebenezer, playing Scrooge in Ti West's adaptation of A Christmas Carol. This is his first major project after his 2022 defamation case win against ex-wife Amber Heard. He was last seen in Fantastic Beasts: The Crimes of Grindelwald (2018). Depp reportedly earned $5 million (over ₹46 crore), down from a reported $16 million (over ₹140 crore) for the Fantastic Beasts franchise.

PHOTOS: INSTAGRAM/ KAREENA KAPOORKHAN

Kareena Kapoor Khan wore a 30-carat emerald pendant bearing Quranic verses

Kareena's Diwali fit lands in legal trouble

Kareena Kapoor Khan's Diwali look is at the centre of a legal dispute. The actor was served a legal notice by social activist and Madhya Pradesh Congress spokesperson Abbas Hafeez over her Instagram post showing her beige kaftan by Punit Balana and a 30-carat emerald pendant.

The historic Bhopal royal pendant, inscribed with Ayat-ul-Kursi, the 255th verse of Surah Al-Baqarah, part of the second chapter of the Quran, originally belonged to the Begum of Bhopal and was passed down to Kareena after her marriage to actor Saif Ali Khan. Notably, Saif had worn it at their wedding.

Hafeez has objected to its use as a "fashion accessory", claiming it holds religious and historical significance. He has also demanded that she remove the pictures and issue an apology. Kareena did not address the issue until the time of going to press. **HTC**

WHO OWNS JALSA?

Amitabh Bachchan's sister-in-law challenges transfer of the Mumbai property to his wife, Jaya Bachchan; says Jalsa remains in her name on paper

◀ Amitabh Bachchan PHOTO: YOGEN SHAH

A property dispute over actor Amitabh Bachchan's Mumbai residence, Jalsa, has brought a decades-old family transaction under scrutiny. Ramola Bachchan, wife of Amitabh's brother Ajitabh, has claimed that the bungalow was registered in her name, challenging a 1993 gift deed which transferred the Juhu property to Amitabh's wife, Jaya Bachchan.

According to Mumbai Mirror, Ramola has claimed that she neither knew about nor consented to the transfer and filed complaints over the past seven months. She has also alleged that the deed was prepared on plain paper without any witnesses or stamp duty payment. While the Kapol Co-operative Housing Society records name Jaya as owner, the government's Property Card reportedly retains Ramola's name.

Andheri's Deputy Registrar of Co-operative Societies, Faiyaz Mulani, confirmed a hearing had begun and responses were sought. The Bachchan family has not issued a statement. We reached out to Ramola and her son, who told us, "No comment." **HTC**

Ramola Bachchan PHOTO: FACEBOOK/ RAMOLA BACHCHAN

ABOUT JALSA

The property in Mumbais' Juhu was originally called Mansa and belonged to producer NC Sippy. According to The Free Press Journal, it was given to Amitabh as remuneration for Satte Pe Satta (1982). The actor later sold and repurchased it at Jaya's insistence, paying a higher price. The family then renamed and rebuilt the bungalow.

JALSA NAMED IN FRESH BOMB THREAT

A new bomb threat email on Thursday named Mumbai locations including Jalsa, the mayor's office, Mahalaxmi Racecourse, and Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport. Security personnel and bomb disposal squads searched the premises but found nothing suspicious. This was the third such threat involving Jalsa in as many weeks, following emails on October 23 and November 6.

Love, lights, and Mediterranean nights

Hours after their wedding in Greece on Wednesday, musician Anirudh Ravichander and businesswoman Kavya Maran shared a glimpse of the intimate affair. Anirudh wrote, "My once in a lifetime, for a lifetime. 11.11." The couple wore coordinated Tarun Tahiliani outfits.

PHOTO: FACEBOOK/ ANIRUDH RAVICHANDER

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A still from *Ramayana: Rise of a Legend* featuring Jatayu, voiced by Anupam Kher

Anupam Kher: Jatayu's fight was that of an underdog

Akash Bhatnagar

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Actor Anupam Kher, who has voiced Jatayu and is also the narrator in *Ramayana: Rise of a Legend*, is delighted with the response to the film, particularly the climax fight sequence between Jatayu and Ravana.

"Obviously, the fight is spectacular because of its VFX, and it has also brought attention to the Jatayu Earth Centre in Keralam. I open Instagram, and it's filled with Jatayu Reels. Jatayu was very old when he had this fight. Thus, it was a fight of an underdog," he shares.

The 71-year-old praises the film for its world-class production quality, "People are thinking of the film series like *Lord of the Rings* when they are watching *Ramayana*." At its Swedish premiere, Kher was moved by the audience's response. "An 18-year-old Swedish boy was mesmerised by the film's visuals and the script. He told me he wants to read *Ramayana* now," he says, adding, "The last 100 years, we have seen good cinema but nothing like this."

With *Ramayana* reportedly submitted for the 2027 Oscars, Kher remains hopeful about its prospects. "As an Academy member, I will certainly root for it," he says.

'THE YOUNGER GENERATION IS DOING EVERYTHING BETTER'

Actor Suniel Shetty opens up about wanting his children, actors Ahan and Athiya, to carve their own paths, take risks and learn from their failures

PHOTO: INSTAGRAM/ SUNIEL.SHETTY

PHOTO: YOGEN SHAH

Vishakha Pandit

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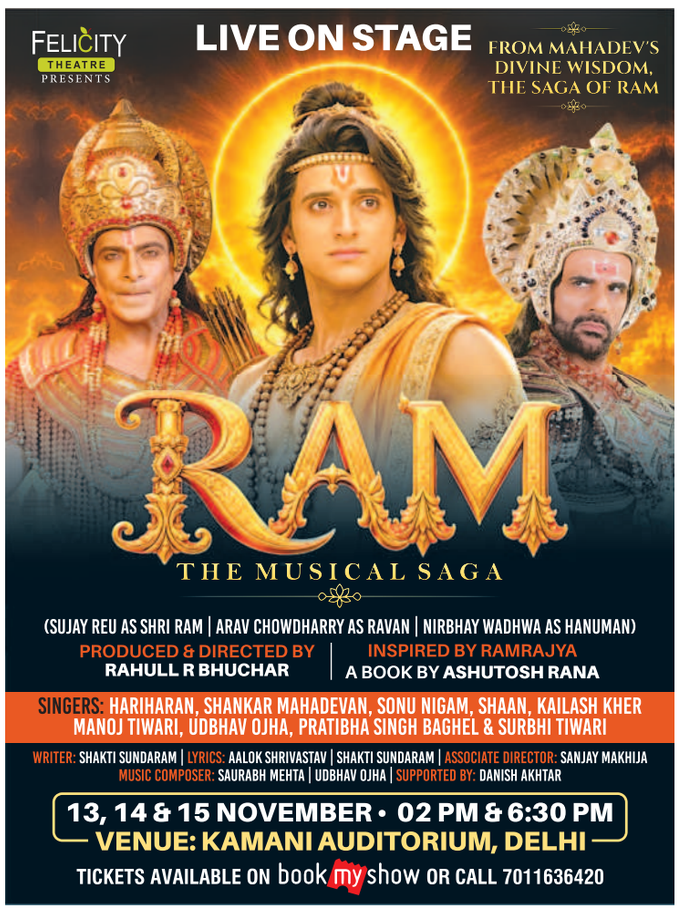
A week after his daughter's birthday, actor Suniel Shetty reflects on how his children Athiya and Ahan inspire him as they live life on their own terms.

"They're doing everything better. They're very smart, know their USP, and work on their strengths. And they're brutally honest. So there's so much to learn from these kids that is not funny," says the 65-year-old, adding that his son's discipline inspires him every day. "When I was his age, I was this young, angry man, wanting to do so much... He's far better than me, far calmer, mentally there. He treats his workout like a ritual."

Suniel doesn't want his children to feel obliged to follow in his footsteps. "Even with my own kids and those working with me, I always ask, 'How long are you going to be here? Get out and do something on your own'," he shares, adding that he tells his children to take the leap, "I won't even listen to the idea. I say, go ahead and do it. Because if they fail, that's where they learn."

Currently hosting *Bharat Ke Super Founders*, the actor talks about his growing interest in business and the new generation of entrepreneurs. "I wish I had known more about business. But I'm learning. I have a soft corner for founders," he says, urging them to learn from his mistakes and have confidence in themselves.

HT Classifieds { THEATRE & PLAYS }



{ DAILY HOROSCOPE }

Friday, November 13, 2026

Dr Prem Kumar Sharma (Astrologer & Vaastu expert) can be contacted at: **Delhi:** 011-47033152, 40532026 (Sat to Mon); **Panchkula:** 91-172-2562832, 2572874 (Tues to Thurs); **Mumbai:** 09716145644 (Last week of every month)

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ARIES
MAR 21-APR 20

Growing workplace competition could demand greater focus on individual professional strengths. Rebellious behaviour at home might test patience. An onsite assignment could introduce professional travel.
LOVE FOCUS: Evening plans can keep your mood upbeat.
LUCKY NUMBER: 2 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Silver

TAURUS
APR 21-MAY 20

A small favour for a sibling strengthens family connections in a meaningful way. Your body could adapt comfortably to current routines despite minor temperature changes.
LOVE FOCUS: Trust between partners can grow through open communication.
LUCKY NUMBER: 9 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Red

GEMINI
MAY 21-JUN 21

A pilgrimage could provide a reflective break. Scheduled workouts can improve fitness consistency and make physical goals easier to maintain. Timely action could move an important property matter in your favour.
LOVE FOCUS: A relaxed evening can bring comfort and warmth.
LUCKY NUMBER: 18 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Brown

CANCER
JUN 22-JUL 22

Handling several projects sharpens your organisation and strengthens professional expertise. A family celebration can bring genuine joy and create memorable shared moments.
LOVE FOCUS: Convincing could require patience and thoughtful communication.
LUCKY NUMBER: 11 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Dark Blue

LEO
JUL 23-AUG 23

A respectful home environment can strengthen family harmony through simple daily gestures. Sudden changes in routine could unsettle your physical balance, so adjust gradually.
LOVE FOCUS: Responding calmly prevents everyday interactions from becoming irritating.
LUCKY NUMBER: 6 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Saffron

VIRGO
AUG 24-SEP 23

Simple lifestyle adjustments can create noticeable improvements in everyday health and wellbeing. Strong financial strategies are likely to protect accumulated wealth and reduce risks.
LOVE FOCUS: Flexibility can ease tension with a stubborn family member.
LUCKY NUMBER: 4 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Silver

LIBRA
SEP 24-OCT 23

Better flexibility can support smoother movement and strengthen joint mobility. Professional goals appear well aligned and bring noticeable momentum to your career plans. A transaction at home needs careful evaluation.
LOVE FOCUS: A reunion brings warmth after time spent apart.
LUCKY NUMBER: 5 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Magenta

SCORPIO
OCT 24-NOV 22

Quick thinking can turn a minor workplace challenge into a valuable professional success for you. Emotional resilience can strengthen as you manage feelings more constructively.
LOVE FOCUS: Time away from routine can help restore family togetherness.
LUCKY NUMBER: 3 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Purple

SAGITTARIUS
NOV 23-DEC 21

Building versatile skills can improve career potential, though excessive multitasking might become overwhelming. Keeping clear boundaries at home can reduce conflict, even if enforcing them feels uncomfortable.
LOVE FOCUS: Seeing someone special will bring excitement.
LUCKY NUMBER: 7 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Blue

CAPRICORN
DEC 22-JAN 21

Persistent body pain could continue despite regular stretching and deserves greater physical care. Hasty money decisions might produce some disappointing outcomes.
LOVE FOCUS: Looking inward can bring more contentment than relying on others.
LUCKY NUMBER: 22 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Grey

AQUARIUS
JAN 22-FEB 19

Overthinking could affect emotional balance, though small worries remain easier to manage calmly. Seeking help can make a heavy academic workload manageable.
LOVE FOCUS: Cooperation can make changing routines easier to handle.
LUCKY NUMBER: 8 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Brown

PISCES
FEB 20-MAR 20

Managing priorities carefully can make your professional day smoother and more productive. Avoiding processed food can support physical comfort despite no major health concerns.
LOVE FOCUS: Avoid emotional pressure and keep interactions clear and balanced.
LUCKY NUMBER: 1 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Maroon

weekend planner

NOVEMBER 14-15

flickfix

SATURDAY-SUNDAY
Where: In theatres
Time: All day

I PLAY ROCKY
Cast: Anthony Ippolito, AnnaSophia Robb, PJ Byrne

editor's car

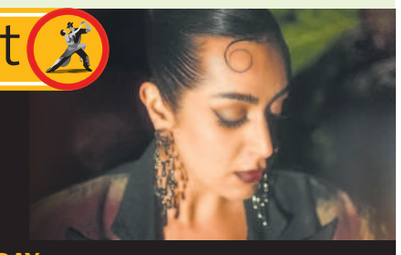
PHOTO: HTCS

bitestop

SATURDAY-SUNDAY
KOREAN CULINARY FESTIVAL
Where: Café, Hyatt Regency Delhi, Bhikaji Cama Place
Time: 12.30pm to 3pm, 7pm to 11pm

THE ART OF SUSHI MAKING
Where: Deja Brew, Block M, Greater Kailash II
Time: 1pm to 2.30pm

grooveit



SUNDAY
KAMAKSHI KHANNA LIVE
Where: The Piano Man, Eldeco Centre, Saket
Time: 8.30pm

BRAINDANCE FT. CHINTAN KALRA
Where: Bigfuz - Jampad, Sound Rental, Humayunpur, Safdarjung Enclave
Time: 6pm

SATURDAY
WAX FOR JOY FT. DAVE SWITCH & NAKUL
Where: Top Banana, M-5, Greater Kailash II
Time: 9pm

SATURDAY-SUNDAY
ANANT UTSAV — FOLK, TRIBAL ARTS & CRAFT FESTIVAL
Where: Amphitheatre, Sunder Nursery, Nizamuddin
Time: 5.30pm to 9.30pm

playdate

PHOTOS FOR REPRESENTATIONAL PURPOSE ONLY

SATURDAY
DASTAN-E-AKHTARI
Where: The Immersion Room, E5, DLF Phase I, Sector 26A, Gurugram
Time: 7.30pm

SUNDAY
HARSH-O-ULLAS FT. HARSH GUJRAL
Where: Kedarnath Sahni Auditorium, Press Enclave, Ajmeri Gate
Time: 7.30pm

PROTHOMA PPANDAV BODHU
Where: The Stein Auditorium, India Habitat Centre, Lodhi Road
Time: 7.30pm

powerhour

Catch It Live: Scan the QR for daily events happening in Delhi-NCR

SATURDAY-SUNDAY
AIR RIFLE LIVE SHOOTING
Where: Triggerline Shooting Range, Block G, Bank Road Vikaspuri
Time: 3.30pm to 6.30pm

Want your event to get featured here?
Email us at: **htcityweekendplanner@gmail.com**

DATING THE BOSS: KNOW THE RISKS

PHOTOS: X

Nvidia's Jensen Huang's alleged affair with his subordinate puts office romance under scrutiny. HR experts and lawyers explain the dos and don'ts of dating a colleague

Aadrika Sominder
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Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang is facing fresh allegations of an extramarital relationship with Kimberly Powell, the company's vice-president of healthcare and a direct subordinate, according to The New York Times. This comes days after he admitted to an affair with Alice Huang, a Chinese businesswoman suspected of being a spy. The report has put workplace romances and conflicts of interest under the spotlight.

But where does India stand on bosses dating their subordinates? HR executives and lawyers weigh in on company policies, legal implications and power dynamics.

"According to Indian law, there is no blanket rule that prohibits managers from dating their direct reportee as long as the relationship is consensual and there is no misuse of position, like compulsion to agree to advances," says advocate Gagan Gandhi, CEO, Niti Nyaya Law Offices.

SAFEGUARDS TO KEEP IN MIND

A workplace relationship need not spell trouble, but clear boundaries are essential. Here are some safeguards suggested by Sanjeeta Mohta, Talent and Finance Manager, Learning Spiral:

- **Check company policy:** Understand disclosure requirements and workplace relationship rules.
- **Disclose conflicts:** Inform HR if one partner supervises the other.
- **Change reporting lines:** Ensure an independent reporting structure to avoid conflicts of interest.
- **Respect consent**: A relationship does not imply blanket consent to future advances or interactions.
- **Have a grievance process:** Ensure clear channels to report harassment, coercion, favouritism or retaliation.

WHEN THINGS GO WRONG

According to Chetna Malaviya, founder, Compos Mentis, a human capital strategy firm, even consensual relationships can raise legal concerns when power dynamics lead to pressure, unwanted advances or professional retaliation after a breakup.

POSH Act, 2013: Under this, the Internal Committee investigates complaints involving unwelcome sexual conduct, demands for sexual favours in exchange for career benefits or threats of professional retaliation, and recommend disciplinary action in corporate settings.

Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023: Section 75 of the BNS deals with sexual harassment, including demands for sexual favours, while Section 69 covers sexual intercourse obtained through deceitful means, including certain false promises of employment or promotion, subject to specific legal conditions.

DISCLOSURE MATTERS

While Indian law does not prohibit consensual workplace relationships, a manager dating a direct reportee can create a conflict of interest. "When a relationship exists within a reporting hierarchy, one individual may influence the other's career progression, performance assessment and opportunities. Most organisations address this through disclosure, followed by changes in reporting relationships. The important consideration is how the associated power dynamics are managed," says Malaviya.

Employees may therefore be required to disclose relationships where one partner supervises the other, depending on company policy.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

What happens when a manager handles the partner's appraisal or promotion? This is where a personal relationship can become an organisational concern. "A manager in such a situation should not be the sole decision-maker on matters affecting their partner's career. Companies can appoint an independent appraiser, change the reporting structure and ensure HR oversight of decisions. Even the perception of preferential treatment can undermine trust in the organisations reward systems," says Malaviya.

Changing reporting lines and introducing independent oversight can help ensure personal relationships do not influence professional decisions.

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Picture perfect, with a stitch!

From wedding portraits to everyday memories, embroidered photos are giving your pictures a handmade twist. With #embroideredphoto crossing seven million views on Instagram, artists share how they create these keepsakes

FROM PHOTOGRAPH TO FRAME

Unlike regular embroidery, this craft involves stitching directly onto printed photographs. Priyanka Dewani, who runs Navi Mumbai-based Filledefil (@filledefil_bypriyankadewani) begins by studying the photograph and identifying details such as outfit borders and florals to highlight. After finalising the design with the client, she hand-stitches it using different colours and techniques. "It is a very detailed process and requires a lot of patience because I handle every aspect of the artwork myself," she says.

Pricing: ₹1,300 and goes upto ₹25,000 for an A5 size.
Time: 12 to 14 hours

Aadrika Sominder

MEMORIES, WITH A HANDMADE TOUCH

For makers, the appeal goes beyond a viral craft. "Pictures capture moments, but embroidery adds a different kind of emotion to them. I loved the thought of creating something people could cherish for years," says Dewani.

The demand comes from its personal touch. "People love the idea of turning their favourite memories into handmade keepsakes," says Anthony Sahana, founder of Bengaluru-based THEHOOPSCART (@thehoopscrat).

TRY IT YOURSELF

- **Choose your picture**: Pick a clear photo with details to highlight (like portraits, outfits, or florals).
- **Print it right:** Use thick matte paper or cardstock to prevent creases and fingerprints.
- **Trace your design:** Sketch the details you want to embroider onto a transparent sheet placed over the photo.
- **Pierce tiny holes:** Support the photo on cardboard or a towel, and poke holes 2–3 mm apart along your traced lines.
- **Start stitching:** Embroider through the holes using a fine needle and 2–3 strands of thread, taping the loose ends at the back.
- **Frame your artwork:** Use a glass frame with a mat board so the glass doesn't press against the stitches.
- Pro tip: Always trace your design and pre-pierce the holes before stitching to avoid tearing the photo.

- With inputs from Anthony Sahana

#gramit

Delhi gets Chhath-ready

The festive spirit continues in the Capital as preparations gather pace for Chhath Puja (November 13-16). At Hathi Ghat, near ITO, workers have been busy making arrangements for devotees who will gather from today to offer prayers to the setting and rising Sun while standing in the Yamuna river.

PHOTO: SANCHIT KHANNA/ HT

Trade Fair goes the Gen Z way

PHOTOS: MANOJ VERMA/ HT(FOR REPRESENTATIONAL PURPOSE ONLY)

Gen Z is set to take centre stage at this year's India International Trade Fair (IITF), scheduled from November 14 to 27 at Bharat Mandapam, with new attractions including a startup showcase, an edutainment zone, revamped food courts and a guide app.

For the first time in over four decades, around 450 startups will showcase innovations at the 'Hall of Inspiration' and meet domestic and global investors.

"Our goal was to create a stage for young founders to display their innovations, breakthroughs, and business talent," says Premjit Lal, Executive Director, India Trade Promotion Organisation (ITPO).

A separately ticketed 'Edutainment Zone' will combine learning with fun, while upgraded food courts will offer international cuisines and regional delicacies from 15 to 20 states.

Also, a dedicated app will provide hall maps, schedules and online ticketing.

The fair will also feature 31 states and Union Territories, over 50 government departments and international exhibitors with nearly double their previous footprint.

Karan Sethi

CATCH IT LIVE:

What: 45th India International Trade Fair
Where: Bharat Mandapam, Pragati Maidan
When: November 14 to 18 (Business days) and November 19 to 27 (General public days)
Timing: 10am to 7.30pm
Entry: Gates 3 and 4 (Bhairon Marg) and Gates 6 and 10 (Mathura Road)

Ticket: Available on 55 designated metro stations and Bharat Mandapam app
On business days:
Weekend: ₹500 (adults) and ₹200 (children)
Week days: ₹500 (adults) and 150 (children)
On general days:
Weekend: ₹150 (adults) and ₹60 (children)
Week days: ₹80 (adults) and ₹40 (children)
Free entry for senior citizens and specially abled
Nearest Metro Station: Supreme Court (Blue Line)

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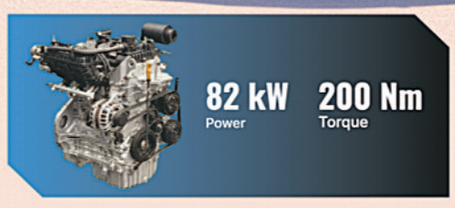

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